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Պատմութիւն
Արիստակիսի
Լաստիվերտցոյ

THE HISTORY OF ARISTAKES LASTIVERTSI

Aristakes Lastivertsi (Արիստակէս
Լաստիվերտցի)

SOURCE-FAITHFUL TRANSLATION

Translated from the Classical Armenian with AI assistance, edited by Paul
McMurry

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Պատմութիւն Արիստակիսի Լաստիվերտցոյ վասն անցից անցելոց ի յայլազգեան ազգաց որք շուրջ զմեք են

Source

Base text: K. N. Yuzbashyan (ed.), *Patmut'wn Aristakisi Lastivertc'woy, Matenadaran / Publishing House of the Academy of Sciences of the Armenian SSR, Erevan, 1963*, printed pp. 21–145, read from page images of that edition.

The English rests on the printed main text throughout. Where the edition's own table of contents, or a manuscript variant reported in its apparatus, gives a different reading, the printed main text is followed and the divergence is disclosed in the back-of-book notes; it is never silently substituted. This is a source-faithful reading translation of one critical edition's constituted text, not a new multi-witness critical edition of the Armenian.

- Yuzbashyan 1963 — Matenadaran critical edition (as available)
- AUA digital Armenian text (provisional scaffold only, never authority)

Translated from the Classical Armenian with AI assistance, edited by Paul McMurry

Translated from Classical Armenian verified character by character against 300 dpi page images of the Yuzbashyan 1963 critical edition before any English was drafted, with AI assistance; edited and verified by Paul McMurry. Scripture is translated from Aristakes' own wording and is never replaced with the wording of an English Bible: where he quotes loosely, conflates, or misremembers, the English follows him and the divergence is disclosed. The author's dating, his numbers, his errors and his invective all stand as he wrote them. Square brackets mark the source editor's supplements, not the translator's. Guillemets « » mark a quotation the 1963 edition itself sets in guillemets; straight quotes " " mark direct speech the edition leaves typographically unmarked and the Armenian marks lexically instead. The reading page carries no note cues; the 498 back-of-book notes are keyed by chapter and lemma.

Produced from the 1963 page images without using any existing English translation as a source text. The corpus translation standard bars consulting an existing translation at any stage, permitting comparison only after freeze; this project's brief instead required a post-draft, pre-freeze collation against R. Bedrosian's English version, unit by unit, and that departure is authorized and disclosed. It was narrowed by procedure: the comparator was opened only after a unit's draft was locked and its independent audit saved, every divergence was resolved from the

Armenian page image alone, and no rendering was adopted from it anywhere in this work. Two distinctive phrases that converged by accident were re-drafted away.

Limitations

This edition has NOT undergone independent Armenian-language review, philological review, or external scholarly peer review, and it must not be represented as having done so. The project-owner sign-off of 13 September 2026 accepts the machine-validated text and its editorial presentation; it certifies no Armenian reading. Correctness rests on the documented source-first workflow: verification against page images before drafting, production QA, a blind independent audit, post-draft comparator collation with nothing adopted, a whole-work terminology audit, and a final Armenian-to-English reverse-coverage audit over printed pp. 21–145 certifying 3,048 ledger rows with none left unresolved. Open textual cruxes are disclosed in the notes rather than resolved by guess; twelve are named there. The scripture notes are keyed by printed page, line and Armenian incipit rather than by an English lemma, because the citation table carries no English column. One Armenian word at p. 115 l. 6 is left unrepresented in the English rather than forced. Chapters 1–11 are British-spelled and Chapters 12–25 American, an unresolved seam at the chapter 11/12 boundary. Printed p. 146 onward is the 1963 editor's bibliography and indices and lies outside this translation.

Suggested citation

Aristakes Lastivertsi, *The History of Aristakes Lastivertsi* (source-faithful translation), translated from the Classical Armenian of Yuzbashyan's 1963 critical edition with AI assistance, edited by Paul McMurry. Open Chronicles, volume 7, version 1.0.2, 2026.
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BACK MATTER

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About this edition

The work's own printed title

The title above is the work's own. It is printed at the head of the text on p. 21 of the controlling edition, ll. 1–3, set in the main-text measure inside the edition's marginal line numbering and collated in its critical apparatus — transmitted source text, not editorial titling. The editor sets it in three printed lines, dividing after ՎԱՐԴԱՊԵՏԻ and after ՈՐՔ.

The source

K. N. Yuzbashyan (ed.), *Patmut'iwn Aristakisi Lastivertc'woy*, Matenadaran / Publishing House of the Academy of Sciences of the Armenian SSR, Erevan, 1963 — printed pp. 21–145, read from the page images of that edition.

The English rests on the **printed main text** of that edition throughout. Where the edition's own table of contents, or a manuscript variant reported in its apparatus, gives a different reading, the printed main text is followed and the divergence is disclosed in the notes at the back — it is never silently substituted.

Extent

Twenty-five numbered chapters, Ա to ԻԵ, and one unnumbered authorial colophon. The work runs from p. 21 l. 1 to p. 145 l. 30 and ends there. The verse proem stands inside Chapter 1 and is not a division of the edition. The closing *Discourse of Commemoration Concerning This Very Book* is the author's own and carries no numeral: **it is not a twenty-sixth chapter, and there is none.** Printed p. 146 onward is the 1963 editor's own bibliography and indices, in reformed orthography, and lies outside this translation.

Method note

Every unit's Armenian was verified character by character against the page images of the controlling edition before any English was drafted, and the English was drafted from that verified Armenian alone. Scripture is translated from Aristakes' own wording, never replaced with the wording of an English Bible: where he quotes loosely, conflates, or misremembers, the English follows him and the divergence is what the reader is owed. The author's dating, his numbers, his errors and his invective all stand as he wrote them. Square brackets in the English mark the source editor's supplements, not the translator's.

Declared departure. The corpus translation standard bars consulting any existing English translation at any stage, permitting comparison only after freeze. This project's brief instead required a **post-draft, pre-freeze** collation against R. Bedrosian's English version, unit by unit, and that departure is authorized and disclosed here. It was narrowed by procedure so that the guarantee the corpus rule protects is preserved: the comparator was opened only after a unit's draft was locked and its independent audit saved, every divergence was resolved from the Armenian page image alone, and **no rendering was adopted from it anywhere in this work**. Two distinctive phrases that converged by accident were re-drafted away.

Notes

The reading page carries **no note cues**. The notes at the back are keyed by chapter and by lemma, and are compiled selectively: uncertain readings, consequential textual decisions, the identification of scriptural quotations, the identification of persons and places, calendar equivalents, and the terms kept untranslated. They state what is known and what is not; *unidentified* is a frequent and correct answer.

Quotation marks

« » marks a quotation the controlling edition itself sets in guillemets — in this work, almost always scripture, and almost always keyed by the editor to a starred reference at the foot of his page. " " marks direct speech that the edition leaves typographically unmarked and that the Armenian marks lexically instead, by թէ / աւէ / աւելով with an initial capital. The two devices are kept apart because the edition keeps them apart. Where the editor's guillemets enclose an aside in the author's own voice, the English sets that aside outside the quotation, since it does not belong to the speaker quoted.

Review status

This edition was produced by the source-first workflow described above and was frozen on 13 September 2026 after project-owner sign-off on the machine-validated text. **That sign-off is not independent Armenian-language review, and it is not philological or scholarly peer review.** No independent Armenian-speaking reviewer, external referee, or scholarly certification stands behind this text. What stands behind it is the documented process: character-by-character verification of every unit against the 1963 page images before drafting; clause-level production QA; a blind independent audit saved before the production records or any comparator were opened; post-draft comparator collation with no rendering adopted; a whole-work terminology audit; and a final Armenian-to-English reverse-coverage audit over printed pp. 21-145, certifying 3,048 ledger rows with none left unresolved.

Readers who need certainty on a particular reading should go to the 1963 edition itself. Corrections are welcome and are published on the Corrections page; after the freeze, changes to this text are made by recorded erratum rather than silent edit.

The Events Throughout This Land of the Armenians

Days of torment came upon us,
And afflictions beyond bearing found us.
For the measure of our sins was filled and ran over,
And our outcry went up before God.
All flesh corrupted its way,
And the earth was filled with lawlessness.
Righteousness dwindled, and debauchery multiplied,
People and priest lied to God.
For which cause the foreign-born nations
Estranged us from our own dwelling,
And our glory was turned to corruption.
No breath was left in us,
And we perished in the cutting off of our hope.
Death grew strong and devoured,
And hell would not consent to say, Enough.
The hands of all rushed upon us,
And at the last, in these our days, time did not reckon
The remnant of the chastisement as discharged by the payment of those
gone before.
Successors took the place of successors,
And the yield that keeps alight the breath of life grew scarce.
Those firmly settled in the land, in their own exile,
Were exiled a second time and became outcasts
At the hand of exiles in revolt.
Torn from those they loved, they whom the sword had not destroyed
Were scattered like the stars that are called wandering.
Whereupon in these our days wars awoke from the four quarters:
From the east the sword, from the west slaughter,
From the north fire, from the south death.

Gladness was lifted away from the land,
The voices of the lyres fell silent,
The beat of the drums fell silent,
The cries of weeping were lifted up . . .

And so much for that. But it is time for us to proceed to the chapters of this history and to make our beginning from here, so that this account may be easy for us to grasp.

And it came to pass after the death of Dawit' the curopalates — who was a mighty man and a builder of the land, munificent and a lover of the poor, who was in truth the boundary of peace; for in his days every man rested, according to the prophecy, under his own vine and under the fig tree. But after his death Basil, the emperor of the Romans, marched out in the twenty-fifth year of his reign with heavy force of arms; and, setting his face, he comes and arrives at the district of Ekegheats', passing by many halting-places. And the companies of the azat nobles of 'Tayk' run out to meet him; and each one of them, honoured by him with lavishly given gifts according to his deserts, attaining to lordship, to honour, to rank, exulted and rejoiced greatly. But the prophecy of David, singer of the Spirit, was fulfilled upon them: «In the morning like green grass they shall spring up, in the morning like green grass they shall flourish and blossom; in the evening they shall wither, and dry up, and fall.» For the king, passing into the land of Aghori, near the stronghold which is called Hawachich, takes his night's lodging. And I do not know from what causes the western army, which is called the Rus, and the azat companies fell upon one another; and in that same place thirty men of the azats died, from among the most honoured. And this did not come upon them unjustly or to no purpose, but because on the day of Great Thursday they had mixed a deadly drug into the mystery of the offering and given it him to drink, and, choking the blessed one to death, took him out of this life — being weary of his living — for the sake of the promises in prospect which they looked for from the king. For that cause the just judgement of God requited them according to their deeds. And from that day to this it has never gone well for an azat of the house of 'Tayk' to come forth and prolong his life;

rather they were despatched by an untimely death and taken away from life. The lofty Isaiah rebukes and reproves them where he says: «Inasmuch as that people of yours has taken no pleasure in the water of Siloam that went quietly, but they wished to make Rezin and the son of Tabeel their own king — therefore thus says the Lord: I bring upon you the water of the river, the strong and the abundant, the king of the Assyrians and his glory.» And so much for that.

And in that same place Bagarat, king of the Abkhaz, and his father Gurgen come and meet him; and the emperor glorifies them greatly. And he gives Bagarat the dignity of curopalates, and to his father that of magistros, and dismisses them in peace. And he himself, going on, passes through Hark' and through Manazkert, and, taking up his station, turns back over Bagrewand and comes to the city of Ukhtik', and takes possession of many districts and fortresses and cities. And he sets over them agents and judges and overseers; and he himself returns by his road in peace, and reaches his own royal city, Constantinople. This took place in the year four hundred and fifty of this era of ours; and the land grew quiet and rested fourteen years.

And the king himself, going, discharges the cares of the western region; for he takes possession of the land of the Bulgars, of their districts and of their cities, which for a long time past, from the beginning of his reign, he had not been able with unresting wars to bring under his hand; but now the opportunities were falling out to his purpose. For he who held that land — the victor in wars — died his own death; and his sons, because they were not subject to one another, gave themselves up and came out to the king; for «Every kingdom divided against itself cannot live.» This is the manner of the taking of the land of the Bulgars. But the king, removing the sons of the tyrant of the Bulgars from their inheritance with their kindred and their nation, gives them places in the land of the Romans; and the troops of that land he gathers by deceit into one place, as though to give them gifts, and, having taken their number in writing, sends them off into the east on a coming without return — and they, coming, turned these lands of ours into a waste. Woe to their coming into the east, and woe to the place where they passed and turned back! Behold, a nation evil and without pity, a nation bitter of heart and given to striking. It is fitting to say of them the

prophetic lament: «Before it a paradise of delight, and after it a plain of corruption.» And so much for that. But let us return to the order of this history.

In the four hundred and sixty-fourth year of our era Bagarat, king of the Abkhaz, died, and Georgi his son reigns in his stead. To him the emperor Basil writes a decree, which has this form: *What I gave to your father as a gift out of the curopalates' portion, give up; and be prince only over your own patrimony.* But he does not accept it; rather, grown proud in his boyish years, he makes a contrary answer: *Of that which my father has held by authority I will not give even one house to anyone.* And the emperor, hearing this, sends an army to master the land by force. Against them came the brave men of 'Tayk', near the great town of 'Ukhtik', and they turned the armies of the Romans to flight; but they did no wrong to the city or to the other inhabited places. This was the beginning of the ruin of the house of 'Tayk'.



Concerning the Kingdom of the Armenians

At that time the land of the Armenians too had a king, Gagik son of Ashot, brother of Smbat and Gurgen, of the line of the Bagratuni, a mighty man and victorious in wars; he held this land of the Armenians in peace. In his time the orders of the church grew resplendent, and the children of the covenant of holiness were illumined; in his days «The earth was filled with the knowledge of the Lord, like many waters that cover the seas», according to the prophet's foretelling. For lord Sargis held the throne of the patriarchate, having been nurtured in holiness in the bosom of the church and trained in monastic asceticism in the monastery which is called the island of Sevan; whom by the grace of God they call according to his worthiness, and seat upon the throne of

our Illuminator. And he, having conducted himself in the body according to that same one's rules, brought his life to its completion in good contests.

And there were at that time vardapets: Sargis and Tiranun and Yenovk', who were the vardapets of the catholicosate; and Samuel, who shepherded the monastery of Kamrjats' Zor as its abbot; and Yovsep', who was head of the monastery of Hndzuts'; and Step'annos Taronets'i, who composed the books of universal history in a marvellous arrangement, beginning from the first man, and comes and brings his history to its full compass at the death of Gagik — of whom this present history treats; and Yovhannes from the same district, whom they called by the added name Kozern, who wrote the books of the faith; and Grigor, exceedingly wise in words; and many others, in whose days the horn of the church was greatly raised up by orthodox confession. But those who looked upon us with a grudging eye, their eyes cast down by these men's vardapet contests, went creeping like mice into the holes of the walls. And so much for that.

But king Gagik, having governed the kingdom for a long time and become worthy of good remembrance, in deep old age ends his life; and his sons succeed to the lordship — Smbat, whom they called Yovhannes, and Ashot his own brother. And Smbat was ample in body and exceedingly fat, but in wisdom, they say, he was greater than many; while Ashot had a well-ordered build of body, being stout-hearted and a lover of war. These two, having fallen upon one another in contention over the portions of the land, came to need right and judgement. To these came Georgi, king of the Abkhaz, and won them over to peace; and he gives as his portion to the two-named Smbat the stronghold Ani and the districts that lie round about it, because he was the firstborn; and to Ashot the inner part of the land, which looks toward the Persians and the Georgians. And Smbat, having agreed, returned to his own city; and on the road, having made a halt because of the heaviness of his body, he slept without care. But a certain one of the princes on Ashot's side, standing to plead before Georgi, says: *Sbatik is my native place, which Smbat has unjustly carried off from me.* Georgi, hearing this, and stirred to anger by a stern rage, sent troops after him; and they came and poured suddenly upon him, and he, because of the

heaviness of his body, could not mount his horse. But the princes who were behind him, turning valiantly to flight, set up along the road many heaps of the corpses of those who pursued them, as far as the gate of Ani. And turning back from there, they stripped and pillaged the churches of the catholicosate of their ornaments; and drawing out the nails of the crosses they said in mockery: "We will carry them off and make crescents for the horses." For which, at the fitting hour, God the just judge requited them by the hand of the Romans — which we shall tell in its own place. But Smbat they seized and took to Georgi, who commanded that he be kept in custody; and then, having taken three fortresses, he released him.

But as for Ashot — because those who were magnates round about his border had unjustly carried off many of his places, which he could not endure — for that cause, leaving the land, he goes and comes to the court of the king of the Romans; and having found favour with him, he asked for troops as a help, and takes them and comes and passes into his own land. And with success coming to him from God, he takes possession of many districts and fortresses; and he grows stronger than all who were before him. So much so that many of the magnates, leaving their patrimonial places to him, gave themselves up to him in obedience of their own will. Up to this point this history is pleasant to us.

But in the year four hundred and sixty-seven of this era of ours the emperor sends a certain Nicomedian prince, who, coming, lays a poll-tax upon this land of ours; and having gathered a multitude of men, he makes a beginning of building Theodosiopolis anew.

And in the year four hundred and sixty-eight lord Petros is ordained to the catholicosate in the lifetime of lord Sargis. And in the year four hundred and seventy the emperor again marches out with a heavy army and comes into the east. And coming, he makes his halt in the Broad Plain of Karin; and he sends envoys to Georgi, the ruler of the Georgians, that he should come into obedience to him. For a certain bishop too, Georgian by nation, who had his seat in the city of Vagharshakert, went out to meet the king and gave assurance in words: *When you come out to Ekegheats' or to Karin, he will come to meet you.*

And he, believing his words and resting his confidence on that, waited for his coming, moving from one lodging to another. But he would not undertake to come at the king's summons; for many of his own people were casting fear into him: *When he sees you, either you die or he makes you a prisoner, and you will not attain to your honour.* But the king, passing into Basean, sends two and three messengers, for he greatly wished to accomplish his journey in peace, and that the land should remain in its prosperity. Then, when the messengers were spent, the king, moved to anger, gave command to destroy with fire and sword and captivity the great town which is called Okomi, and the villages and farms round about it which lay within that portion; and taking its captives, he commands them to be marched off to the district of Khaghtik'; and he himself, setting his face, passes through Basean and reaches the district of Vanand, to Karmir P'orak. But Georgi, finding the fitting hour, comes down upon the city of Ukhtik', and commands his troops to burn its beautiful estates with fire and to carry off its goods as plunder, but to do no wrong at all to any man. When the king heard this, roused to anger more than ever, he turns back against him; and the armies, meeting one another near the lake which is called Paghakats'is, struck at one another with a terrible din. So that from the flashing of the swords and the glittering of the helmets lightnings of fire fell about the mountain, and from the clashing of the swords sparks of fire broke off and fell to the earth. Looking on at these things, even the king himself marvelled at the valour of the fighters; for as the torrents of rivers strike against a rock, so the armies of the Romans, striking against them, kept turning back on their heels. In that place the great prince Rat died: his horse having met with marshes, he could not get through; and the sword came upon him, and they killed that praiseworthy man, which brought great mourning upon the house of Tayk'. But Georgi, going with his troops, makes himself secure in the stronghold of the Abkhaz; and the king sends troops into the four quarters of the land, looses raiding parties, gives orders with a stern command to have no mercy on the old man or the young, on the child or the one of full stature, on man or woman, nor at all on any age whatever; and with this undertaking he tears down and destroys twelve districts. In them was to be seen a sight pitiable and worthy of many tears; for the high-

vaulted mansions of royally built halls, which with vast expense and by the ingenuity of craftsmen had been built for the wonder of those who beheld them and for the glad enjoyment of those who dwelt in them — burnt with fire, they fell and were overthrown, and those who were their lords lay sword-slain beside them. Alas for this history, alas for that evil deed! How shall I, poor in knowledge and duller than all men, be able to set down in writing the things that happened at that hour, or to lament our miseries as they deserve? These things belong to the spirit of Jeremiah, who knows how to frame laments to match the misery. But we in few words set up as a monument these long matters, this history, for the hearing of the ears of the generation that is to come; so that the sons who shall be born may rise up and tell this to their own sons; so that they may not forget the works of God, who requites with a just balance all who turn aside from his ordinances, according to the words of Job: «He shall requite, he says, in the sight of those who hate him, and shall not put it off.»

Now come, reckon up for me the manner of what was done at that hour: the honoured and venerable grey hairs of the old men steeped in blood and in what is past enduring; the young men cut down by the sword; the countless and unnumbered that had eyes, whose lamps they darkened. I think that these things passed over them fittingly, in return for this: that they drew out the nails of the royally stamped sign at the door of the holy cathedral, and said in mockery that they would make crescents for the horses — by this right it passed over them, and the bitter sight that goes with these things. Azat women went out into the public square, the veil taken away from their heads, and shamelessly, in the face of the sun, they fell into open shame; and those who on foot would scarcely go to visit the sick or to places of pilgrimage now walk with bare head and bare foot before their captors, stripped of their ornaments, fallen from honour, given over to a myriad of dishonours. As for the suckling children: some they took from the arms of their mothers and dashed against the stone; and others they pierced with spears in their mothers' arms, and mingled the blood of the infants with the milk of the mothers; and some they flung down at the crossings of the roads and slaughtered them one and all under the hooves of the horses. O God, that forbearance of yours at that time! O the merciless

commanding of the king! Yet for all this his anger was not quenched; but his hand is still lifted up, to add yet other evils on top of this one. And by this work, having made the well-built land empty of men, he kept it waste and desolate until the coming of winter.

But I do not know in what manner all this passed over them — whether according to an order of chastisement, or because of the multiplied impieties of the inhabitants of the land, or because of the savage manners of the western troops, gathered out of barbarous nations. But the king returns to his winter quarters, to the mild parts of Pontus, and going down into the district of Khaghtik' he takes his night's lodging. The patriarch Petros, coming after him, meets him on the days of the great feast of the Theophany, and is made much of and honoured by him.

Now on the day of Illumination — on which it is the rule for Christian kings and princes who stand in piety to make themselves equal with the leaders of the church, and to go down on foot into the waters, and there to accomplish the mystery of the Lord's baptism — now, on the day when it came round, the king commands the patriarch Petros to bless the water according to this canon of ours, and the bishops of the Romans who happened to be there according to their own canon. And as the patriarch poured the Lord's oil into the waters, jets of rays of light suddenly shone out of the waters; which all of them alike saw, and they glorified God; and the horn of this our faith was raised up. And honoured with still greater honour by the king and by the officers, the patriarch Petros returns to his own house. But it was there that the writing and letter of the ruin of the Armenians came to be; for Yovhannes had given the patriarch a charge: *Write a writing and give a testament to the king, that after my end I may give him my cities and my lands for an inheritance.* For he had no son to bear the crown of the kingdom, because his son Erkat' had died early and had not come to his father's dignity. And the king, going on, reaches the winter quarters in the places said before; and the troops sold the captive people off into distant nations.

In these same times the holy and worthy patriarch lord Sargis passes from the world, and his tomb is in the monastery of Horomos.

How the King Turns a Second Time Against the Land of 'Tayk', in Which the Troops of the Iberians Were Defeated

But the emperor, having brought his winter quarters to an end in the mild country of Pontus, when the season that brings the spring came on, marches again by that same track against 'Tayk'; and passing through many stopping-places, he comes and encamps in the district of Basean. Now many of the princes of the Romans — men whom the king had cast out of honour and out of authority, time after time and on one pretext after another, and who were roaring like lions in cages — finding here a fitting hour, gathered into one place. And taking evil counsel among themselves, a counsel they proved unable to make good, they resolved to rebel with one accord against the king and to set up as king whomever they themselves should wish. And when they were settled upon this, then they brought their counsel into the open, and encamped in the broad plain; in which a countless multitude of men gathered into one place, and they began to thrust the royal dignity upon one another. And then, all being of one mind, they laid hold of the son of Phokas, whom they called Crooked-neck, who because of his father's offences had long since fallen from the honour of authority. He, not consenting, does not take it upon himself; but they did not slacken from their demand, and by force they prevailed upon him until he took it upon himself.

When the emperor heard of this, he lay fallen into the midst of a great perplexity, and going, he takes refuge in the strongholds of a certain fortress that is called Magdat — for this is an old custom of the house of the Greeks. But I do not know whether these are the divine ordinances, that it is not right for servants to rise against their lords; or whether it was at that time a particular grace granted to the king. This I know for a certainty, and I saw it with my own

eyes: that those who rose up against him went out of this life by a laughable death. So, as at the first, in the beginning of his reign, Vard who is called Siklaros rebelled against him, and drew the Romans after himself — very nearly the whole of them, every one — so that the king had to ask for troops as a help from the curopalates of the Georgians. With these, having struck the usurper, they drive him out of the land a fugitive; and he, going, falls into Babylon, into the city of the Chaldeans. And then, after him, his namesake Phokas sickened with the same sickness, and ruled all the East for seven years. And he, having crossed the sea by night with four thousand men and no more, falls upon the rebel's troops in their tens of thousands; and out of so great a multitude not one man dies, but only the rebel himself, and he outright. Whose head, being cut off, he orders the trumpet of peace to be sounded. And the war having ceased, each one of the troops returns to his own home; and the king himself, going in great victory, enters his own city Constantinople.

In the same way here too nothing was drawn out long for them — a thing built in childish play, or a building upon sand, which, when the floods beat against it, straightway fell and was overthrown. For Dawit', who was called Senek'erim, being pressed by the Persians, gives his ancestral inheritance, the house of Vaspurakan, to the emperor Basil, and receives in exchange the city of Sebastia, which has districts round about it. And these things were done not at a distant time, but two or three years before; and from that time and thereafter the Romans ruled the East. This man was at that hour in the counsel, of one accord with the rebels, and trusted among them; who, suddenly, like a man roused out of sleep, or like a strong man shaking off his wine, seeing the unseemliness of the deed, and because there was no other means whatever of thwarting the evil confederacy — then, on a certain day, at an hour that was not looked for, they take the man whom they had named king, they went out beyond the camp as though for an opportunity of confidential speech, and suddenly, taking up a sword, he killed him. And having cut off the head and given it to his servant, he speedily conveys it to the king.

But the people, when it had so fallen out, went out man by man, hurrying to reach their own houses unnoticed; and at once all their counsels were brought to

nothing.

But the king, seeing the head of the usurper, orders it raised upon a pole in the sight of the whole camp; for there were many of them who, though they went after the king with the running of their feet, were nevertheless of one accord with the rebel in word and in counsel. This he does according to his own deep wisdom, so that, seeing it, they might stand off from their vain counsels, and might set their hearts straight toward obedience to the king.

After this the king goes down with his troops into the broad plain of Basean, and sends horsemen from among the heathen troops to take the rebel Phers captive; and he himself, marching, arrives at the far end of Basean, at the place that is called Salk'oray; and having thrown up a rampart with a deep ditch round about the camp, he halts there a month of days, or longer still.

But those sent by the king, having seized Phers and Andronike the son-in-law of that same man, who was his fellow in counsel, and having brought them as far as the stronghold that is called Khaghtoy Arich at the far end of Karin, and having come to the farmstead that faces the fortress, and having made their halt, and having brought Phers and Andronikos forward — they cut off their heads. For the king had given them that command; because these men, in their rebelling, had become confederates of the Abkhaz, and had promised to give him, as far as that place, land for his portion — because in an earlier time Dawit' the curopalates had held that place, yet not as his ancestral inheritance, but these were gifts to him from the king on account of his single-minded obedience. And whereas he had promised that after his own death he would give his district to the king, they took no account of that, but were lavish with what was not their own. For that reason the king commanded there that their heads be taken off.

Concerning the Last Battle, which was at Shghpha

But the king, during the days that he stayed at Salk'oray — since he was demanding from Georgi three fortresses together with their estates, which Gurgen had unjustly taken out of the curopalates' portion — kept sending envoys to him, and wrote to him in gentle words: "What is not your ancestral inheritance, let go; and remain in peace within your own portion; and do not obstruct my road that runs into Persia." But he does not consent. Afterwards he sends Zak'aria — whom we mentioned a little earlier — the bishop of Vagharshakert; and he, having gone and beguiled Georgi with persuasive words, to which Georgi gives his consent, writes also to the king that he would give what was demanded. And he took the letter and turned back rejoicing.

And when he had gone one day's journey of road, to the halt where he was to make his lodging, couriers came hurrying after him in search of the letter, for the fool had repented; and they took it and went back again. But the other went on and meets the king, and reports what had happened. Then the king asks about the troops, and about their being equipped for the contests of war. Zak'aria answered and says: "He has troops in such numbers as no one else, mighty in strength and ready to give battle." Hearing which, the king, moved to anger, says: "You too have come from among the rebels — you are putting me in fear." And he orders him to be marched off to Constantinople, saying: "Go, stay there, until I come to you a fugitive." And he orders those conveying him to cut out his tongue. And he went, and returned no more to his own place, but remained there until the day of his death.

After this the king left the camp-ground of the halt at Salk'oray and marches with his troops to the former place, which is called Shghpha. Learning which, the Abkhaz — while they had not yet pitched camp and made themselves safe behind a palisade — works a stratagem after this fashion. He sends as envoy a certain chief man among his own bishops, and himself comes on behind the envoy with his troops, so that, falling upon them unprepared, they might turn

them to flight with terror. These came on at speed on horseback, each man outstripping his fellow, not after the manner of war but as though for plunder and pillage — just as in ancient times, in the days of Joram, the Moabites came against Israel and were struck down by the sword of bitterness, so it befell these also. For, having charged recklessly upon the horses, and failing in strength because of the weight, and because of the iron-forged arms, and because of the long gallop at speed, the troops of the Romans took them into their midst effortlessly, on the instant, and cut down a countless multitude. But those who remained became fugitives, together with their king, and took refuge in the stronghold of the Abkhaz; and the troops went after them and cut them down until the setting of the sun. Then the king orders the heads of the slain to be gathered into one place, and one dahekan to be given to each of those who brought them; and they made search through all the borders and gathered the heads of the fallen into one place before the king. And he orders them to be set in heaps along the road, for the astonishment and the terror of those who saw.

After this, when Georgi saw himself fallen away from all hope, he then entreats the king to come to peace. Hearing which, he had compassion on him, and writes him a letter after this pattern: "Do not suppose," he says, "that because I have overcome you I am demanding anything more of you than before; only give me my patrimony, which the curopalates had given me, and give me your son as a hostage; and for the rest there is peace between me and you." Persuaded by this, he consents; and the king set princes over the district, and they divide it house by house and village by village and farm by farm, as it had been at the first. And the king Basil took the hostages, and promises to send them back after three years; and he himself marched with his troops round about Armenia, and encamps in the broad plain of Her, and orders his troops to cut down the orchards of the city. But the man who was prince of the city begged to serve the king with tribute and to remain in obedience to him.

And while he was of this mind — for the whole land of the Persians, one and all, lay in fear, beset with terror, and they were seeking means of deliverance — of a sudden the heavens thickened with cloud and torrents of rain poured down upon the earth; and after that a biting north wind blew, and turned the rain into

hail and into snow and into ice, and covered the face of the earth with thick-massed drifts. For the season itself lent a hand to this, since they had come well on into winter. And as the abundance of the snow and the harshness of the frosts went on, the droves of the horses and of the mules grew numb and could not stir. But as for the footmen among the troops, from the bitterness of the frosts the ends of their feet and the ends of their hands, as though burnt with fire, were severed and dropped away; and the cords of the tents and the pegs, bound fast to the ground by the violence of the bitter visitation, remained immovable. And this, as it seems to me, was the requital of their pitiless sword, which they had brought upon the Christians; for though those were delivered up because of their sins, it was for these to show mercy — as God said also to the Babylonian: «I delivered my people into your hand, and you did not show mercy upon them.» For that reason they were tormented with bitter frosts, and not upon high mountains but in the deepest plains and in places exceedingly warm, in the sight of their own enemies — just as in Moses' time Egypt was struck with hail and with hoarfrost, which was not according to the nature of that land; whence the barbarians knew plainly that the hand of the Almighty was making war upon them. And this being so, those who held out by force and strength mounted the horses, together with their king, and, harried by the frosts as though by enemies, taking no care at all for their goods, went across into the district of the Artsrunis. Seeing which, the city made a sudden sally and came out, and rushing upon them with great joy they were filled with plunder — with horses and with mules and with tents and with the rest of the baggage, which the others had not been able to make use of, but were hindered by the cold. But the king, reviled by the plunderers, knew plainly that the hand of the Lord had delivered the Georgians into his hand, as it is written in the book of Kingdoms: «Not by his own strength,» he says, «is the mighty man strong; but the Lord makes weak the adversary.» Then the king set out with his troops, passes by many lodging-places, and goes and reaches his own city, Constantinople. And after staying three years he sends away the son of the Abkhaz with many gifts; and he himself burns with a mortal sickness.

But since Constantine, his own brother and colleague in the kingship, was in the district of the Nicaeans, the king orders searchers to be sent for him, so that he should come to him with speed. But those who bore the orders gave assent in words, yet kept the king's orders hidden with themselves, for they did not wish that Constantine should reign. And when, after many peremptory messages, the emperor had come to know their cunning, he orders his attendants: "Bring me a horse." And he rose from his bed and sat upon the horse, and went out from the palace in the sight of the city. Seeing which, many, out of fear, went into their darkened houses and mourned. Then the searchers went out and brought Constantine there in haste; and when the king saw him he set the crown of the kingdom upon his head and established him king, and gave him charge — as David to Solomon — concerning the troublers of the kingdom, and concerning those who did not wish his reigning over them, that he should not keep them alive; yet not as David, saying, "You shall hunt him down on a pretext." And he himself drew his feet into his bed and failed; and after two days he was taken from among them; and he had reigned fifty years. But at his death also some sign of marvels was shown from heaven: at the evening hour in which he breathed out his spirit, the upper aether was cleft and a flash of fire suddenly fell forth, which — seen by absolutely everyone — foretells, they say, the king's death.

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The Reign of Constantine

After Basil there reigned Constantine, his own brother, four years. And since he was a peace-loving man, and generous, in the first year of his own reign he remained in quiet; and the land rested from its very great distress; and the princes who were governors of the districts, whom the great Basil had appointed, he confirmed in the same posts. But a certain Komianos — a brave man and a lover of war, whom the king's brother had set up as lord of the

district of Vaspurakan — this man showed great deeds of valour at the gate of the Persians, and became renowned throughout all the East; this man, at the king's death, having cast an evil counsel into his mind, becomes the confederate of Georgi, to reign in the East. This having become known to the Cappadocian troops, they banded together of one accord and came suddenly upon him, and cutting the cords of the tent they cast it down over him; and seizing him and his fellows in counsel, they put them in prison in a certain fortress, and made it known to the king. This happened in the first year of the reign of Constantine, in which the years of this era of ours were four hundred and seventy-five.

But the king, when he heard, brought no punishment upon him on the spot; but he forbore a whole year, until he had come thoroughly to know the matter. Then, when the second year came, he sent an executioner, who came and darkened his lamps, and those of the men with him, about eight in number. Which is greatly worthy of lamentation — how such an honourable man, worthy also of good remembrance, was led astray and fell from his senses; for it was he who brought Archesh with its estates under the hand of the Romans.

But when the second year came, the king sends to the East, as overseer of the land, a certain Nikit, a eunuch, who comes and passes over into the district of the Georgians; and with deceitful words, having driven many of the azats of the land out of their patrimonies, he sends them to the court of the king. Seeing them, and rejoicing, he honours them with great gifts and with a princely seat, and gives them, according to their deserts, villages and towns, by writing and by signet, as an inheritance for ever. But when the third year came in, Simovn the eunuch goes out to the East with many troops — he who held the authority of half the kingdom, which in the Greek tongue they call parekimanos; who comes and passes over into the land of the Georgians. But he did not have time to accomplish any business, for the evil tidings of the king's death came after him; and when he heard it, without delay he turned back and went with his troops to Constantinople.

How Romanus Reigned

For Basil, mighty among kings and always victorious in battles, who trampled many lands under foot, had no leisure from his manly deeds of valour to take a wife and to raise up sons as heir to the kingship, as is the custom of all kings. After him the aforesaid Constantine, his own brother, succeeds to the kingship. And since he too had no son, but there were two daughters, he gives Zoe, the firstborn, in marriage to Romanus — who was one of the officers of the Roman forces — and makes him king in his own place; and he himself, by death, hastens after all the earth-born.

This man, in the first year of his own reign, musters an army and makes his way toward the regions of the Antiochenes; and he intended to march against the city that is called Halp, to take it and lay it waste. And on his coming he meets with the mountain that is called Seaw, and sees there a multitude of monasteries and the hermitages of solitaries, who, being in the body, bore the likeness of the bodiless ones. They are content with a single goatskin or coat, bearing the likeness of John; except only that he was fed with locusts and wild honey, whereas these take an iron mattock in hand and labour to weariness at the sowing of barley, preparing the food that sustains their day. But the various delicacies and the sweet dishes, together with the gladdening wine that the vines of the vineyards pour out — all these they have left to the lovers of the world. Raised to the summit of the mountain, and fellows in the assembly of the foremost prophet, they speak with God continually.

When the king saw them, he asked his men of rank: "What is that multitude of heretics?" And they say: "These are all flocks of men of prayer, who make petition continually for the peace of the world and for the health of your lives." The king, giving answer, says: "I have no need of their prayers; rather, carry off archers out of all the monasteries into the service of this my kingship." For he had unreservedly given his assent to the Chalcedonian definition, being hateful

to every orthodox faith. He also, having brought the bishop of the Syrians to Constantinople and made him a mockery and a laughing-stock, orders his beard to be shorn, and that he be set upon an ass and led round through the squares and through the streets, and that he be spat upon; and afterwards he ordered him to be taken away to the mines, where indeed he died. Such a raw-minded man was the king, who did not bring to mind the former kings, how they showed protecting care toward the nations they held under their hand; but by a command of his own will he wished to make innovations in the churches of God, not remembering the Lord's unerring command, that «Everyone who is dashed against this stone shall be broken to pieces; and on whomever it falls, it shall scatter him.» Wherefore the well-deserved judgements of God come upon him from close at hand. For on that very road a force came out from among the Tajiks, not more than eight hundred or a thousand men, and falling upon the myriad multitudes they made slaughter beyond measure; and taking as plunder the treasures of the king and of the troops, they returned to their own city.

But the king, become a fugitive with great dishonour, falls at his horse's headlong rush into the city of his kingship. Then, brought low from his fierce arrogance, he was able to bring to mind the word of the Davidic song which says, «It is good to hope in the Lord and in the prayers of the saints, rather than to hope in princes and in the abundance of treasures»; for riches are of no help in the day of wrath. And from that time and thereafter he no longer went out from the city of the royal seat until the day of his death.



The Capture of the City of Urhay

The man who was prince of the city — whom they themselves called amir, and who held the inheritance of the place from his forebears — died without a son.

And his wife loved one of her own servants, whose name was Salamay, out of a lustful craving, and installed him as lord of the city in her husband's place.

But he, in fear of the leading men of the city, that they would not submit to him, sends one of his trusted servants to Maniak — who at that time held authority on the frontiers of the district of the Romans, and who resided in the city called Samosata, which they say was built of old by Samson — so that he might make it known to the king, and the king give him authority and an inheritance in perpetuity, in writing and with the royal ring, within the land of the Romans. And I, he says, will give this city into his hands without a battle. When king Romanus heard this, he writes him a letter of consent, and makes him anthypatos patrikios, and honours his wife with great and conspicuous honour.

But the townspeople, when they heard the sound of the outcry and the blast of the trumpets, panic-stricken and full of trembling, kept coming out of doors terrified and in turmoil, and heaped up like the waves of the sea, they poured over one another. And when they could not make out how the matter would end, those of them who were accustomed to the Muhammadan law went out by night and made their way to the nearby cities, telling them of the sudden urgency of the crisis that had come upon them. But when those men heard, a call was given, and multitudes of troops assembled in one place; and coming up against the city they breached its wall, and having got inside they went on making great slaughter. Whereupon many from the city went up into the great cathedral and took refuge there, and others in strong places or in towers. But the besiegers ruined many places with fire, until they cast fire into the holy cathedral itself. And having opened the treasures of the house of the sanctuary — which the former kings of Armenia had laid up to serve the needs of the Lord's temple — and having carried everything off in great haste, they went away to their own places. And from that day to this the city has been brought into subjection by the hand of the Romans.



The Death of Romanus

But the king, having been worthy of no good remembrance, on the great Thursday came forth in the palace and was speaking in public with his troops, until at midday he gave out the royally bestowed gifts, each according to his authority. And then, being free of the business, he gives orders that water be prepared in a golden basin for him to bathe. And when he had entered the golden pool filled with warm water, the attendants laid hold of the hair of his head and covered him under the water until he was finished out of life, the queen consenting to what was done. He had held the kingship seven years.



The Reign of Michael

Daniel, in that prophecy of his which he saw — whose head was of gold, and whose back and hands were of silver, but whose middle and sides were of bronze: these have passed away. But the legs and the feet of iron mingled with clay — that is the kingdom of the Romans; for it is not carried on by descent, as among other nations a king and a king's son are. He who holds the rule from his fathers and forefathers, that is the iron; but the newcomer, who is not of the royal line, that is the clay. And this happens often among them, as we see even now in this king set before us. He was not of the royal line, nor a king's son, nor by office one of the illustrious officers; but an obscure man among the servants of the palace, for whom the queen conceived a passion with the raging sickness of a harlot, and on his account she had her husband drowned — and they say that this man too was one of the killers. Then, after the satanic deed had been brought to its head, the queen orders the chief men of the city to be called to

her. And she shows the king dead, giving out that he had died suddenly; and then, hard upon it, bringing forward this Michael she makes him king, taking him as her husband — whose deeds became plain to all. Since he had many kinsmen and brothers, he gave the highest authority into their hands. One of the brothers he makes magistros, and gives Thessalonica into his hands, and entrusts to him the lands of the Bulgars and of the western parts; and another he names demeslikos, and sends him to great Antioch, committing to him the charge of Tachkastan and of the southern part. But the third of the brothers, who was a eunuch and a monk, whose name was called Ort'anoros, he establishes in the royal city Constantinople, making him sinklitos, and giving all the charge and the rights of the palace into his hands.

And he himself, since he was grievously smitten by a demon, would run even to the churches and to the resting-places of the saints; but I do not know whether this was vengeance for the death of Romanus, who died unjustly, or whether he had the demon-possession from birth. But they give another reason too: that because the kingship had not fallen to him, he went for that reason to the city of the Thessalonians, to a certain woman, a sorceress — as of old in Basil's day the young man's deeds are told, wrought through the sorcerer — giving himself into the service of the father of all evils. And the queen, inflamed through the demon of whoredom, took him and set him up as king over the lands. But after the deed had been brought to its head, when by the custom of kings he went of necessity to the churches at the feasts of the Lord, the evil demon could not endure it, reckoning him a rebel against itself. And they confirm this by saying that the king often stayed at Thessalonica, where they supposed him to be with the sorceress. But whether it was in this way or in that, still to the very end the spirit that tormented him did not depart from him.

In his reign there was a great slaughter of the Roman troops at the fortress-town which is called Berkri, which lies in the district of the land of the Artsrunis, and which the Persians had seized long ago together with its estates, and held under their hand. Against it came a certain Kawasilas, who was governor of Vaspurakan, with a great force; he took the city and stationed troops of horsemen as a guard for the city. Then another man succeeded to his command,

and taking the rest of the troops he went and halted farther off, at a certain place which is called Ardzak, because of the abundance of fodder and of the other needs of the horsemen. But the lord of the city, whose name was called Khtrik, being shut up in the fortress, sends word to the chief men of the land of the Persians. And they, suddenly passing word to one another, gathered into one place, and coming upon the city they besieged it with a siege-work. But the Roman troops, sunk in dissolute doings and in wine, could not keep guard over themselves. Moreover the Keeper of Israel withdrew his help from them; and setting the sword upon them they cut down about twenty-four thousand men. And this came about not for the righteousness of the Persians, but for the lawlessness of our own troops, who were struck by the sword of bitterness according to the word of the Lord: «He will destroy the wicked with evil.» But the troops that were at Ardzak did not come in time to help them. And the Persian troops, taking the spoil and the plunder of the slain, went off to their own land. But on the road, since they had many prisoners, Khtrik gives orders at the halting-place that the ground be dug out to the measure of a body, and that the bound men be slaughtered over the pit until it was actually full; and he went in and washed himself in the blood of the slain, to give rest to the fury of his heart.

But at the coming of the second year, other troops again were sent by the king; and they, coming and setting up engines and mangonels, began to bring down the wall of the fortress. And those who were in the fortress, seeing that there was no means of deliverance for them — for many of them had actually died — begged the commanders to let them go without harm to their own land, and that they themselves should hold the stronghold and its estates. And when they heard this, they did as they had learned; and from that day and thereafter the dominion of the Persians was taken away from that place.

At the beginning of his reign the sun was darkened, in the month of Arats, on the day of Friday, at the turning of the day; and it was the four hundred and eighty-second year of our era. Seeing which, many of the learned supposed that day to be the birth of the Antichrist, or else a foretoken of very great evils. And so indeed it came about, in our own days, into which the narrative of my

account leads and carries us: the blows of God's wrath which we saw with our own eyes, and the strange chastisement which came upon this house of the Armenians for our sins. Moreover, in an earlier time, yet another great sign appeared, which brought great amazement to those who saw it; and it was like the signs of the last destruction of Jerusalem, of which the Savior said in warning: «Those days shall be days of tribulation such as have not been under heaven since the beginning of the creation, and let there be no other.» — in return for this, that they raged against their Lord and Creator, supposing him a man. A man named Ananias, taking his stand in the middle of the city of Jerusalem, would take up a lament with a loud cry and say: "Woe, Jerusalem! Woe, city of blood! The days of your vengeance have come" — and the rest besides, which the great Eusebius sets down in the Ecclesiastical History. So too here in our own time, like that man, a certain man unknown to all, without kin, without a place, came out from the eastern parts, passed through Apahunik' and through the district of Hark', went down into Mananaghi and to Ekegheats' with a journeying that never turned back, and took these words into his mouth and said them without ceasing by day and by night, in a loud voice: "Alas for me! Alas for me!" — and he said nothing more at all. And if anyone asked him, "From where, or from what district are you? Or why do you say that?" he gave no answer at all, but said the same thing continually and did not cease from saying it. Seeing which, senseless men took him to have fallen out of his mind; but the wise said: "That *alas* of yours is to be for the whole land." Now let the account come to a stand here; and let us turn back to the order of our history, to the king spoken of before.

He names his sister's son caesar; and having lived seven years and eight months in the kingship, he falls sick and burns with the sleep of death. But the queen, having made the caesar her adopted son, makes him king in the place of her husband; yet he, instead of showing her thanks for the good things the queen had done him, took counsel with his kinsmen to send the queen away into exile to islands far off, so that the rule should be their own — which they actually did. But the queen's sister, whose name was known as Theodora, calls the chief men of the city and makes known to them what had happened. And when they

heard, they passed word to the western troops and gathered them to themselves. And coming upon him by force, they demanded, "Show us our queen glorious in the purple, who from fathers and forefathers holds the inheritance of that kingship of yours" — for many supposed that she was in fact dead. But when he saw their violence and their concert, he was afraid and gave orders that the queen be brought back in haste from the place of exile. And when Theodora saw her sister, she at once gives orders to seize the king together with their kinsmen and those who were their intimates. But the king, become a fugitive, wished to enter the great church and to hide beneath the altar and by that be saved. But he was not able to reach it; for the pursuers came up in haste and seized him and brought him back, and in an unhallowed place they threw him to the ground and darkened the lamps of his eyes, and of him who was called demeslikos, and of many others besides; and she gives orders that their houses be turned to plunder, to devastation, to ruin. At this the whole city was stirred up, and they made many plunderings; and the great and beautiful mansions they pulled down to their foundations and turned to ruin. And so heavy did the rioting mob become, inflamed for plunder, that they breached the wall of the palace and dug out many treasures from the royal treasuries; and the chief men of the city could hardly bring the mob to a stop, the sun helping them by gathering its rays into itself.

But the king who yesterday sat upon the golden throne and gave orders to the whole world, today, darkened out of the light, sits upon the seat of vanity and reproach; and those who supposed they would rule sea and dry land for ever, in a single moment lost the saving even of their own selves. And they became, indeed, as the prophet has it, like grass upon the housetops, which withered before ever it came into the hand; from which the reaper's hand was not filled, nor were the bosoms of the sheaf-bearers filled; and the blessing of the passers-by did not drop into the ears. These are the daily records of the caesar, who reigned six months.

The Reign of Constantine Son of Theodos, Who Is Called Monomachos

And this man too, by the prophet's vision, is of the portion that is clay; for his father held in the palace the dignity of the *zgayiosut'iwn*, from which all the judges of the realm are sent out. After the unfinished reign of the caesar, the lioness roared over her mate in her lair; for no small perplexities besieged and held her, since she had no one of her own worthy of the kingship; and the one she had taken as an adopted son, and had made lord and king of lands, had paid her back that recompense which we set down a little while ago. And what then does she do? She goes outside the canonical ordinances, and calls this man forward and makes him her husband, and seats him upon the throne of the kingdom. Many supposed him to be her paramour; but I do not know whether it is so or otherwise, since she herself had written in her own edict, as a benefaction to the realm: For the peace of the realm I did not spare myself, and for that reason I made bold to an unworthy deed.

In his first year the son Maniak rebelled, who held the western part, a brave and renowned man, and he brought many into league with him. And coming with many troops as far as the gate of the royal city, he so prevailed over it by the strength of his valour that many gave themselves over to him in submission with unwilling will; for they supposed him to be king, because of the many advantages that were falling to him. For twice and three times the king's forces went out and gave him battle, and being beaten by him they came back to the king in great dishonour. But at the coming of the last battle, upon which the minds of all were set — since after those victories all had submitted to him, and were to make him king — yet because he did not purpose to reign with God, but took refuge in the strength of his own might, sick from afar with Absalom's sickness, drunk with arrogance — for that reason he paid the very penalty that was Absalom's. In the middle of the battle line they found him fallen, his soul

given over to a mighty angel, with no one having met him face to face. This the Lord and Creator of all has done and does in all wisdom — he who is able to gather in the spirits of princes, being more terrible than all the kings of the earth; for «Let not the mighty man boast in his might, nor the great man in his greatness, nor yet the wise man in his wisdom» — as we have heard from the scriptures — «but let him who boasts boast in the Lord, and let him do judgement and work righteousness upon the face of the earth.» Such a one is indeed worthy of much boasting and praise, and his memory stands and abides for ever, and «his horn shall be lifted high in glory,» as it is written there in the psalter. Such was great David also, who, though he was anointed king by the seer and with the anointing received a spirit of power and of prophecy — who laid hold of the wild beasts and tore them apart like the kids of goats, and, trusting in these, took the field against the unconquerable giant, and shattering his skull with a sling-stone cast him to the ground, taking away the reproach from Israel — yet, though often persecuted by Saul, he forbore and waited on the command of him who had called him: not only did he not seek to seize the kingdom by force, but when his persecutor twice fell into his hands he spared him as though he were a benefactor; and to the man who wished to kill him he said in rebuke: «Do not lay your hand upon him, for he is the Lord's anointed.» Therefore God, being pleased with his will, said: «I have found a man after my own heart, who shall do what pleases me.» But this man brought nothing of the kind to mind, and did not wait on God's command; but wished to reign of himself, without God, forgetting the divine word which through the prophet said, reproaching the kings of Israel: «Woe to them, for they willed to reign, and not by me» — and the rest besides.

Now it is not that this king is worthy of any praise, and that God had compassion on him for that reason: rather, he honours the throne, and dams up the spring of arrogance — as the Savior said to the Jews when he taught: «On Moses' seat sit the scribes and the Pharisees.» Though these were themselves hypocrites, yet for the seat's sake he commands men to be obedient. Whence great Paul also, instructing with that blessed voice, writes to the Romans: «Let every soul,» he says, «that is under authority stand in obedience; for authority is

from nowhere except from God.» He does not speak of the prince but of the authority — that is, of the seat; for it is not that God raises up every prince. And he added: «He who resists the authority resists God's ordinance; and they who resist receive judgement upon themselves» — as indeed befell this man. For he was judged by no man, but by the just judgements of God, who judges everything by weight and by right; for his eye is wakeful, and our hidden things are open before his all-seeing knowledge. As the blessed David, psalming, confesses to God: «You have known my last and my first.» Like this the Apostle too writes to the Hebrews: «There is no creature unseen before his face.» This the youths in the furnace also said in praise: «You who sit upon the cherubim and look upon the deeps, you are praised and exalted above all for ever.» For by the height of the place they made plain the exactness of his knowledge, according to the psalmist's songs: «The Lord looked down from heaven upon the earth.» In this manner the lofty Isaiah also: «The eyes of the Lord are on high, and man is afflicted; and the loftiness of the arrogant shall be brought low, and the Lord alone shall be exalted in judgement and in righteousness, and the Holy One shall be glorified.» These things happened at the beginning of the reign of Constantine, in which the years of this era of ours were four hundred and ninety.

But after three years the end of the life of this house of Armenia came; for in one year their term here below was finished, and both the true brothers Ashot and Yovhannes were taken out of life, who held the kingship of this land of ours. In that year the throne of their establishment was shaken, and it never again stood firm; in that year the princes went out from their ancestral inheritance and became sojourners in a foreign land; in that year the districts were laid waste and went as plunder to the house of the Greeks. The settled towns became a dwelling for beasts, and their fields a pasture for wild beasts. Desirable houses, high-roofed and great, became dwellings for *hambars* and *yushkaparks* — the thing the holy prophets lament when they lament the desolating of Israel: «There the hedgehog brought forth her young and reared her offspring without fear.» The solemn places of the monasteries became caves of brigands; and the churches within them likewise — churches which bore the likeness of heaven

for their shining fabric, and for their ornaments of splendid state, and for the burning of unquenchable lamps and torches — whose vigour of light, spreading through the air and swaying this way and that, bore the likeness of the waves of the sea, when in calm seasons, under a sweet-breathing air, the ripples of the swell fold ridge upon ridge one over another; and the vapours of the sweet-smelling incense, wrought by the fire in proportion to the abundance of the offerings, present the pattern of the mists of the spring season, which settle upon the mountain-tops and hold back the rays of the sun. And as for those who dwelt in them, what words would suffice to tell the manner of it — the sweet-voicedness of the singing and the unceasing psalmody, the readings of the divine scriptures, the solemnity of the feasts of the Lord and the honours of the martyrs, the will of men who take counsel with one mind, and their straining toward the things of God, and whatever else besides.

Now those that were such, and so many, in the former time may now be seen empty and void of everything, stripped and plundered of all their good glory. In place of the sweet-voiced singing, owls and screech-owls are now the precentors; and in place of the psalm-melodies, the turtle-dove and the dove sing there, calling their young with sweet voices, as the prophet has it. The torches are quenched, and the fragrance of the sweet-smelling incense is spent; and the table of the holy mystery, which once was adorned with exquisite ornament like a new bride in the bridal chamber, wearing a crown of glory upon its face, may now be seen — a pitiable sight, and worthy of many tears — stripped of its ornaments, filled with dust, become a lodging for ravens. All these things need a long discourse to tell, and the help of the grace from above besides, that we may be able to aim straight at the mark of this account. Now we must carry this account back from the last things to the first.

When the great Constantine fell sick with the sickness of which he indeed died, he gives command to those who stood near him: Go out and seek some man from Armenia, whomever you may find, and bring him here. And the searchers went out and found a certain priest named Kiwrakos, who was the guest-master of the catholicosate, and brought him before the king; and the king, having seen him, gave him the letter that concerned the land of Armenia, and said: Carry

that writing and give it to the king of Armenia; and say: Since, like all who are born of earth, the summons of death has come to us also — take your writing, and give that kingdom of yours to your son, and your son to their sons, for ever. And he himself drew up his feet on his bed and died. But the man took the letter and kept it by him until the time of Michael's reign, and sold it to him, and got much treasure for it. Oh, that bitter sale! For how much blood did he make himself a debtor! How many churches were laid waste by that sale! How many districts turned manless and desolate! How many great-seated towns were emptied of their inhabitants! But let us tell the whole of it in its own place; and let us carry forward the order of this account as we began it.

Now when the report of the kings' death reached the hearing of the emperor of the Romans, and he had found the writing of the Armenian letter, he took thought to seize the city of Ani and the land, as though it were his own proper inheritance. But a certain one of the chief azats of Armenia, Sargis by name, put upon himself the pomp of reigning over the house of Shirak and the districts that lie round about it; for he had found all the treasures in the house of King Yovhannes and gathered them to himself, since at his death it was he who had charge of him. But Vahram, a mighty and renowned man, and in piety exceedingly lofty, so that no one was his equal — Pahlaw — together with his kinsmen, with sons and with nephews, some thirty azats, did not make common cause with him; rather, calling to themselves Gagik son of Ashot, they made him king over themselves, and by wisdom and by contrivance brought him into the city.

But when Sargis saw what had happened, he took the treasures of the kingdom and enters the inner stronghold, the citadel of Ani. But Gagik, with manly boldness of heart, went down to him alone, and with coaxing words wins him over; and he came out of the fortress and goes to the fortress-town that is called Surmari; yet he does not give the stronghold into Gagik's hands, nor the other strongholds that he held under his hand; and having gone there he plots once more a worthless plot: to put what he held under the hand of the Romans, and to go over to them. But Gagik went with a few men and enters into the middle of the camp, into the tent where Sargis was, and having seized him he enters the

city of his kingdom. And whereas he ought to have taken the rebel out of life, he took Saul's counsel: sparing this second Agag, he would seat him beside him in his chariot. For that reason he received Saul's requital — a life more bitter than death.

In those days the forces of the Romans pressed on, and four times one after another they entered the land of Armenia, until they had emptied the whole country of men with sword and with fire and with captivity. When I bring the tokens of those evils to mind, my soul goes senseless and my wits are stunned; and my hands, taken with trembling at the dreadful horror of it, cannot carry the course of these lines forward — for this account is bitter, and worthy of many laments.

A land which once upon a time showed itself to those who passed by like a garden set thick with plantings before it — green and lovely, full of leaf, fruit-bearing, of splendid state, and happy; for princes sat upon the princely throne with glad-looking faces, and the troops, bearing the likeness of the flower-gardens that the spring brings, stood before them in colour upon colour, and there were assemblies for nothing but songs and words of gladness; where too the sounds of trumpets and of cymbals and of the other arts of song filled the souls of those who heard them with joyful gladness. There the elders too sat in the squares, flourishing with grave and honourable grey hairs; and mothers too, taking their children into their arms, their inward parts wrung with a mother's tenderness, forgot for the abundance of their joys the sorrowful hours of their travail, fluttering continually over their new-fledged young after the manner of doves. And what shall I say of the brides in the chamber, and of the bridegrooms in the bridal bower — the kindling of their love-rich longings, and the leaning of a nature that will not be held in? But we must carry our discourse higher still, to the patriarchal throne and to the royal dignity. For the one, thickened like a cloud with the gifts of the Spirit, dropped down the dew of life through the grace of the vardapet's teaching; and the garden of the Church, made fat by it, bore fruit, while he set those ordained by him as wakeful watchmen upon its walls. And the king, when he came out of the city in the morning hours — after the manner of a bridegroom who comes out of his bridal chamber, or as the

daylight morning star which, rising at the head of creation, draws all sight to itself — so he too glittered in his shimmering garments and his pearl-thronged crown, and drew every man to gazing and to wonder; and a white-maned charger too, running before him in gilded trappings, dazzled the sight of the beholders with the sun's rays that struck upon it. And the multitude of the troops ran thronging before him, heaping themselves one upon another after the manner of the waves of the sea. The desert places too were full and crowded with companies of monks, so that in a good rivalry they laid hold even of villages and farmsteads and made them dwellings for monks. This, and what is like to this, our land had in abundance. And I have written it so that when I tell the contrary of these things I may move all men to tears.

Now the king has fallen from his honour and sits like a captive prisoner in a far-off place; and so too the patriarchal throne, made desolate of its occupant, shows a mournful face, like a newly wedded woman left in widowhood. The horsemen wander without a lord — one man among the Persians, one among the Greeks, one among the Georgians. The noble troop of the azats has gone out from its ancestral lands, fallen from its abundance, and wherever they are they roar like lions' whelps in their lairs. The royal palaces are a ruin and manless. The land that men inhabited is empty of its inhabitants. No voice of gladness is heard at the vintage of the vineyards, and no blessing among the treaders of the winepress. Children do not play before their parents, and the elders do not sit in state in the squares. No voice of weddings is heard, and the curtains of the bridal house are not adorned. All this has failed and perished, and «it shall not rise again,» according to the psalmist's voice. Now everything has been turned to lamentation for us, and that robe of gladness has been turned into the dark garment of sackcloth. Oh, what ears could bear the telling of this wretchedness of ours! Oh, what heart of stone would not give way with sighing and break with sobbing! It is time for me to mingle some of Jeremiah's laments with our sighing: «The ways of Zion,» he says, «mourn, because there is no one who comes in.» These things were said then, at the desolation of Jerusalem; but they have been fulfilled now.

Now all this befell the Armenians out of that sale which we mentioned a little while ago. This sale seems to me more inhuman than Judas's; for there, though the seller lies under reproach, yet the thing sold became the price of the redemption of the whole world. As great Peter writes in the catholic epistles: «Not with things of gold,» he says, «or things of silver were you bought and set free from the vain observances your fathers handed down to you, but with the blood of the Son of God.» But here the seller is exceedingly hard and inhuman, for he made himself a debtor for evils so many: the vineyard which the Lord planted, and which our Illuminator tilled with his fifteen years of sweating labour — he pulled down its fence and threw down its towers and made it a thing trodden by passers-by, so that «the boar of the forest has ruined it, and the wild swine has fed upon it,» according to the songs of David. Now let the report of all these things reach the Lord, and let judgement upon him come from the Lord; and let us turn the course of this discourse back to our own matter.

Now in the four hundred and ninety-fourth year of the era Ani was taken — not by the law of war, but by deceiving speech; for by oath and by the cross they persuaded Gagik, at the king's command, saying: Only at the sight of you I shall give back to you that kingdom of yours, and I shall write you heir for ever of that land and that city of yours. And since the wise man swears and the witless man believes — as the sayings of the wise also report; and again, that the words of liars are fat as a quail, and the witless swallow them down. He believed, because of the oaths and the cross — whether out of the rawness of his mind or out of the God-fearing temper of his character, I do not know — and gave the key of the city to Petros, who at that time held the patriarchal throne of our Illuminator, and committed to him the whole charge of the land with a great compact and vow. And he did not abide by the charge of Vahram and of the other azats who had made him king, but listened to the prompting of the treacherous Sargis and went out from the city, and travelled to the Greeks on a journey of no return — like a fish caught on a hook, or like a bird taken in a snare. When the king had seen him he remembered neither the oaths nor the mediation of the cross, but detained him with himself, and kept demanding:

Give up Ani, and I shall give you Melitene in exchange, and the districts that lie round about it. But he would not accept.

And as this demand dragged on, Grigor, son of the brave Vasak, went out too and came before the king. And since he was a wise man, and deeply versed in the divine scriptures as no other was, when he saw that they were not going to let Gagik go back to his own place, he came forward and gives the key of Bjni to the king, and all his own ancestral inheritance; and being honoured by him he receives the dignity of the office of magistros, and places to dwell in within the bounds of Mesopotamia, villages and cities, by writing and by a golden ring, from generation to generation, for ever.

But the chief men of the city, who were seated in Ani, when they saw that Gagik was detained among the Greeks, took counsel — at one time to give the city to Dawit' of Dvin, since Dawit's sister was his wife; at another to Bagarat, the king of the Abkhaz. When the patriarch Petros saw such counsel — that, to whomever it might be, this city was going to go — he sends to the man who held the authority of the eastern part, who was seated in the city of Samosata, which they say was built of old by Samson, and writes: Make it known to the king — what will he pay us in exchange? — and I shall give this city and the other strongholds that are in this land. And when he heard it he made it known to the king with all speed; and the king, hearing it, satisfied his will with treasures and with authority, and by that means they became masters of Ani and of the whole land.

But Gagik remained unrequited with the king; and out of humanity he gave him places, such as he himself chose, which fell far short of the worth of Ani and of the rest of the land. The thanks and the gifts of the giving they paid to the catholicos, from whom they had taken the city. And Gagik, at the king's command, takes to himself as wife the daughter of Dawit' son of Senek'erim, and becomes master of his portion; for Dawit' had died having no other child to be his heir.

Now a certain prince named Asit, who had formerly held the lordship of the east — him too the king sends as his lieutenant over the city of Ani. He came

and honours the patriarch Petros with measureless honour, and brings the land into subjection under his hand; and he himself marches with many troops against the city of Dvin. But Apusuar, the lord of the city, gave him battle and works a measureless slaughter at the gate of the city; and in that place there died the great prince of the Armenians, Vahram, together with his son — which brought a great mourning upon the Armenians. And when Asit had lived in the lordship of Armenia, a certain Kamenas succeeds to his authority, in the four hundred and ninety-third year of this era of ours; and coming, he does not honour the patriarch according to the former honour. And he begins to accuse him in writing before the king, and by deceits he brings him out of the city, saying: The king has appointed you a place of dwelling in the district of Karin, in the town of Arcn. And the patriarch went out and comes to this great-seated and royal city of ours, and with great joy he filled the souls of those who saw him, who had longed for him. And the season was near to the feast of the holy Theophany; and when the great feast came he went down with a measureless multitude to the swift-running water that comes down from the mountains which are on the northern side of the plain, and there he performed the mystery of the day in glory, as indeed was fitting; but at the hour of the pouring of the Lord's oil into the water, a certain Tachik man came forward out of the crowd and asks to be baptized in the water. And he asked the reason for which he asked this, and learned from him that he desired to become a Christian, and commands him to go down into the water. But the bearer of the chrism, standing close by him, took the vial in his hand and, striking with his hand, broke the vial, pouring the oil abundantly over the newly baptized man and over the water; and a fragment of the glass struck and grievously wounded his hand, so that a flood of blood was poured out upon the ground. Seeing which, many put what had happened down to misgiving, saying: This is no sign of good — which indeed was fulfilled that very day. For while they were still at table at the dinner hour, captors arrived and took him, and carried him off and put him in the fortress that is called Khaghtoy Arich. And then they brought from Armenia his sister's son, Khachik by name, and put him in the fortress that is called Seaw K'ar; and they remained there until near Easter. And then they

brought them out from there and carried them to Constantinople before the king; for a certain eunuch, who held a dignity that was half the kingship, had earlier taken with him Anania, the elder brother of Khachik.

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Concerning the Slaughter That Took Place in the District of Basean and on the Mountain Called Smbat

In these same years the door of wrath was opened from heaven upon this land of ours; and many troops were set in motion out of T'urk'astan, whose horses were swift as eagles and their hooves firm as rock, their bows strung and their arrows sharpened, valiantly girded, and holding the latchets of their boots fast beyond loosing. And having come out into the district of Vaspurakan, they fell upon the Christians like hungry wolves that are never sated with food; and coming as far as the district of Basean, and as far as the great estate that is called Vagharshawan, they demolished and ruined twenty-four districts with sword and with fire and with captivity. This account is pitiful and worthy of much lamentation and many tears. Upon them they ran like lions, and like the whelps of lions they pitilessly flung down the corpses of the many as carrion for the beasts and for the birds of heaven; and they meant by that same enterprise to come to the city of Karin. But he who set a bound for the sea, saying, «Thus far shall you come, and no further shall you add, but there within you shall your waves be broken», cast a thick darkness before them and held them back from their course. This he does according to his own unutterable wisdom, so that we may be chastised by the fear of them, and they may learn that it was by no strength of their own that they did what they did; but the hand that mightily held them back, that same hand made the road for their going.

Now he poured out his wrath upon us by the hand of a foreign nation, because we had sinned against him; and again he repented of bringing his own evils upon us, for he is merciful — wherefore he is not angry to the uttermost, nor does he keep his grudge for ever. By the one he is constrained by us, bringing the just judgment into the midst, for he is a righteous judge; and by another he comes early to mercy, because he is the father of compassions; and by another he repents over our evils, since he is the God of mercies. So here too he showed us both: according to the vengeance we had earned he made his hand heavy upon us, and he turned again and swiftly made his wrath to pass by, that he might not destroy us utterly. But we fell sick with Pharaoh's hardness of heart, and with that of the utter fool among his own fellow-sufferers, who, being tormented at one time, makes confession and says, «This is the finger of God»; and when the punishment of wrath had passed by, drunk with arrogance he says, «I do not know the Lord, and I will not let Israel go» — until he drew upon himself the last punishment, and became a fellow-dweller of the abyssal deeps. But the wretch spoke well when he said that this is the finger of God; for the hand has its completeness for the work in ten fingers, just as there too, beginning from one, he finished the chastisement of the plagues at ten, and then let Israel go.

Now we, when the wrath was bared and the fire kindled and those murderous evils set in motion, were struck with terror at the fear of it, and greatly smitten with trembling we were appalled; but God had mercy, and with darkness he shut up their roads and checked the course of the raids of the lawless. The good became a thing of seeming to us, and in the matter of thanksgiving we were found no men at all. For whereas we ought, through the chastisement of our brothers, to have come to our senses, and to have made haste to go early to the prophet, and to have learned from him the chastisement that saves — «Cease», he says, «from your evils, and learn to do good», and the words that come after these — and by setting ourselves right to have reconciled God, and to have quenched the punishment that blazes like Gehenna, and to have brought the uplifted hand down from wrath to pardon: nay, all this passed into forgetfulness with us, and the knowledge of it never even dawned in our hearts. Rather, he who was of the lawless did lawlessly, and he who was of the unjust did unjustly,

until, after the fashion of wild boars, we drove ourselves upon the sword, bringing the whole of it upon ourselves. It seemed to us that they, being sinners, had borne the punishment, and that we had come off safe by our own righteousness; and there was no remembrance in us of the Lord's own charge, the chastisement that makes wise: «Those Galileans», he says, «whose blood Pilate mingled with their sacrifices — do you suppose that they were sinners above all men? No. But unless you repent, you shall all perish in the same way.» But we were as in the words of Amos, with which he reproached Israel — those who drank the strained wine, and took their ease with sweet ointments, and rested upon beds of ivory, and the rest besides, and grieved not for the breaking of Joseph. For God requires that, when he gives some over to torments, those near them should suffer along with them, according to that saying, «To weep with those who weep». But they did the very opposite: they were of one blood, and they did not grieve at the captivity of the line of Joseph; and for that cause the prophet set it to a song and laid accusation against them. So it fell out in our own case too.

For in the four hundred and ninety-seventh year of this era of ours, which was the second year of our captivity, the dregs of bitterness, full of wrath, were stirred once more out of the house of the Persians with a terrible surging, and coming on they poured out over the broad plain of Basean and Karin; and the spattering of that torrent took the four corners of the land: to the west, as far as the district of Khaghtik'; to the north, as far as Sper and as far as the strongholds of Tayk' and Arsharunik'; and to the south, as far as Taron and as far as the district of Hashtenk', as far as the forests of Khordzean. And having taken up its station it halted for fourteen days, and spreading like a sea it covered the mountains and the thicketed places and seized this land entire — which seems to me to have come to it out of that unmixed wine which the child Jeremiah, in his vision, poured with a golden cup and gave to drink to kings, to nations, to cities, to princes and to their troops; and after all of them he gave the house of Sisak to drink. Behold, the event is the manifest fulfilment of this prophecy. For this house of the Armenians drank of that unmixed wine and was made drunk with an evil drunkenness; it drank, and grew numb and senseless; it drank until it had

taken the whole of it into itself; and now it lies fallen at the crossings of every road, naked and shamed, and the passers-by of the roads trample it with reproaches. Gone out from its house, made a stranger to those who knew it, removed far from its household and its kinsfolk, a captive and a prisoner to all the nations.

It is time for me to utter that prophetic word: «What the caterpillar left the locust devoured, and what the locust left the young locust devoured, and what the young locust left the devouring worm devoured.» These too are mine, since in us all the words the prophets spoke beforehand have been fulfilled. Now that caterpillar and that locust have gone by; but the young locust and the devouring worm are these, concerning whom our discourse has been set out. For at the first time, when the Persians and the other barbarous heathen nations came out and with man-slaughtering butcheries ruined many districts, and having taken much plunder and many captives went down into their own land, they became bringers of good news to nations and to kingdoms; and giving them invitation they say, as in the prophet, «Beasts of the wilderness, come, devour this that is in the forest.» And when the next year came, countless multitudes of troops, bowmen and swordsmen, gathered like eagles over food; and with great cheering, haste upon haste, they came out into this land of ours in the month of September, on the feast of the Holy Cross, on a Wednesday.

Here this account of ours is one of lamentations and mournings, and the scenes of this account summon all men to beat the breast. For if the Ninevites, at the threats of the prophet — and that when a single person had entered the city, a man from a foreign land, unknown to them all, and without signs — were so struck with terror that from the king down to the one who sat at the hand-mill the beating of the breast was one and the same for them all, all of them clothed in sackcloth, all of them in dark garments, all of them cut off from food, and they forced their nature to be lavish in lamentation, and even called the women who lead the dirge to join their voices with their own: «Perhaps», he says, «God will repent, and his indignation will turn away from us» — how much more is our own case worthy of lamentation, where there were not threats only, but the punishment of wrath came and was carried through to its head, and we were

reviled and overthrown and made a spectacle to the world, of which the Apostle too takes up the word concerning the saints, and we have left an evil report behind us from generation to generation. For cities laid waste and houses burned, mansions turned into furnaces, and royally built halls turned to ashes. Men slaughtered in the public squares, and women gone out of their houses into captivity, and suckling children dashed against the stone, and the fair faces of youths withered. Virgins fallen into open shame in the public squares, and young men run through with the sword before the elders; the honourable grey hairs of old men gone amid blood and what is past enduring, and their corpses tumbling over and over. The swords of the enemy grown dull, and their hands failing of strength; the strings of their bows snapped, and the arrows spent out of their quivers; their own selves grown weary, and their hearts not come to mercy.

O that mercy of yours, God, who have borne so long with the lawless as they bluster over the flock of your pasture! Remember your people, which you acquired from the beginning by the coming of your only-begotten, and redeemed with the blood of your anointed one. Why have you cast us off utterly, God? You were angry in your indignation, and gave us over into the hands of lawless men, harsh and rebellious. Do not remember our sins, and do not turn your face away from us because of our sins; but remember your mighty hand and your uplifted arm, by which you were lord over us, and your name was called upon us. And now, behold, you were angry and we sinned; and for that cause we have gone astray in captivity among many nations, and have all become as unclean things. The winds have driven us away, and there is no one to call upon your name, or to remember to make you his refuge; for you have turned your face away from us and given us over because of our sins. Do not be angry with us for ever, and do not remember our sins even for a season.

Oh, and alas for the dawning of that day! For the light that on the first day came into being in bodiless form from the word of God, and on the fourth day, wrapped about with body, was divided into luminaries — becoming ruler of the day and of the night, and travellers of the world for ever, the one rousing man to his work and the other giving the beasts their liberty — today, at the noon of

that day, was changed for us into darkness and became night; and the heathen nation, beast-like, who from of old roared in their lairs, according to the prophet's word, and sought their food from the flocks of God, when that day became night for us, came out and spread over the face of the earth, and found much prey and were sated with food, and left leavings for their young for many years. Now although in every place prey enough was made ready for them — for the land was found before them like a garden of delight full of fruit — yet most of all in the district of Mananaghi, at the mountain that is called Smbatay Berd; for there a numberless multitude of fugitives had gathered, and of beasts there was no counting. The lawless came upon them and ruined its defences, and going inside they laid the sword upon them and slaughtered them all.

There was to be seen there a sight pitiable and worthy of much lamentation. Some of them, those who fell into their grip, they put to death by the sword; and those who fell into rocky places and made themselves secure there they pierced with arrows and killed; and, climbing above the cave, they crushed the heads of many of them with enormous stones, and the corpses of these, rolling head over heels and heaped one upon another like the piles of woodcutters, filled the ravine that lay below. Woe and alas for the very bitter light of that day! For the brave men, armed with weapons and boiling with fury, were mustering, and the cowards were fainting; the womanish were losing their wits and the young men were playing the bold; but they could find no way out of the business. For on every side the rampart of the enemy had shut them in. There was no love there for those they loved, nor any lament for friends; the father forgot his pity for his sons, and the mother her love for her new-born children. What newly wedded woman could remember there the love of her bridegroom? And no man called to mind the desirable beauty of his wife. The songs of the ministers failed from the mouths of the priests, and the voices of the psalms were cut off from the lips of the psalm-singers; trembling and fear took hold of them all alike. And out of the violent distress many women who were with child miscarried their infants; and by such a work, having snared the mountain as with a hunters' net the whole day long — until they gave out and failed of strength.

But when the evening came, they took the plunder and the captives and the spoil of the slain, and went from the place. And after their going out there was to be seen there a sight pitiable, and more pitiable than the first, and worthy of much lamentation. For the death-agonies were of many kinds. Some of the fallen were still alive in their souls, and their tongues dried up with thirst; with a narrow, thin voice they begged that relief for their thirst might be found, and there was no one to give it. Others were grievously wounded and failing of voice, and breathed heavily. And others, cut through the throat, being half dead, rattled with difficulty. And some, convulsed by their grievous wounds, kicked with their feet, and with the nails of their hands clawed the ground. But beside these there was yet another dreadful sight to see, one that would move even stones and the other breathless creatures to lamentation and groaning. For when the lawless brought the captives down from the mountain, they took the infants from the arms of their parents and threw them on the ground, so that from the multitude of them the whole place of their camp was seething. Some of those thrown down were dashed against the stone and died, and the flanks of others were torn open and their bowels poured out on the ground; but the screaming of the living — what ears could bear it? For those who were able to run on their feet went wandering here and there seeking their mothers, and at the loudness of their weeping the echoes of the mountain rang after them; and others, who were not yet steady on their feet, crawled on their knees and screamed; and those who were of a still more helpless age than these beat the ground with their feet, and, failing of voice from the crawling, could not bring out their breath. And with such pitiful voices and unceasing crying they bore the likeness of lambs which, newly parted from their dams, go in and out of the folds because their nature cannot endure it; and with ceaseless bleating they wounded the air and wearied the ears of those who heard.

These are your grievous histories, O mountain — a mountain not such as God was pleased to dwell in, but a mountain of blood, of trampling and of destruction. It is not possible to call you a mountain, but a pit of mire for the destruction of all the inhabitants of the land; for in you the wild beasts lodge, and the kites and the vultures have made their dwelling; in you the foxes go in

packs, frisking, filled with food. O mountain, you were not made fat, as Hermon was, by the dew of heaven dropping upon you, but by the fat and the blood of the corpses slaughtered upon you. O mountain, you were no mediator, as the Sinaitic one was, of Moses' speech with God; but you silenced many priests from the songs of the psalter, who by their prayers were always in converse with God. Elijah, in terror of death, a fugitive from Jezebel, took refuge on Horeb and was saved; but these, having made you their refuge, were delivered over to the sword and became the portions of foxes. O mountain, I see you as of one accord with the mountain of Gilboa, upon which the nobles of Israel fell. Wherefore it is time for me to repeat over you what David said concerning that one. Mountains of Smbat, let no rain fall upon you, nor dew; for you drank of the blood of the faithful, of the men and women who fell upon you. But let the account of the evil report concerning that mountain come to a stand, though out of much I have said but little. Here I shall turn the manner of this account's speech to our own case; and I mean, so far as my strength allows, to linger over the words, so that I may move the tears of all. I call also, along with Jeremiah, the women who raise the wail, that they may set the lamentation in order together with me; for I am not making my account of mountains and caves and desert places, into which the meanest of the fugitives went and dwelt.



Concerning the Merciless Slaughter of Arcn

But of a city — and of such a city as was magnificent and renowned among all the lands, like a city set upon a mountain, with sea and land travailing and lavish to bring their wealth to it, as the exalted Isaiah prophesied concerning Jerusalem — this one, at first, while it was crowned with the abundance of good things, had everything after its own mind. And it was like a young bride, who by the loveliness of her beauty and the brightness of her ornaments was desired by all.

For its princes were lovers of mankind, and its judges were just in judgment and declined all bribes. Its merchants were builders and adorners of the church, providers of lodging and rest for monks, and were merciful and provident toward the poor. There was no deceit in the marketplaces, and no fraud in the exchanges of commerce. The profits of usury and interest were held in reproach, and their offering, brought among the gifts of dedication, was despised and rejected. In all of them there was one zeal alone: for piety. Its priests were holy in life and devoted to prayer, obedient and submissive to the church's ministry. Wherefore its merchants were held in honor, and its rulers were as kings among the nations. And like some precious gem, radiant with a light-fair brilliance, this city of ours shone among all cities, altogether beautiful, wholly adorned.

But from the time when the Sextians and Pyrrhonists entered our churches, and the law of justice was turned to injustice, and the love of silver came to be esteemed above the love of God, and Mammon above Christ, then all the decency of order slipped and turned to disorder. Its princes became confederates of thieves, doers of violence, and servants of silver; its judges were bribe-takers, and for a bribe they stole away justice. They gave no judgment for orphans, and did not incline themselves to the cause of widows. Laws of usury and interest were set up, and the manifold profiteering in wheat, by which the earth is defiled and its womb withholds the giving of its fruit in its season for the food of mankind. He who deceived his neighbor boasted of being wise, and he who plundered said, "I am mighty." The houses of the companionless poor, and the boundary-lines of their fields, the rich seized, and the God-commanded curses written by the hand of Moses, the servant of the Lord, did not fall upon their ears — «Cursed,» he says, «is he who seizes the field of his neighbor.» Or that which the exalted Isaiah, having raised his cry, rebukes such as these with: «Woe,» he says, «to those who join house to house and bring field near to field, that they may drive out their neighbor. Behold, all this has come as a report into the ears of the Lord of hosts» — and as for the rest of it, I pass over it in silence, sparing you. The vineyard of Naboth was not in their remembrance, nor Jezebel who seized it — what she suffered for it, a thing that even to this day rings like a trumpet in the ears of all. From the priests too, fear was taken away, and the

discernment of holiness; they press and crowd to draw near to the altar and to minister the ineffable mystery, which is fearful even to the angels, let alone to men — and that by the power of silver, and not by God. And the psalm that says was given over to oblivion: «Let those be despised who are chosen by silver.»

What shall I say concerning the accusation that touches women? What was said by Isaiah is enough; it has no need of my words. For he thus rebukes the women of Jerusalem for their finery-loving wantonness: «Because,» he says, «the daughters of Zion are proud, and go about with necks outstretched.» First he takes hold of the root of all evils — I mean pride — for it is the mother and origin of all evils; it makes demons out of men, and makes them partakers of their torments. Now this passion is evil for everyone, but far more for the race of women. For this reason he judges them first, and then, setting them out in order, recalls the trains that drag along the ground, the anklets, the rings, the bracelets, the veils, the mantles, and all the rest. See, O hearer, their recompense as well: «Instead,» he says, «of ornaments of gold, baldness of the head.» For, stripping the head of its ornaments, they cut off their hair, making a mockery of them. «Instead of girdles of gold, a rope for a belt; and instead of precious garments,» he says, «they shall be clothed in sackcloth.» For when they were made ready for captivity, their captors granted them just that.

It was not for nothing that I have gone through all this, but that I might show that, just as our own transgressions match theirs in kind, so it was fitting that we too should receive chastisement to match — and all the more. For if they suffered that without any example before them, how could ours not be worthy of far greater punishment — after having had them as our example, and the teaching of Christ as well, who cries out and says: «If your righteousness does not exceed that of the scribes and the Pharisees, you shall not enter the kingdom of heaven.» And we are found wanting not in righteousness alone, but we are found even more abounding in sins — and what pardon of forgiveness can we have?

Now see the well-measured and fitting recompense. The Persians rose up against Jerusalem, and they rose up against us too; Jerusalem was laid waste, and our

cities were laid waste too. The heathen nations entered the holy temple, and carried off its ornaments as plunder, and defiled the holy temple; they entered our churches too, and made bold to go where none should enter, and defiled its holy things with unclean footsteps, and made spoil and plunder of its ornaments. The holy temple was burned; and among us, instead of a single house, many churches were burned, and their priests fell by the sword beyond number — and as for ours, who can give the count? It is time for me to pass into the words of David, and with his own voice to shape our lament: «Why, O Lord, have you stood far off, and paid no heed to us in our affliction?» — while the unjust one acts lawlessly against your holy things, and those who hate you boast in the midst of your feasts; for behold, the heathen nations have entered your inheritance, and have defiled your holy temple; they have burned your holy things with fire, and brought down to the ground the glory of your church; they have poured out the blood of your servants like water — not, as then, around Jerusalem only, but this whole land of ours was filled with the blood of the slain. And as for the count of the dead to be buried, who could so much as call it to mind?

But as for the many-sided and unbearable evils of our city, who could set them down in writing? For as it is written concerning the Sodomites, that «the sun rose upon the earth, and the Lord rained fire and brimstone upon Sodom, and burned it» — in the same way here too, at sunrise, hordes came upon the lawless like ravenous dogs, and surrounded the city, and went in like reapers into a field of grain, and, setting each man's sword to it, they reaped until the city was severed from the living. But those who had fled into houses or churches, they struck with fire and burned mercilessly, thinking the deed a good work — as the Savior had foretold, saying, «The time will come when everyone who kills you will think he offers service to God» — and he himself makes plain the reason: «And these things they will do to you for my name's sake, because they have not known me.»

The very air too lent a hand on that day of ruin, for a violent wind blew and fanned the fire into a blaze, until the smoke towered up and reached the sky, and the showers of sparks from the fire's light outshone the rays of the sun. There

was a sight to be seen, piteous and utterly terrible; for the whole city was full of the corpses of the fallen — the market streets, the narrow lanes, and the broad halls alike. And as for those who were burned, who could give their number? — for those who fled from the flash of the sword and hid themselves away in houses, all of them were burned to nothing. And the priests, whom they seized in the churches, they consumed with fire; and those outside, some they killed, and, laying a great swine-carcass in their arms, made it a reproach to us and a mockery and derision to those who saw. And as for the number of priests who perished by sword and by fire, we found it more than a hundred and fifty — men who held a parish and a church of their own. But as for those who had come in from elsewhere, and those from every land round about who happened to be there, who can give their number?

These are your grievous histories, O city, happy and blessed, sated with abundance, renowned among the lands. Now lift up your eyes, and see your sons driven off into captivity, your little ones mercilessly dashed against the stone, your young men burned with fire. Old men of great dignity and glory, fallen in the marketplace; delicately-reared and well-nurtured virgins and women, fallen into disgrace, and driven on foot into captivity. In us the songs of David's laments have found their fulfillment: «He gave over,» they say, «their strength into captivity, and their villages into the hands of their enemies» — and the rest that follows; but Christ delays his awakening, not as he did then.

But let this sorrowful account concerning Arcn come to its close here, for we have not been able to set down in writing every one of these evil events; what we have left out, let the inquirer learn from the ruins themselves. These are the pitiable histories of two places — the mountain, and this city — what we saw with our own eyes, and passed through in the trial of these evils, that alone have we written; but as for the calamities that befell the other districts and cities, whose mind could take in the whole of it? Those would need a long account, and time; we, according to our own strength, have made our own account short.

Concerning the Great Battle That Took Place in the Plain of Basean, in Which the Romans Were Defeated

The prophet Isaiah, when he prophesied the devastation of the Egyptians, said this, saying: «The princes of Zoan have grown foolish, who were the wise counselors of the king» — and this too has befallen us. For the cavalry forces of the Romans, guarding the land in the east, were not few — they say the number of the army was as much as sixty thousand. Their leaders were Kamenas — whose name is interpreted "fire" — who held the lordship of the House of the Armenians; and Aharon, son of the Bulgarian, who held the region of Vaspurakan; and Grigor, the mighty prince of the Armenians, who held the dignity of the office of magistros. And since the scriptures say that a multitude of rulers is a tumult, unfitting and near to ruin — this too befell them. For it was fitting that, with one accord and a single mind, they should call upon the Lord God, the giver of victory in battle, for help, as was the custom of those who conquered before: «For it is not by his own strength that the mighty man grows strong, but the Lord strips away the strength of the adversary.» But they did not think in this way; rather, whoever among them was disposed to lawlessness acted lawlessly, and they imagined, by human cunning, that they could quench the kindling of the insatiable fire. For this reason, falling into wavering indecision, they would not be persuaded by one another's counsels; for God had taken wisdom away from their counsels, because they had not sought Him. And this is plain from their deeds: they sought Liparit to come to their aid, like Saul, when afflicted, running to the witch; or like the Jews, who, loading their treasures upon camels, carried them to a nation in which there was no hope of help. And they did not call to mind David, who stood against the hill of flesh — which with great arrogance was reproaching Israel — for whom one sling-stone alone was enough to shatter the casing of its brain; or Hezekiah, who by prayer alone

hunted down into the earth, by the hand of the angel, with an invisible sword, the hundred and eighty thousand of the Assyrians.

Now Liparit came, with many entreaties and with lavishly-given gifts of treasure, and nothing was accomplished by it, for they themselves were not even of one mind with one another. For this reason, when the battle was joined, the son of the Bulgarian, turning his own men back to the rear, gave boldness to the enemy, who, with loud shouting, urged one another on, and, having shut Liparit in among them with his own brave men, killed some of them, and, cutting the sinews of his horse with a sword, took him captive. Seeing this, the rest of the army turned to flight. The enemy, pursuing after them, wrought slaughter beyond measure — some by the sword, and many, because the hour had grown dark with night, they cast headlong from cliffs and out of caves; and those who remained, stripped and plundered, escaped on foot wherever they could. The enemy, filled with plunder more and more, rejoiced; but our own were full of wailing and lamentation. And from that day to this, like ravening dogs, or like wolves of Arabia, they have never been sated with the blood of Christians, until they had consumed them and swept them away. And the whole land became like a field come to harvest, after whose reapers there follow those who gather the sheaves, and afterward leave only the gleanings and the stubble as pasture for the wild beasts. Now after the victory of the battle, having taken booty and captives, they entered their own land, and filled the whole country with plunder beyond measure; and the prince of the Georgians they carried off and gave to the caliph, as something great, and more pleasing to him than all the other captives — whom, having taken and received with thanks, he released in peace to his own land, with great gifts. This much, then, up to this point.

How the Patriarch Petros Came to Remain in Constantinople, or How the Return Came About

When the king saw him, he received him with great honor and esteem, and commanded that he be maintained with abundant provisions. But he kept him with himself for three years, because he suspected that, if he let him go to Armenia, he would go and incite Ani to rebel. But Atom, son of Senek'erim, took him as a pledge, and brought him to his own city of Sebastopolis, and gave him as a dwelling place the resting-place of the holy sign, which he himself had built with manifold adornment and splendid magnificence; and having lived in that place two years, he passed to Christ. And they install in his place Khachik, his sister's son, who had long before received the ordination of the patriarchate. When the king heard of this, he sent men to seek him out, and brought him to himself, along with the treasures which they found both there and in Armenia; for Petros had been a great lover of treasures, for which many reproached him. But after three years Lord Khachik was released from the royal-seat city, and having come to the borders of Second Armenia, to the district called Tarntay, he settled there; for there they had assigned him a dwelling place.

Now the reason for his delay in Constantinople was this: they wished to subject him to tribute, but he would not consent, saying that what had not existed until his own time, he too would not agree to. And then, having put him to questioning and testing, they added threats besides: he should not leave from there unless he took upon himself what had been commanded of him. But that blessed person, the successor of our great Illuminator, not at all daunted by their words, remained utterly steadfast in the same resolve. After this, two men — one a prince, the other a monk, from among the Romans — came forward, whether to provoke him to jealousy or in earnest I do not know, and sought the oversight of the church, undertaking to pay the tax; and both of them died an evil death. Then, having come to repentance, he released him without tax, granting him by

document and by a gold ring the places that were their own in Armenia, and two monasteries in Tarntay.



How the Gorged City Which Is Called Kars Was Struck Beyond Bearing

This city had known no trial of misfortune for a long time; wherefore they lived carefree and unsuspecting, grown rich, having amassed great wealth from sea and from land. Now when the great manifestation of our Lord came, on the night in which the choirs of priests, together with the vast multitude of the people, were performing the office of the day with joyful voice, suddenly the forces of the lawless came upon them. And since the city was without night-watches, they entered within, and, setting the sword upon every man, slaughtered all without mercy — a narrative most worthy of lamentation. For it is the custom of cities, at the feasts of the Lord, for men and women, old and young, to be adorned with much finery, according to their strength and according to their means, after the likeness of spring-blossoming flower-gardens. Finding them thus, the city was suddenly filled with wailing and lamentation. They silenced the priests from their ministrations, and the psalm-singers from their psalmic songs; the song of blessing was cut off from the mouth of clerics and children. There was to be seen there a piteous sight, one that would move even the stones and lifeless creatures to laments of groaning — let alone sentient and living beings. Very wealthy and honored merchants were slain by a cruel death; young men and wrestlers were cut down by the sword in the streets; the honored grey hairs of old men lay fallen, blood-drenched, beside them; and by such deeds the city was emptied of its men. And if anyone managed to reach the fortress that stands above the city, he alone survived. And they remained the whole day at that place, and, setting to work with mattocks, dug up the houses;

then, setting fire, they burned the city, and taking the captives and the plunder of the city, they went off to their own land.



Concerning the Coming of the Sultan

After this narrative, when the following year came, it was the five hundred and third year of our era. In that same month, and on the same day of the month on which they had earlier carried this land into captivity and burned Arcn, together with other cities and towns, the death-breathing, blood-drinking beast and man-slaughtering Sultan set out with countless troops, elephants, chariots and horses, women and children, and great equipage. Passing by Archesh and Berkri, he came and encamped around the city called Manazkert, in the district of Apahunik', and occupied the whole broad expanse of the plains. And he sent out raiding parties into three quarters of this land: to the north, as far as the stronghold of the Abkhaz and as far as the mountain called Parkhar and as far as the foot of the Caucasus; to the west, as far as the forests of Chaneti; and to the south, as far as the mountain called Sim; and he held the whole land as reapers take the swath of a field.

Now the evils which they brought upon this land at that time — who is able to commit them to writing, or whose mind suffices to reckon them? For this whole land was full of corpses; inhabited places and uninhabited, roads and desert places, caverns and rocky wastes, dense forests and open plains — and in every settled place they set fire and ravaged houses and churches, whose blazing flame rose higher than that of the furnace of Babylon; and by such deeds they ravaged the whole land, not once, but turning back a second and a third time upon the same ground, until the land was altogether emptied of its inhabitants, and the lowing of cattle ceased.

Seeing this deed done, mourning seized the land, and the earth was overthrown, for its inhabitants were overthrown; joy was lifted from the face of the whole earth; in every place, lamentation and groaning; everywhere, wailing and the gatherings of mourners; nowhere the songs of priests; nowhere is heard the glorification of God. Nowhere the books of the word for the instruction and comfort of hearers, for the readers lay slain in the public squares, themselves burned and turned to ash. Nowhere is heard the voice of weddings, nor the glad tidings of newborn children; the old do not sit in their seats in the public square, nor do children play before them; the flocks do not gather in the pastures, nor do the lambs frisk in the meadows. The reaper does not fill his arms with the sheaf, nor does he hear the blessing of the passers-by; the threshing floors are not filled with wheat, nor do the vats overflow with wine; the voices of rejoicing are not heard at the grape-harvest, nor are the storehouses weighed down with their jars. All this has been lifted away, has perished and is seen no more. What Jeremiah could lament our ruin, drawing his laments out over the roads and the mountains? What Isaiah, deaf to those who would console him, could take his fill of lamentation? Woe is me, who tell this tale — being like that *himenats'i* young man, I have become a herald of grief, not for one village or one city, but for every land, from nation to nation, even to the end of times; for there is no time or deed that can make our own misfortune seem old, except what the books make known beforehand concerning the abomination of desolation. Now what shall I do? Shall I forbear from relating the unbearable evils that came upon the Christians — sparing you, though I should stir up laments and groans in all of you who share in this hell-sounding tale? But I know that you wish to hear it; wherefore I too, laying aside my own hesitation, will recount, one by one, the chief places of these unbearable evils.

When I recall Khordzean and Handzit', and what was done in them, I am broken with tears; my heart bursts; my mind grows numb; my hands are struck with trembling; and I am unable to carry my pen forward. Many and countless souls, from the upper districts, had gathered there because of the strength of those places. Upon whom the lawless fell, swift as birds, merciless as beasts, seething with fury as avengers, and, setting the mattock to the caverns and the

dense forests, insatiably slaughtered whomever they found — so that the blood, as in the season that brings the spring, when from the warmth of the air the water melts and flows out of the snow, gushing forth stream by stream, sweeping the earth's soil along behind it, so it was then also: streams of blood, risen up from the fallen corpses, on the sloping ground, from the abundance of their flow, swept the earth's soil along with them.

But you, then, call to mind the ranks of monks and priests who were caught there, or the flocks of old men, or the multitude of young men, whose newly-sprouted beards, like a beautifully-fitted picture, adorned their cheeks, and whose curling locks, gleaming upon their brows, brightened the look of their faces with the vivid color of a rose — how suddenly, struck by the enemy's sword as if by hail, they fell, tumbling and rolling to the ground. Bring to mind also the reckoning of the children, whom they seized from their mothers' arms and cast to the ground, who with mighty groaning sought their mothers; and they tore the parents from them with blows of beating, in haste. What heart of stone, hearing this, would not be choked with tears at the constant recurrence of these manifold evils? Virgins fell into disgrace; young brides were parted from their husbands and given over into captivity; in a single moment the land, which like a city had been thronged with the abundance of its people, became empty of men — divided in two, either cut down by the sword or led captive. O Christ, Your forbearance in that hour! O our own evils! To how bitter a death were we given over!

As for the slaughter that took place in Derjan and Ekegheats' and the borderlands between them — that too is beyond your power to commit to writing; but weigh it by what has been said. Now those who entered Tayk', having taken the land and reached as far as the great river called the Chorokh, then turned back from the river and descended into the land of Khaghtik'; and, having taken the plunder and captives of the district, they turned back, and, coming as far as the fortress-city called Baberd, they meet there a company of the Roman troops called Varangians, who, unaware of one another, clashed and fought face to face. And by the mercy of God the Roman company was strengthened, and, having defeated the enemy, they slew the head of the force

and many along with him, and turned the rest to flight, and recovered all the plunder and the captives; but they did not dare pursue the fugitives far, for they feared lest they should meet a heavier force. And the captives who were freed gave thanks to God and went to their homes. But those who went on against the Armenians — whomever they found, they put to the sword or sold into captivity, and, laden with plunder, turned back. And coming to the borders of Vanand, the valiant princes under Gagik son of Abas met them face to face, and wrought great carnage in that place. But the forces of the lawless came upon them and hemmed them in; and because, through the length of the battle and the terrible slaughter, they themselves and their horses had grown weak in strength, and so were unable to break through the enemy's barrier and get out, the enemy put the sword upon them and slew thirty men of the azats.

And they seized one of the azats, whose name was Tatul, who was a mighty man and a lover of war, and he was taken and brought before the Sultan. And since he had grievously wounded the son of Arsuban, the amir of the Persians, when the Sultan saw him he said: "If he lives, I will free you; but if he dies, I will order you offered up as a sacrifice to him." And after a few days he died. But he answered: "If the blow is mine, he will not live; but if it is another's, that I do not know." When the Sultan heard that he had died, he ordered him slain, and, having cut off his right arm, sent it to Arsuban for a comfort — that your son did not die by a weak arm.

Now what is it for me to set down in writing, one by one, the irreparable ruin of the Christians? It befell us just as when a sea, churned up by violent winds, rises into terrible surging waves and foaming heaps from every quarter — so it happened to us: the whole land was suddenly filled with turmoil, and nowhere was a place of refuge to be found; for on account of the unbearable evils, hope of life was taken away from all men. This the Savior also foretold beforehand, likening these murderous evils to the turmoil of the sea, in which many among men, growing faint, could not keep their souls within them, from fear and from the expectation of what was coming.

But leave this aside, and come, marvel at the Sultan's folly and at God's manifold wisdom — at his folly, in that he proclaimed himself Almighty and a co-throned equal of God; and at God's wisdom, in that with a single trick He toyed with him, and sent him back to his own land full of disgrace. Now attend to what I shall relate, in order. The first time, when he came and surrounded the city with his countless troops, and they were unprepared in men and beasts, had he then remained ten days more, he would have taken the city. But God, who is not wroth to the utmost, nor keeps His anger forever, nor deals with us according to our sins, cast into the Sultan's mind, along with everything else, a design of vanity. After three days, having moved with his whole camp, he marches down to Tuaratsoy Tap', and from there descends into the broad plain of Basean, by the impregnable fortress called Awnik, where he saw the land gathered full of people and beasts, and paid it no heed, for from a single glance he recognized that it was impregnable; and passing it by he comes to the head of Basean, near the village called Du. And going up from there with a few men, unrecognized, onto the height that looks toward Karin, he saw the city armed with every preparation; and, having gazed a long while, he turned back again. But the men of Manazkert, without suspicion, went out from the city and abundantly prepared provision for men and beasts, for it was, indeed, the season of the harvest. And while the Sultan, occupied here and there, had turned back, they remained free of care; and then he came, inflamed with fury, and gives battle against the city. Now the prince who held charge of the oversight of the city — since he was a pious man — called upon Almighty God for help, disciplining himself with fasting and prayer; and armed with this, he grew bravely bold in faith. And he said to God, in the words of the psalm: «I will not fear evil, for you, Lord, are with me»; and the other, that: «I will not fear the ten thousands of their forces that surround me,» and what belongs with it. And he gave encouragement to the men of the city and to the troops, saying: "Take courage, my comrades and brothers, take courage and do not be afraid; this is an easy task for God. They come against us with chariots and horses; we will call upon the name of our Lord, and glory in God forever, and confess His name, for He gives strength and firmness to His people, who is blessed forever." He urged the

priests to prayer and to the singing of psalms, who cried out to God with unceasing outcry by day and by night, who with cross and striking-board, with lifted voice, upon the walls, besought God to come to the aid of those in danger. Wearing by this, the tyrant's ears asked what that unceasing outcry was, and learned from those who knew that they were crying out to God.

For the space of a month's days he remained before the city, and each single day he twice joined battle against the city, once at daybreak and once toward evening. But here observe God's wisdom, how He knows how to win, by opposition itself, the fruit that belongs to His opponent. Now while the city stood in this uncertainty and danger, He cast a good design into the heart of a certain prince, who was very much among the Sultan's intimates, who made known to the city, by word or by writing, what he had learned in counsel from him. Many times, having written on a paper, he would bind it to the shaft of an arrow, and, approaching the wall under the pretense of combat, would cast the arrow into the city; and by this he made known to them the whole plan of the fighting — that: "Tomorrow, thus, and according to this manner, is the plan of the fighting; and at this marked place, in the night, they intend to dig beneath the wall and get inside. But you, stand firm and strong, and be watchful over those places."

This God does, who knows how to lay the foundation of great matters from far off — who made Balaam a prophet before Balak, for the oversight of His people, and gave the mute beast to speak with a human voice; and who fed Elijah for three years, by ravens, in the wadi of Cherith, during the famine. What wonder, then, if here too, by the hand of adversaries, He ordained the salvation of the city?

Now on whatever side they took their stand for battle, whether by night or by day, they were found there armed and ready. After this, the enemy set up siege-engines, and fought with them. But a certain priest of ours, advanced in days, who was well versed in the art, himself set up his own trebuchet; and it happened that whenever they placed a stone in the sling of their engine and hurled it at the city, the priest released his own stone directly against theirs, so

that the priest's stone, striking the stone of the lawless, cast it back upon them. The lawless did this seven times, and could accomplish nothing; for the priest's stone prevailed over their stone.

Then they prepared another instrument of war, which they themselves called a *baban*, which was very dreadful, of which it was said that it had four hundred attendants, who hauled the ropes, and they placed a stone of sixty *litr* in the sling and hurled it into the city; and before it they raised a rampart of bales of cotton and much other material, so that the priest's stone should not reach it. And when they had arranged this, they loosed a single stone, which, striking the wall with great force, broke it down and hollowed it out; seeing which, the city was greatly seized with trembling, and cried out to God with great groaning, beseeching Him to come to their aid, while for the lawless there was great rejoicing. But on the coming of the second day, the leader of the Daylamite force — for he was a valiant man — took his troops and came and gave battle, fighting against our men; and coming to the breach, he was eager to force his way powerfully inside, and suddenly, going of his own accord, he fell. And those who were upon the wall cast an iron hook and caught him, and dragged him and pulled him down beneath the wall; and the enemy troops, seeing this, turned back to the camp full of sorrow, while for the city there was no small rejoicing.

Then a certain valiant man of the Roman troops prepared fire with naphtha and sulfur, and poured it into a glass vessel, and, mounted upon a noble horse, being stout of heart and brave, having protected his back with a shield alone, went out through the gate of the city and enters the camp of the foreigners, calling himself a *mandator* — that is, a letter-bearer. And going up to the *baban*, he passed around it, and, suddenly lifting up the vessel, poured it upon the *baban*; and at once the fire blazed up, a crimson flame burst forth, and he himself turned back swiftly. The lawless, seeing this, were struck with amazement, and, mounting their horses, pursued him, but could not overtake him. And he came in peace and entered the city, by the help of God having no wound upon his person. But when the Sultan saw what had happened, in great wrath he ordered the guards cut to pieces.

Do you see God's loving care for mankind, how near His salvation is to those who fear Him? Do you see how He knows how to conquer the great by small means — as with Moses against Og, whose height was nine cubits by a giant's measure; or as with the boy David against Goliath; or as with the giant-armored Sisera of the foreigners, by the hand of Jael, the wife of Heber; or as with Holofernes, by the hand of another woman? I say this so that we may not lose heart when we fall into the midst of unbearable trials. For God is accustomed to permit, for a time, such perilous afflictions, so that those who endure may be found worthy of the crown of glory, and the lawless may receive, from a just judgment, the recompense of their own evils. This too we see to have happened in the case of the furnace and the youths: for God permitted the king to bring forth into the light all the ragings of his fury, and the furnace was prepared, whose flame rose forty-nine cubits high; and he, in his violent arrogance, said: "Who is the god that shall deliver you out of my hands?" See, along with this, also the steadfast faith of the youths — how, standing before such a beast in judgment, they gave the boldest answer, which was a great scorn to the tyrant: "It is not necessary," he says, "for us to give you an answer concerning this." And then what? When the king's threats were carried out, and they were cast, bound, into the furnace, then help came swiftly to their aid, and He does not put to shame those who call upon Him in truth. See here too the depths of God's wisdom, which no one attains to: for the fire divided itself in two — whomever of the Chaldeans it found, it burned; while an angel sprinkled dew upon the youths, who did not draw near to them at all, neither grieved them nor distressed them; who also brought the barbarian to his senses, so that, at these unspeakable wonders, he confessed and said: "Come forth, you servants of God, for I too, with you, bless Him who is blessed forever." So too here, by the hand of an insignificant man, He showed forth great wonders. Let this, then, be for us instruction and teaching.

Now Vasil, who was the prince of the city, ordered the common people, upon the wall, to revile and insult the Sultan with a great shout; and he, after two days, having moved his camp, departed from that place, and, going on, comes upon a certain city called Artske, which is in the midst of the sea of Bznunik',

and which has near it a strong and impregnable fortress; and the citizens, taking refuge in this — the sea and the stronghold — remained free of care. But the blood-drinking beasts, finding a shallow place in the sea — whether under someone's guidance, or by their own ingenuity — entered the city; and, putting the sword upon them, slaughtered them all; and, taking the captives and the plunder of the city, departed from the place. And this was a comfort to the Sultan's heart, and he went off to his own land in great sorrow, for he was not able to accomplish anything of what he had intended.



The End of the Reign of Monomachos

The blessed and divine Solomon writes, saying, «A just king establishes the land, but the lawless man overthrows it.» And this too we have seen with our own eyes come to pass in this man's case. For it is the law of kings to attend to the peace and building-up of the world, just as God provides beforehand for all that comes from Him; but this man was not so. Instead, ever given over to eating and drinking, he only multiplied his own filth, and the treasures which he gathered from the taxes of every land — which it was his duty to distribute for the needs of the cavalry, and to multiply the mounted forces against the enemy, forces that could have kept the world in peace by defeating the enemies, as the blessed Basil did, who reigned fifty years, so that none of the enemies dared to enter his land — this man instead spent on the expense of harlots, and the ruin of the world grieved him not at all. For he was so given to fornication and so loved harlots that he was not satisfied with the women of Constantinople, but had women brought to him from distant lands, and spent the whole day occupied with them. For this reason the enemies grew bold, and just as hungry wolves, when they find the flock without a shepherd, slaughter without mercy, so too in his time there came, from east and west alike, the utter ruin of the

Christians, which we have set down above, in small part. And he, having spent his life in such courses, died — he who reigned thirteen years, having earned no good remembrance at all.

As for Theodora, who was daughter of the king Constantine, she took hold of the kingship as her own hereditary patrimony, against which no one could rise up. To her the Sultan of the Tajiks sent envoys, and wrote her a letter, which had this form: "Either give me the cities and provinces which your forefathers took from the Tajiks, or else give a thousand dahekans every day." She, in reply, sent him horses and white-maned mules, and much treasure, and purple garments besides. But he, receiving this with disdain, detained the bearer of the treasure with himself, making him travel on with him into the land of the Babylonians; and it was the five hundred and fourth year of our era.

And in that same year the Persian troops set out in the Sultan's name — though some say they belonged to Apusuar, the one who held Dvin and Gandzak and was son-in-law of Ashot, king of the Armenians — and they invaded the land of the Armenians. Before them the inhabited places fled and gathered into the city of Ani, but not all of them managed to get inside in time, for the hour grew late and the city gates had already been shut. And the Persian troops, marching by night, seized the city gate, and, putting them to the sword, wrought unbearable slaughter, and there was no one to help them; and having taken plunder and captives, they went back to their own land.

Now in the region of Taron, Theodoros son of Aharon — whom they called Awan in their own tongue, the letter being wanting — was prince of the district. To him came a troop from T'urk'astan, and submitted to him, and wished to show their good faith; they entered the district of Khlat' and took much plunder, and brought it to Taron. But troops gathered from among the Persians and from T'urk'astan sent word to Theodoros: "Either hand over these rebels of yours to us, or else we will carry your land off captive." He would not consent to this; after which they came and clashed with one another twice and three times, and the prince displayed much valor, but afterward, grievously wounded, he died after a few days. His death was greatly worthy of lament: youthful in age,

and in his handsome, splendid appearance bearing a likeness to the prophet David, and in courage surpassing many, he was cut off from among us before his time.

Now when winter came, on the days of the feast of the Theophany, the lawless troops, marching by night, came to the market-town of Hark' called Mankan Gom, and catching them off guard while they were performing the night office, put the sword to them and slaughtered them all, together with the villages and farmsteads round about; and taking captives and plunder, they went to the village of Aratsani, since it lay on their way. And when they brought the plunder and the captives out onto the ice, suddenly the ice broke, and covered under itself all who stood upon it.

O how bitter is this history, and worthy of lamentation! But perhaps someone will blame us, saying, "Until when will you set before us this recital of sorrows and afflictions?" How many threatening words did the prophets prophesy, of things that would come to pass after a time — and the people were reluctant to hear of them! But I am not a herald of threats; I relate things that have already happened and come to a head, so that I might stir tears in all who hear, at how bitter a time we have met with. This life of ours became a matter of doubt to us: whether the sins of our fathers came upon us, as the prophet, lamenting, accused his own people — then alas for us, that we pay the debts of our fathers' sins! And where is that which God spoke through Ezekiel, saying, "Son of man, what is this proverb that they use in the midst of Israel, saying, 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes, and the children's teeth are set on edge?' As I live, says the Lord, this proverb shall no longer be used in Israel; for all souls are mine, the soul of the father just as the soul of the son" — and the rest that follows in order — and he freed the son from the father's debt. And if all these things came upon us on account of our own evils, then we are more pitiable than all mankind: the whole world dwells in peace, while we are captives and prisoners, cut down by the sword, our houses ruined, and stripped of our possessions.

Armenia had four thrones of kingship — not to mention the rule of the curopalates, and that which came from the Romans. And it had a patriarchate

great and envied by all nations; and truth-speaking vardapets, equal to the first vardapets of old, who had attained to the depths of knowledge; before whose words all the phalanxes of the heretics bowed their necks and sank into the ground, unable to enter the fold of the flock of the faithful, for the gatekeeper would not admit them — he who knows his own and is known by his own. And our churches, like newlywed brides, were adorned in every beauty to please the will of the immortal Bridegroom; and newborn children, from the passionless womb of our mother Sarah, gathered like the young of doves, sang with full-throated voice the angelic songs.

Now come and see the evil, and comfortless exchange we have received in its place. Where are the thrones of the kings? Behold, they are not seen. Where is the multitude of the armies, which, dense as a cloud before them, gleamed each in its own color, garment upon garment, like the flowers born of spring? Behold, they are no more, and are no longer seen. Where is the great and wondrous patriarchal throne, which the blessed man of God, the great Gregory, descending into the depth of the pit, won through fifteen years of sweat-drenched labor, and set his own throne upon the apostolic throne? Today it is seen empty, void of inhabitants, stripped of adornment, filled with dust and spiders' webs, and the heir of the throne removed into a foreign land like a captive and a prisoner. The voices of the vardapets and their preaching are silenced; and the ranks of the heretics, who used to hide here and there among them like mice creeping into holes, hunted down by their theological words and by their orthodox confession — today, like mighty lions, come out fearlessly from their lairs, mouths agape, to see whom they may devour among the innocent. And what shall I say of the Church, which formerly was so adorned and comely, richly fruitful and most blessed, which even moved the prophet to wonder — but today sits without splendor, unadorned, stripped of all beauty, like a widow without a son, stripped of her ornaments, fallen from honor, sitting in torn garments without comfort? So it is seen here too: the torches quenched and the lamps gone out, the fragrance of incense and sweet odors spent, the crown of the Lord's table covered with dust and ashes. One may see her own children, who, at her doors, having taken *bnakit* in hand, sang the

songs of David; today they dance outside the demon-haunted dens which they call mosques, learning to recite what Muhammad handed down. And chaste and modest women too, who used to accept lawful marriage from their own men only under great entreaty, today are grown accustomed to unlawful and monstrous promiscuity.

Now if all this that we have related came upon us because of our own evils, call out to heaven, and to what is in it and what is above it; call out to the earth and the living creatures that are in it; call out to the mountains and the hills, to the trees and the dense forests — let them weep and mourn for our ruin. This too the prophets used to do in times of rejoicing: they commanded the mountains and hills to leap for joy, the rivers to clap their hands, the sea to rejoice, and the forests to exult. For all these are our kin: in our joys they rejoice together with us, and they must likewise share in our mourning, just as also in former times they bowed down with us on the day of our humiliation and affliction, since it was on our account that they came to be. But even this is no help to us for comfort: for though one weep and beat the breast for the dead a long time, and shut them away in darkness, it brings him no benefit. What benefit was it to the Jews, the weeping of Jeremiah, or of Christ for Jerusalem, or for Judas? Tell me. None at all. Wherefore, knowing this, we are bound to reconcile God through the rectitude of our own souls; for if this is set right, then the enemy's sword will fail utterly, and hard things will be turned into easy ones for us, and the rugged places into a level road, and all flesh shall see the salvation of God. For if God is on our side, who shall be able to stand against us? For He Himself commanded in the Law, saying, «I will be an enemy to your enemies, and I will destroy those who hate you»; and again, «I will not abandon you, nor cast you aside.» Only let us have peace with God, and call upon Him with a whole heart, holding good deeds as a pledge between us, and there is nothing among our adversaries that can grieve us. And this too is a word of the Lord, which we find written in Isaiah: «Before you have called, I will hear you; and while you are still speaking, I will say, What is it you seek?» — a saying that surpasses every warm-hearted father. But from the unworthy He washes His hands, saying, «Let not my soul be with them»; and again, «Though you cry out to me, I will not hear you; the

wicked shall seek me, and shall not find me»; and again, «When you lift up your hands on high, I will turn my face away from you; and though you multiply your prayers, I will not hear you.» For what fellowship has light with darkness?

Let us fear, brothers, and give heed to these heavenly tidings. Let us not be among those unknown to Him, lest He say, "I do not know you"; but let us be numbered among His friends, that He may say to us, «Come, you blessed of my Father, inherit the life that is past telling.»



The Reign of Theodora, Who Is Interpreted as Astvatsatur

After the death of Monomachos, the she-lion, roaring in her den with a beast's savagery — the very one who had earlier appeared to Daniel in his vision — summoned the chief men of the city and the greatest of the princes, and said to them: "If any of you dares go out with an army to the east, and put an end to the roaring of the Persians, and subdue the land to peace, then let him come boldly and sit as king; by God's own right he is worthy of the kingship. But if no one takes this word upon himself, I myself am regent enough." Having heard this, the princes went away, each without giving an answer, each to his own house.

Now the queen, having sated the Sultan, like a famished beast, with an abundance of gifts, so that he forgot to rise up against us; but instead he stirred up the war in Babylon and the regions around it — for the man was exceedingly fond of war. But those who were our own borderers and neighbors, inflamed, did not cease, summer and winter, from ravaging our land of Armenia; for they searched deliberately, and wherever they heard of an inhabited place, having marched by night, they fell upon it unexpectedly, and with unheard-of blows mercilessly destroyed everyone without exception. And, careless of fear, they

spent many days in the place, turning up every corner of the houses — if anyone had anything hidden away, drawing it all out — and having demolished the place, razing it to its foundations, having taken booty and captives, they returned to their own land.

Now there was a town in the district of Basean, near the foot of the mountain called Tsiranis, and its name was Okomi, populous and prosperous. Against this the impious ones marched by night, on the great feast of the Theophany; and since in the harsh frost of the plain the hands and feet of these man-faced beasts had grown numb, when they drew near the settlement they found much hay heaped up as fodder for cattle, and having set fire to it, by the blaze's flaring the whole plain was lit up as if at midday; standing by it they warmed themselves, they and their horses. And then, having strung their bows and bared their weapons, they fell upon the settlement, as much at ease as in summer, and putting the sword to it they slaughtered without exception about thirty thousand souls, leaving not one of the inhabitants of the place, except any who happened to be somewhere on the road. And having spent three days in the place, and having loaded oxen and asses and horses with stores of wheat and hoards of goods, and a little of what was useful, taking these as spoil, they went off to their own land. But the manifold evils that they wrought there — who could commit them to writing? And by such an undertaking the whole land was emptied of its inhabitants, with nothing left alive except perhaps in some stronghold.

Now the queen, having held the kingship two years, and having come to advanced old age, fell ill with the illness of which she also died. To her the chief men of the city came and asked: "While you still live, appoint someone as king, so that the city may remain without disturbance." The queen, agreeing to this, ordered a certain man brought from among the city's chief men, Michael by name, who in his fathers' time had for a while been among the officials of the palace, a man bowed with age in his grey hairs, and very wealthy. And she set him up as king with the city's assent; and she herself, three days later, went the way of all the earth, where kings and poor men are together, according to the psalm of David. Now when the princes of the lands, great and small, heard of

his becoming king, they all came to him in submission. And what he owed them — to gladden them all with conciliatory words and an abundance of gifts, and to win them over to submission under his own rule — instead, being no true man, and seized with Rehoboam's own affliction, he held some of the princes to be unworthy of authority. And speaking harshly to the great men, he said: "Either go out against the Persians to war, and do not let the land be ravaged; or if not, I will pay your stipends as tribute to the Persians, and I will keep this land in peace." The princes, not agreeing to this, went out from before the king without answering, and having made a covenant together, crossed the sea, and gathered many troops, beyond number. Their leaders were Komianos — who indeed himself became king — and Kamenas; and having rebelled against the king, they swore an oath not to submit to his rule. And this took place in the five hundred and sixth year of our era, in which the Roman indiction was the tenth.

Woe to that year! Woe to the world-ravaging design by which the inhabitants of the land were brought down and ruined! For it turned back to its first unadornedness, according to the world's own story, which says: «The earth, he says, was desolate and unfurnished, for there was no man to till the earth.» For just as a man's fair face, in the flower of his age, shows lovely and desirable to those who see it, but when the ordering soul departs from it in death, its former bright and beautiful adornments show fearful and without splendor to those who see it, and pity too is cut off with it — as it is said, «I have been forgotten, like one dead, from the heart.» In the same way the land too is to be seen: for when it grows rich with the dwelling of men, then the farmers fill the fields with the seed of abundance; and these, when they sprout, make the countryside lovely with their green appearance, and shoot upward with towering growth; and when they show the shape of their ears of grain upon their tops, then, cloud-like in their dense thickness, they present themselves to those who see them, and in the sweet-breathing air they sway and pace like the waves of the sea. So too do the flocks of the open pastures, in the valleys of verdant growth by the cold springs, leap and play, and the land, like a nurse, is adorned by them with a fair countenance — as it is said, «Let the fields exult, and everything that is in them.»

But now we see the opposite of this: the land laid waste, empty of its inhabitants; cities brought down; and fields gone to fallow and briar, showing dreadful and terrible to those who pass by. And the flocks of sweet-voiced birds too, which by their gentle, man-loving ways were once tame among our kind, which made the countryside ring with sweet-toned melodies, and in the mornings, with their chirping songs and loud warbling, roused the farmers as if with a goad from the sluggishness of sleep, readying each to his own craft — but now the settlements are ruins, desolate and without people, and there is no place for them to dwell; for where do the birds build their nests, and where do the weak among the birds take refuge in them, according to the psalm's own word? Or where does the swallow prepare her wandering nestlings' little nest, rearing without fear those born of herself? Now let this word rest here; let us make, from the beginning, the start of this hard-to-hear and evil history.

Now when the house of the Greeks was divided in two, the rod of iron became a crushed rod of reed — the very name by which the Assyrian, taunting the kingdom of Egypt, once called it; and the boiling pot that showed its seething to Jeremiah, which then poured its scalding out from north to south, now with a terrible seething poured it from south to north, and, burning, ravaged the Christian peoples. For according to the Lord's own word, a kingdom divided cannot live, but is brought down — and so indeed it came to pass; for when the Persians learned of this strife and mutual contention among them, they came against us boldly, making ceaseless incursions, and brought the world-ravaging ruin to its full measure.

Now at the beginning of the year of which we made mournful mention, they, like night-ravaging wolves who come upon a flock that has no shepherd — who are not content with feeding themselves alone, but strive to destroy all — so too the troops that came from Persia were not sated with plunder, but held an insatiable hunger for our destruction; for whatever they saw with their eyes, it was impossible for it to escape their hands, and they reckoned this a great benefaction.

Now when war broke out among the Romans, there was a man named Ivane, son of Liparit, to whom had been granted as a gift, for places of habitation, the great town of Eriza in the district of Hashteank', with the estates around it. When he heard that the kingdom had been divided in two, he went and by deceit took the fortress called Eghants Berd, and having brought it under his own hand, he returned again to the district of Aghori, and to the fortress called Hawachich. And the city came out to meet him in friendship; and the judge who held charge of the eastern regions, who happened to be there at the time — when Ivane saw him, he at once ordered him seized. And having taken from him boundless treasure, and horses and mules and everything he had gathered from the eastern regions, he put the man himself in prison at Eghnut; and he himself, with all haste, went against the fortified city of Karin. And for a while he tried by deceit, saying: "I have a command from the king; the city is mine — open the gates, that I may enter." And when by this he could not bring them to submission, he then gave battle, seeking to master the city by war. But the prince of the city at once sent word to the prince who resided at Ani and held the rank of magistros; who, on hearing this, sent one of the chief men, with troops, against him. But when Ivane learned of this, he raided the land and returned to his own place; and he sent to the Persians to bring troops to his aid — this was the beginning of the unbearable evils that came upon us.

When the impious host heard the summons, they called out to one another, and, gathering at once in one place, hastened to reach him. But he, when he saw the multitude of the troops, was struck with fear; and since there was no one to oppose them — for the prince, on whose account they had come, when he learned of their coming, entered the great fortress and shut himself in — the troops that had come said: "Show us a way to plunder; do not send us back empty." And he, at a loss, gave them a guide from among his own men, who set out, and, marching by night through desert places, came upon the district of Khaghtik'. And having caught them off their guard, according to their own blood-drinking ways, they put to the sword every man they met, as far as the forest of Khrt'i in Chanet'; and having taken booty and captives beyond measure, they returned in great triumph. And coming to the leader of the

evildoers, they offered him rich gifts in thanks for the success that had befallen them on the road; and then they went off to their own land. And since they saw the land without a lord and without a guard, on this account these servants of evil, having turned back at once, went out into it again; and having come down into the district of Mananaghi, they divided in two. One part went to Ekegheats', and, falling by night upon the city that is there, found what was in it unprepared and unguarded. Of its disastrous and pitiable evils I am not able to give a full written account; for at the breaking of that tearful morning, there was to be seen a sight full of turmoil, such as would have been enough to move even the stones and the lifeless creation to laments and groans. For whose heart, among those who saw it, was not broken, whose person did not shake with trembling, whose eyes' lamps were not darkened with a shadow of gloom, seeing the public squares full of corpses, and the houses, the broad halls, the narrow streets, and the rows of vineyards? And nearly the whole extent of the city was stained with the blood of those slaughtered; where, moreover, many were still to be seen with life in them, gasping for breath with difficulty, and the men mercilessly, cruelly wounded further still: some had their bellies slit open and their livers pulled out and thrust into their mouths, and some they forced, while still alive, to eat of it. O Your forbearance then, O God! O the excess of our own evils! For it is thirteen years now that the Christian people have borne such unendurable sufferings, and the wrath of the Lord's anger has not been quenched; but His hand is still raised, to give to drink a full cup of unmixed wine — an evil draught. No longer for pardon and mercy, but for the repayment of hatred; with these they besieged the city and the villages and farmsteads around it, until not a living soul among mankind remained, except perhaps in some stronghold. And the impious ones, filled and sated with plunder, having put the city to fire, and having taken captives and spoil from the district, turned back. These are your grief-laden histories, O city — no longer a city of refuge, but a pit of destruction for those who dwell in you — a few of your manifold evils here set down.

And the impious came and reached the district of Karin, near the village called Blurk'; and since the inhabitants of the place had walled the hill round about,

they had laid its foundations upon the earth, according to the Lord's own parable — for which reason, when the impious came like the surge of a swollen flood, at its striking, it could not stand against them for a single moment, but was cast down at once, and its fall became a thing heard of throughout the world and unforgotten unto the very end of ages. Now what they had thought a hope of salvation and a place of refuge became for them a pit of ruin; and since the villages and monasteries that lay on this side of the river Euphrates were all gathered there, and many besides from the town of Arcn, when the enemy came upon them, they at once made a mockery of its strongholds. And once inside, at the flash of swords and the sound of the bowstrings, all of them, struck with trembling from fear, became as if bound in chains. And since there was no prince or leader to rouse them, by courage and encouragement, to strength of spirit against the enemy, urging on brave champions, as is the custom of all who go to war — for this reason, being without a lord, at the very sight alone they gave way, they melted, and were thrown into confusion, they were shaken, and all their good sense collapsed. And they began to steal away from one another: some, at the coming of night, let themselves down over the wall and became fugitives; others gave themselves up of their own will; and those who remained inside, having abandoned any thought of fighting, dug hiding-pits and covered themselves with earth. Against these the impious grew bold and began to slaughter them, not after the manner of war, but as sheep penned in a fold: some they seized by force and, bringing them forward, cut off their heads with the sword. Twice over they were taken from life: by the sword's flash above them, which is more bitter than death itself, and then by the death-blow itself. And some they struck face to face, sword in hand, and, falling upon them beast-like as they met them, striking the sword into the heart, they killed at once; but the heavy-set and the stout of body they forced to their knees upon the ground and, stretching out their hands to stakes driven in, bound them to the earth, and, tearing off their skin with the nails still on, from this side and that, along the arm and the back, to the very tips of the second hand, dragged and pulled it off by force, and made of it bowstrings. Oh! How bitter is this history!

But as for the priests and monks, what ears could bear the unheard-of evils that they suffered? Some of them, flayed of their skin from the chest upward, were led about, face and head still attached to it, and, tormented with such bitter torments, were only then put to death. For what other torment, more bitter and unbearable than this, could anyone conceive — such as is nowhere found to have occurred even in the sufferings of the holy martyrs?

In this manner they cut down and finished off all of them, turning up every corner, and those buried alive they killed by piercing them cruelly with spears; and the wailing of the tormented resounded in echoes throughout the mountains, all together. And when they had made an end of all their lives, they then pierced the bellies of all the fallen and drew out their gall, gathering it into vessels, and gave the captive women to carry it with them. Such was the end of this ruinous imprisonment; thus were we delivered into the hands of evil and pitiless men, and there was no visitation to us from the Lord, because we did not heed Him while we were still at peace. He called to us with a beseeching voice, through the prophets: «Come, He says, hearken to Me, and your souls shall live in good; and if you willingly hearken to Me, you shall eat the good things of the land.» We held His words in contempt; for this reason He too did not hearken to us in the time of affliction, but turned His face away from us. And we were delivered into the hands of our enemies, and those who hate us afflicted us, and their arrow was drunk with our blood, and their sword devoured the flesh of our fallen and wounded, the men of our own fighting force; and they went off with this victory to their own land. As for the number of the fallen and the captives, seven thousand was the count given, and of the monks, sixty.



**Concerning the Devastation of the Land of
Mesopotamia and Whatever Cities Were in It,**

and the Boundless Slaughter

As for that which we mentioned earlier — that when they came down into the district of Mananaghi they divided in two — the first division did what I have written. But the second, at a headlong gallop, with swift-footed course, passed through Handzit' and through Khordzean, turning aside neither to right nor to left; but just as an arrow that leaves the archer's hand, driven by the force of the draw, goes and meets its mark, so too they, giving no sleep to their eyes nor slumber to their eyelids, having become travelers by night, suddenly, in an unforeseen hour, like hail mixed with stones, poured down upon the inhabitants of the city of the south. And since the city had no defensible position, for this reason its inhabitants, like the waves of the sea, surged back and forth, but could find no way out of their plight. Woe to the deeds that were done there then! Upon them the impious set the sword, and slaughtered mother with child, and son in front of his father; and in an instant the well-built city became a pit of blood. And because, in the violent panic and the sudden onset of death, the love of kin and the affection of blood were forgotten, each one contrived some device by which he might perhaps save himself from that hell-kindled wrath; wherefore, fleeing into the vineyards that lay around the city, they fell in among them and hid themselves beneath the leaf-thick vines. But the impious learned of it, and having searched them out, pierced them with spears and put every one of them to death. And the clusters of the grapevine were dyed with their blood. Those who afterward remained, bereft, found their dead among the vines, and covered them with earth. But they could not bring themselves to harvest the vineyards or to taste of the grapes, saying that it was human blood they would eat. Now the impious, having done with the slaughter, turned back into the city; and turning up every corner of the houses, if anyone had hidden his goods anywhere, or in some hiding place, they dug it out again with great cunning. And then, having set fire to the city, they burned and ravaged it, and having taken booty and captives, went out from the place. Likewise the villages and towns around it — all of them destroyed by sword and

fire and captivity, until there remained not a living soul who opened his mouth and made a sound.

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The Reign of Komianos

Komianos, since he was open-handed and rich in treasure, gathered to himself many troops. When the king saw that circumstances were turning out favorably for him and prospering, he turned to entreaty and began to send ambassadors; he promised him gifts, and to give him the authority of the curopalates in the East — "Only turn to peace, that we may require the blood of the Christians"; but he did not believe it, nor did he agree. Then, when the embassies were spent, those who were intimate with the king strove to subdue him by victory in war.

And having mustered many troops, they came against him, and having met one another, they engaged in battle, where there was much bloodshed, of which they say that no one has seen such a slaughter in one place among the Romans; in that place many even of the chief men fell, and this from both sides; but the army of Komianos prevailed. And since the patriarch was on Komianos's side, he brought many of the city's chief men into agreement with himself; and having brought Komianos within, they made him king. And having made Michael a monk, they sent him across to an island; but they say that he himself went willingly. All this came to pass in this world-ravaging year.

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The Destruction of the Royal City of Melitene

As a rod of torments, and not of correction, God took T'urk'astan and the house of the Persians into His hand, and by them He judged us according to the justice of His own judgments; for the rod of correction belongs to a father, but that of torments to a judge, as David says of the torments of the sinful: «Many are the torments of the sinful; and your corrections shall teach me.» In agreement with this, Paul too writes to the Hebrews: «For if you stand within the order of discipline,» he says, «God deals with you as with sons.»

Now Christ, in His life-giving gospel, having brought us to His own heavenly Father, set us near Him in kinship, and commanded us in every way to become like Him, and to keep our kinship firm in the sweetness of good conduct — yet we rebelled against our sweet and good Father, and became strangers to that kinship; for this reason, in the time of our affliction and our torments, He looked away from us, and we were handed over into the hand of a foreign people; and our enemies grew strong over us, and those who hated us seized us; and our souls were bowed down even to the dust, and our bellies clove to the earth. And as God, tormenting Egypt in Moses' day with the ten-plague rod, said, «This is my great power» — now all of it has befallen us. Their water was turned into blood; our rivers and streams, and nearly the whole soil of this land, were dyed with the color of our own blood. Among them the body swelled and boiled with sores; our whole body was hacked to pieces, cut limb from limb. Among them the dog-fly and the gnat, striking the lordly features of their faces with their stings, blinded them; but among us it was the onslaught of arrows, which wounded us the more bitterly still. Among them the light was turned to darkness for three days; but for us the light was quenched outright, for the very seat of light fell to death, and no more shall he see the goodness of the Lord in his life. Among them the loathsome worm crept into their houses; our houses and our churches — it comes upon me with dread even to say it — were corrupted, and left stinking, by corruption-working and, worse, grievous plagues. Among them the death-bearing angel struck the firstborn; our whole house, with its inhabitants, was consumed and destroyed. The sea alone was lacking to us — but if you weigh it by the deed, you will see that too has befallen us: for what abyss is more unfathomable than T'urk'astan, or what depth of

earth deeper, into which our captives were carried off and vanished, as though into the Red Sea, which was dyed with the blood of its own captives? From them the Israelites asked, as wages, ornaments of gold and garments, from those to whom they had been enslaved; but us they utterly stripped and plundered outright, though we have done them no wrong. Oh, alas and woe upon this inconsolable ruin! For the Egyptians the justice of their punishments was twofold: one, for the bitter servitude with which they oppressed Israel, for which God, coming to judgment, spoke against them; and second, that they served the creatures and not the Creator, who is blessed forever. We have a confessing tongue, though we are void of good works, and we suffer their sufferings — how pitiable we are, and how deserving of lament! O Lord and Maker and God, why hast Thou utterly cast us off, and made us the trampled ground of the heathen, the mockery and derision of our enemies' scorn? Awake, and rouse up Thy power, and come to save us; God of powers, turn again to us, and repay our neighbors sevenfold into their own bosom.

Now for other cities and districts, the time of their devastation fell short by a matter of days — by ten, or a little more or less; but this city, of which we have made our account, while it was still standing was, like Moab, a heifer in the full vigour of its strength, tender and delicate; whose merchants were the glorious of the earth, and whose buyers were the kings of nations, who reclined upon ivory thrones, and continually drank strained wine and anointed themselves with the finest oils. And since every evil takes its beginning from this, as Moses too brings accusation against Israel: «He grew fat,» he says, «he grew thick and gross, and forsook the Lord God his Maker» — so too the Sodomites, inflamed by such a life, fell into unbearable evils, as Ezekiel indeed makes plain, that it was from fullness of bread and the surfeit of life that they grew wanton; and even the first man in paradise could not, for a single day, enjoy the good things without transgression. And since these are the bounds of our nature — in growing poor we murmur and lay blame on God, and in growing rich we grow arrogant, and as though immortal we lay violent hold upon the world. For this reason, by turn and by change, He teaches us to keep ourselves within measure, and not to rise up beyond our bounds, lest we fall the more greatly. For what is one to

understand himself to be, beside base and lowly earth? — our beginning is from it, and our return is again to the same; and He who is the maker of our nature does not wish that anyone perish, and for this reason leaves no one wholly unrestrained: wherever there is occasion for correction, He corrects with gentleness and as a father; and when we grow deaf to correction, He punishes with lordly authority. Some among sinners He judges here, that there He may make their torments the lighter; and some He keeps for the world to come; and there are those who are punished both here and there, as the Sodomites; and there are those who are punished here only, as Lazarus; and there are those who are punished there only, as the rich man. But let this rest here for now; let us return to the order of our history.

Now when the autumn of that sorrowful year had come, while the Romans were still preoccupied with the tumult over their kings, at the entering of the month of Areg, again another army went out from the Persians — whether of the earlier ones or new, I do not know — and it went through desert places with such caution that no one could perceive it, until it reached the district called Kamakh; and there it divided into two: one part went as far as Koloneia, and according to their custom took the land captive — which we learned of only afterward, when they passed back on their return. But the other part, having set its eye on Melitene, came upon it by night; and since a troop of Roman cavalry stood guard over the city, when the enemy came upon them the garrison sallied out and made a sudden attack. And as they engaged one another, they wrought great slaughter on both sides; and as the battle continued, the city — as many as were able to get out — escaped; and the fighting men who remained went in pursuit of the fugitives; but those whom they seized within the city, all of them they put to the sword. They remained in the city twelve days, and, digging it out from its foundations, laid it waste, together with the estates surrounding it. And this was the recompense of their arrogance from the Lord, incorruptible and just, who repays to each according to his deeds.

But the districts from Ekegheats' downward, through which they had passed by night, when they learned of the evils that had befallen Melitene, gathered many companies of archers and seized the passes of the road. But the lawless ones,

since they knew no other road, and since thick-packed snow covered the mountains, remained helplessly in that place five months, the whole winter through, until the month of Nawasard, and stripped the land of any hope of life; and the unbearable evils that they wrought there they left as a memorial from generation to generation: for making sport of the children and other infants, playing with javelins and arrows, they cruelly pierced and destroyed them, and no pity of compassion dripped into their nature. I forbear to tell of those who, seizing children from their parents' arms, dashed them against stones; and as for the fair-formed women and the maidens who had been raised in seclusion — what need have we to set down their disgraces in writing as well? Do you see the measure of evils, when God gives men over out of His hands, how unbearable it is?

And because food failed for man and beast, they, driven by the force of need, went up through Khordzean; and since, from fear of them, the roads had been cut, and the snow still held the land in its thickness, they made their marches twice over: first, forming the horses and mules into a herd, they drove them unladen and opened a road, and afterward brought the captives and the baggage behind. And by these marches they came to the head of the district, to the village called Mormreans. And since the village had a fortress, all the inhabitants of the place had gathered there. Now when the Persian arrived, he made camp, for he supposed cavalry lay within the fortress; the snow having packed hard, he made ready for battle. And their chief, going before the fortress, began to speak certain words to the one who was lord within it; the snow lay covered with many tents; and he, sitting upon it and holding his shield before him, spoke out hellish words with great-minded arrogance — but the lord who was within the stronghold, having waited for the opportune moment, at the tilting of the shield struck him through the throat with an arrow and killed him on the spot. And because a company of Romans was coming up behind, who at that very moment sounded their trumpets, when the lawless ones heard it they took to flight; and those who were in the fortress went out and brought in as many captives and as much plunder as they could — but the Romans had not yet come up. Now when the Persian saw that there was no other army, he turned

back, and cut down those of the plunderers whom he met, and took the rest and turned back. And going near the borders of Eghnut, they too went out and, giving battle, rescued many captives, and were filled with plunder, which they took and brought into the fortress. But as for those blood-drinking beasts, driven back and forced into the passes, as they entered the borders of Taron, troops came down from the mountain called Simn, which by the custom of men is called Sanasunk' after the name of their forefather; and closing with them, they conquered and cut down all of them; and having rescued the booty and the captives, they returned rejoicing and glorifying God.

In this same year they burned the beautiful palace of St. Karapet, which a certain Hrahat, one of the officials of the great Grigor son of Vasak, had built with great effort, while they were still lords of the land — the antechamber that stood before St. Karapet, which he had adorned with fitting beauty for the glory and honor of the great martyr and Forerunner of Christ; and also the other buildings, and the wooden-built church which they call St. Grigor. And it was the five hundred and seventh year of our era when this thus came to pass.

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Concerning the Evil Sect of the Tondrakians, Which Appeared in the District of Hark' and Troubled Many

A certain bishop Yakobos, who held the oversight of the churches of the house of Hark', showed forth in himself, at the beginning of his rule, the outward form of virtue — clothed in sackcloth, fasting, going barefoot. And he chose for himself priests who went about continually with him, coarse in dress and unadorned, cut off from delicious foods, and always occupied with the singing of psalms. And by this outward form he moved the distant and the near to

wonder, and everyone longed to see him. And those who were greatly diseased with arrogance on account of power gave themselves over so entirely to obedience toward him that, had he commanded them to give up their very souls, there was no one who would have resisted, or dared to open his mouth and make a sound. But this was hypocrisy, and not truth; for the fruit is what makes the tree known, as we have heard from the Lord himself. In agreement with this the Apostle too writes, saying: «Even Satan disguises himself as an angel of light; what wonder then if his ministers also disguise themselves in the form of the apostles of Christ.» For just as they mix deadly drugs into familiar foods, and those who take them consume them as food and are seized by the deadly drugs — just so those who cast the hook conceal it with bait, so that the fish, deceived by the bait, may be seized by the hook — so too the workers of lawlessness: for they do not dare to show openly to anyone the pit of their own perdition, since who indeed would consent to that, even had it strongly occurred to his mind, to sink down of his own will into a pit from which there is no way to come up? For this reason, under the guise of our own pious religion, they disguise themselves so as to deceive the simple-minded, and with sweet-tasting words they beguile the minds of the innocent; for their words graze like a cancer, and just as that disease is hard to cure, so too those seized by them can scarcely hold their footing.

Concerning them our Lord himself commands, in his life-giving gospel: «Beware of the false prophets who come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly are ravening wolves.» And the Apostle likewise teaches the Philippians the same thing, admonished by the Lord's own commands: «Beware of the dogs, beware of the evil workers.» For it is easy to be on guard against an outward enemy, but it is hard to escape wars that arise from one's own kin, as befell Abel and Joseph. Now if these men were of a foreign-speaking race, whatever race they were, it would be easy for us to guard against them; but as the blessed John writes: «They went out from us, but they were not all of us» — and to have knowledge of this is hard. Of one tongue, of one race with us, sweet water and bitter welling from a single spring — though holy James spoke of this as a thing beyond belief, yet this too has come to pass among our own people:

from this same sweet spring which our all-glorious leader, descending into the depths of the earth with fifteen years of sweat-drenched labor, caused to well up for us — a spring of overflowing streams from the depth of the excavation, crystal-clear and pure according to Ezekiel's vision — into which the schismatic, rust-gushing rivulets could not make their entry. For the bulwark of truth had been firmly fortified upon the rock of faith, down to these latest times — which our very Illuminator himself foresaw with prophetic spirit: that the lambs would become wolves and pour out streams of blood. And this came to pass through the multiplying of men's lawlessness upon the earth, and through the sleep of the good householder who had been the sower of the wheat; then the enemy, finding his opportunity, sowed tares in the midst of the wheat, according to the parable of the gospel. And the dregs of bitterness were mixed in with the life-giving water that flowed as a spring from the house of the Lord; but the teachers of the church made it known in good time, and tore up the harmful tares by the root from the field of our faith, and pressed out and cleared away the dregs of bitterness, restoring the waters to health with the salt of truth, after the manner of holy Elisha's timely remedy. And so much for this; but it is time to turn our discourse back to its head, so that what we have said may prove faithful to us.

Now the firstborn attendant and confederate of the father of all evils — when the false good reputation that foolish men had spread about him had grown to this degree of strength — began thereafter to become an archer against the mark of our faith, whose arrow-tips were hardened in the fire of oak. For the man was exceedingly eloquent, and with his artful tongue he bewitched the ears of many; and on that foundation he thought to overturn the holy church, not calling to mind the Lord's own commands and the unfailing promise made to Peter: «You are the rock, and upon this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.» He did not believe this, but heard it as though it were merely some man's private saying; for which reason, entering into contention, he thought to shave off the glory of the church — as that harlot of old did the locks of Samson — so as to betray to the foreigners that unconquerable person — that is, to the despoilers of the truth, the holy Church

— which our Lord Jesus Christ purchased with his own precious blood, and, crowning it, glorified it with the all-conquering cross, setting up in it a mystical table after the pattern of the tree of life in Eden, whose deathless fruit we have surely come to know as the body of the Life-giver, according to his own unerring command: «He who eats my flesh shall never see death.» Now see for yourself his contrived cunning — how, serpent-like, through deceits he schemed to pour out corrupting poisons upon those sound in faith.

First, he began to make a selection among the priesthood according to worthiness, and he ordered the unworthy to keep silence; and when this pleased many, he then added yet another thing to it: for he commanded that the worthy should offer up the sacrifice only three times in the year. And though it is written in the Nicene canons that, however grave a sinner a man may be, one must receive his confession, and grant him communion of the Lord's body and blood, and admit him to the sacrifice and to all the ranks of Christian rite — this he would not so much as receive into his ears at all. Instead he taught thus: that whoever had not, by his own person, through which he had sinned, and by that same person done penance, was helped neither by remembrances nor by offerings on his behalf; and together with those who did his will he would set this to mockery and laugh, and they would bring forward a beast of burden and set it before them, and say as follows: "O wretched four-footed creature, granted that this one sinned in his own time and died — what sin did you commit, that you should die along with him?" And over this the people were divided into two; by some it was accepted, and by others not; and as every man remained tossed about and in doubt, seeking to understand the outcome of the matter, so too those who at that time, in deserts and in caves, by solitary austerities continually performed what was pleasing to God, with great groaning and tearful supplications sought a visitation from the beneficent Lord. Moreover a synod was convened twice, of many fathers and patriarchs and priests and a mixed multitude beyond number. But because the lords of the district were, every one of them, bound as though by chains to his hypocritical outward form, they vowed to die first, after the manner of war, rather than deliver him into the hands of the synod. And he, Nestor-like, sitting at home, with great self-

assurance, made his answer to the synod by means of messengers, having put his hope in the help of the lords and not in God — not calling to mind David's own song, that «It is better to trust in the Lord than to trust in princes»; the wretched man thought to overcome the truth by the help of men. But God, who does not allow the rod of sinners to presume upon the lot of the righteous, lest the righteous stretch out their hands to wickedness — who does the will of those who fear him, and hears their prayers; who brings calm out of storms, and brings rain in time of drought, and did this too, at the prayer of one righteous man — he came to visit us and wrought the salvation of his people, he who knows, according to his own deep wisdom, how to lay the foundation of great matters from far off, and here administered it in whatever way was, as it turned out, most beneficial. And so it came to pass.

A certain monk named Esayi, from the district of Karin, of a pious lineage, who had gone and attached himself to him on account of his good reputation — when such stirrings and inquiries were aroused concerning him, he kept watch over him with attentive care; for the man was exceedingly wise, and by showing him great familiarity he made himself appear to be one of his trusted followers. And having seen and learned of his depraved practices, he went without delay and reported them to the holy patriarch Sargis. Who, on hearing it, and having gotten to the bottom of the matter, called the wretched man to himself with gentle words, and rendered to him according to his desert; for, having released him from the priestly order, and having set upon his face the brand marked with a fox, the herald cried out concerning him: "Whoever, having crept away from the faith of the holy Illuminator, shall enter and join himself to the man-faced beasts' fold of the lawless Tondrakians, let him bear this judgment and sentence." And he ordered the utterly wretched man to be confined in prison, since he wished that he might perhaps repent, and confess, and hold himself apart from the vile sect; for he had great pity for the ruined soul.

But since, according to the words of Jeremiah, fire cannot forget its burning, nor the Indian his blackness, nor the leopard his spots — so too the evil man cannot forget his own evil-doing: for, having broken out of the prison by night and become a fugitive, he crossed into the land of the Greeks and reached the

imperial city of Constantinople, and became a slanderer of our faith, and asked to be baptized according to their own rite. But they, having informed themselves according to their own wisdom, and having gotten to the bottom of the matter, would not accept him, but said: "Him whom the Armenians have rejected and dishonored on account of his faith, we too will not receive." And when this did not succeed for him, he went off and passed into the district of Apahunik', to the dwelling-place of Satan, the assembly of the god-forsaken and the fold of beasts, called Tondrak; and there for a time he denned himself in silence. But they say that even they would not receive him, because of his still greater impurity; for which reason he went off to the mountain of Khlat', and there, finding some of his own people in the farmsteads and in more remote places, he stayed among them; and having passed his days there, he went off and died wretchedly in the city called Muharkin. Since he had not walked according to the canon of the scriptures, nor been in accord with Christians, he was to be left aside; for which reason he died like a donkey, and was buried like a carcass, leaving behind him an evil memory — so that everyone who hears this history will loose curses after him.

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How the Fire of Error Blazed Up Also in the Territory of Mananaghi: It Must Be Told

Kuntsik, a certain monk of lewd name, who dwelt near the fortress-town called Shirni — whose farmstead they still call by his own name to this day — this man, being far advanced in years, held within himself the leaven of defilement; for he had learned it from a certain monk of lewd character, who gave himself out to be from Aghuank'; but he was the firstborn of Satan, and the storehouse of his devisings, so that the smoke of the ever-blazing furnace of Gehenna went forth continually from his mouth, by which many, having taken it as medicine,

perished. Now this Kuntsik, being an active laborer for Satan, hunted down a certain woman named Hranush, who was of a leading and choice family, and mistress of a farmstead bordering his own. And when she was filled with his death-breathing venom, she was not content with her own ruin alone, but fashioned many helpers for her deceits. And first and foremost, two women who were her kinswomen — whose names are these: the one Akhni, and the other Kamara, who was indeed a true doer of Satan's will. And these two were own sisters; seized by the raging disease of harlotry, as is the custom of their fold, and by the art of sorcery they became teachers for Satan, in whom the father of all evils grew strong; who «sharpened their tongues like a sword, as the psalmist's song has it, and bent their bows to shoot bitter things» — to be archers against the upright in heart; who struck and wounded many innocent souls with grievous and deadly wounds. And since from their ancestral inheritance they held two villages, they made these ready as dens and lodging-places for the crooked serpent-dragon, in which he lodged and poured forth his venom violently; and they, acting as his cupbearers, gave those who dwelt round about them to drink unto destruction. Concerning this very thing Moses wrote, saying: «Their wine is the fury of dragons, the fury of asps, for which there is no remedy.»

A certain prince named Vrver — brother to these partisan women, having become the doer of their will — this man, being formerly sound in the faith, was foremost in the practice of piety, so much so that he built a monastery on his own inheritance, gathering ascetic brothers into it; and with ample provision he kept their life free of want, whose leader was known by the name Andreas, greatly renowned in monastic contests. To these men this prince would come every year during the fast of the Forty, and would share in their observance until the days of the great Pascha, and showed forth many other good works in their service; and also in almsgiving to the poor and in obedience to priests he showed himself more forward than many. This man the Evil One hooked by the hand of these same women, who fornicated with him indiscriminately, with a corrupting passion, giving no thought to the closeness of their blood. For these are the dens of their perdition. This is indeed also the fourth daughter of Solomon's leech.

Concerning this the divine Apostle commands: «Not,» he says, «in the passion of lust, as also the other Gentiles, who do not know God.» Do you see that this passion is a pagan one? See what manner of demonstration the divinely blessed Solomon makes concerning it: «My son,» he says, "keep yourself from entanglement with strange women; for whomever she finds among the thoughtless young, with sweet words she persuades to remain with her; for the lips of a harlot woman drip honey, which for a time sweetens the palate of those persuaded, but afterward is found more bitter than gall; for she takes and leads her companion away like a dog on a leash, and like a bull-calf to the slaughter, and like a deer struck with an arrow through the liver; and he cannot be healed of it until she brings him, body and all, down to hell — for her house is the vestibule of hell."

Ensnared by these things, that lamentable Vrrer stripped off his integrity, fell away from the faith, and became an enemy of God and of his saints. He forsook the Lord who had given him birth by the holy font, and forgot God who had fed him with his own body and blood. Having gone out from the house, having fallen from honor, he forgot the divine covenant, and withdrew from communion with the ascetic order; and the place which had once been a gathering-house of monks — which he had built at great expense and labour, where choirs of psalm-singers and companies of ministers, with sweet-voiced songs, blessed God in unison with the hosts above — today its voices are silenced, and the place lies waste and unpeopled. And after this, what then? The wretched man went and joined himself to those evil-demoned women, and the farmsteads which were their own native places, which we mentioned a little before, whose names are called the one Kashe and the other Aghyusoy — they brought all the inhabitants of those places into league with themselves; and then, raging with demonic fury, they turned the churches which had been built long ago in their own serpent-nested places into waste ground. And in the fields, wherever a fitting hour met them, they destroyed the sign of our salvation and the weapon of the Lord's victory, by which the victory over death was swallowed up and the crooked enemy's proverbs against us were removed — in which the blessed Paul, setting aside all created things, gloried in its very power: «God

forbid,» he says, «that I should glory, except only in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ» — these men, having become avengers for their father Satan, smashed it shamelessly. But since I have mentioned the cross, I will bring into my history another marvelous tale, which brings dread to all who hear it.

In a district of the Pakhra mountain, which is now called Gaylakhazut, there was a certain town of the early fathers, which they call Bazmaghbyur, where a divine sign had been set up with manifold splendid adornment; and they have changed the village's own name accordingly, calling it Khach' [Cross] to this very day. On the night of the great feast of Pentecost — which is called the new Sunday — the will-doing labourers of Satan came and, striking with a hammer the crown of the God-receiving sign, broke it in pieces and cast it to the ground, and themselves stole away unseen into their serpent-dens. At this the heaven above marveled, and the whole earth was struck with dread and trembling; the morning star made lament for the deed, and the evening star mourned harshly. Now, according to the customary order, at the hour of matins the priest arose and came before the cross to perform the office of the great Sunday; and seeing the astonishing sight, he laid hand to his collar and tore his garment, and with a loud cry at once gathered together, startled, the inhabitants of the place to see the sight. And they, seeing the great wonder, took up lamentation, beat their breasts, and wept; and there was then, of men and women, old and young, one single voice of wailing and groaning. And while they stood in this distress, understanding suddenly dawned upon them, according to God's ineffable wisdom: on the night on which the deed had been done, snow had unexpectedly fallen and whitened the face of the earth, which, having caught the tracks of the lawless men, led straight to their dens. And at once word was sent to the blessed patriarch Samuel; who, hearing it, arrived there with a great gathering, and having assembled the bishops and priests and fathers of the district, went with them and burned and destroyed the dens of the lawless men, cursing their goods and possessions, as Joshua did of old at Jericho, so that no one should dare take anything for himself. And six of them — whom they called teachers of the evil and foul rites — he had seized, and came with the assembly to the town called Jerma, and ordered their faces to be branded with the fox-mark, that this might

be for them a mark forever, plain and recognizable to all, so that no one might unknowingly have dealings with them, but that they should be hunted from among all men like an evil beast. After this he blessed the people who had labored together with him, and sent them away in peace.

Now when summer came, a judge of the laws of the land was sent forth by the king, whose name was Eghia. When he arrived in the district of Ekegheats', that most evil Vrver went out to meet him; and he brought accusation against the honored patriarch Samuel, and against the other bishops who were with him, saying: "They carried off my house as plunder, and they laid waste my village and set it on fire." And he laid upon them a debt of many treasures and possessions. When the judge heard this, being further inflamed to anger, he sent soldiers to bring the blessed bishops before him by compulsion. Now when the soldiers came, the chief of the bishops wrote letters to the diocesan clergy of the church, to the priests and to the hermits, that they should assemble to him without giving thought to anything. And as the report reached them, it was as though notice went out to everyone by God's own providence; without delay a multitude of people gathered in one place — not only of the clergy, but even more of the laity, whose number I am not able to commit to writing. And the assembly went in a great multitude as far as the bank of the river Euphrates, where the Mananaghi flows into it. And at that hour there came a downpour of rain; and from the abundance of the rain the Euphrates rose up and came full from bank to bank. Now the soldiers, having brought a boat, hastened to ferry the elderly bishop Samuel and his nephew Theodoros across to the other side, to the town called Koter, since the judge himself was there too; but the people laid hold of the bishops and would not give them into the hands of the soldiers. And they said: "First we will ferry these across, and then the people"; and having persuaded them with this word, they took the bishops with the boat and ferried them across. And having stopped the boat, he put the bishops in prison; and when the assembly understood their treachery — that they did not turn the boat back to them as they had promised — with a loud voice and with exhorting cries they encouraged one another that it was better to die crossing the waters than to hear reviling words spoken against the leaders of the faith. And since the

hour had grown toward evening, and the sun, gathering its scattered rays to itself, was turning toward its setting, giving boldness to the heaven-spanning luminary, then the ranks of the priests, coming forward, did not divide the waters by the mystery of the cross, but, holding the very sign itself of the Lord's victory in their hands and raising it upon their shoulders, with firm and steadfast faith struck the high-heaped mounds of the waters, from which, like a grass-fed horse wrenched back by the bridle, the water gave way and yielded passage to the people, not one person of all that great multitude being harmed. And when they had crossed, they sang songs of thanksgiving to God the whole night through, having as leader of their dance the immaculate Mary, who is the holy Church, holding the timbrel in her hand, that is, the truth of the faith — not voiceless and unskilled, fallen into the damp passions of schism, but warm according to the Holy Spirit, dry of those passions, and ready for resounding songs — which, struck with the Davidic tambourine, they sounded in everyone's hearing: «Praise the Lord, for he has done wonderful things,» and the words that follow after this; and with this loud voice they brought the whole night through to its close in prayers to God.

Now when the judge heard of the divine dispensation and the wonders of these miracles, he knew that the Lord was visiting our nation. Seized with trembling from great astonishment, he took refuge in prayer and called upon God for help, saying, "Let me not, Lord, unknowingly turn aside from your judgments." And at daybreak — for it was Sunday — he went to the episcopal residence called P'rris, and having set forth a just proceeding, he seated the leading men of the assembly for the trial and the judgment; and they summoned the unworthy and guilty Vrrer to come to the hearing of justice. And since there is a certain living creature which they call the cuttlefish, of which they say that it changes every color in order to escape its hunters — so too he, when he saw that he could not withstand the strengthening of the truth (for when the light dawns the darkness is spent, and when the truth is revealed falsehood perishes) — what then does he do, and what device does he contrive? He promises to become a Roman, and becomes the adopted son of the bishop, whose name was called Episarar, having stolen his mind with a bribe. And coming before the tribunal, he entreated with

supplication that he be granted to him as a favor, and the judge himself wished the same; for the brother of the lawless man was of princely rank and stout-hearted valor, one of the king's own chosen men and acquaintances, before whom the judge stood in great awe; wherefore he gave him over to the bishop's keeping, just as he had asked. But as for the others whom they found among his accomplices, having tortured them with great blows and scourging, they made them outcasts, laying waste their houses; and the assembly blessed the judge, and they were dismissed in peace.

But the judgments of God had already gone before him: for although he escaped the human punishments, he was not able to escape the hands of the All-Knowing. For suddenly his body was set ablaze with a burning heat, as was Herod's, and the fingers of his hands withered, and could no longer assist his body in taking food; moreover, the food which he ate with great suffering — its passage was blocked, so that he had to discharge the working of his refuse in reverse, until the day of his death; and afterward his very body too was corrupted with leprosy. But he did not come to repentance, nor did he remember his former piety, but was carried away by that same demonic error until he was taken from among the living; and the torments of his body constantly brought to mind the memory of the hell for which he was destined.

But their depraved deed we have judged unfitting to commit to writing, since it is exceedingly filthy; and since not everyone is steadfast in hearing, the mention of many men's sins draws the hearers into prurient itching, and even leads to the very commission of the deed; for this reason I too have kept clear of it. But what is manifest concerning them, and what must be told to us, is this: they did not accept the Church and the ordinances of the Church at all — neither baptism, nor the great and fearsome mystery of the eucharist; neither the cross, nor the ordinance of the fasts. But let us, who truly believe in the Holy Trinity, hold fast the unshaken confession of our hope, which we have learned from the holy fathers; and let us turn our faces away from their godless assembly, sending curses down upon them.

Concerning the Slaughter of the World-Renowned City of Ani, by Which...

And now, mankind has fallen into many follies and delusions, and because of extravagance and an unyielding mind they have taken refuge in their own works: mighty giants of towering stature, invincible and unconquerable — these they called sons of god. And some, fortified with a tower, holding its height unapproachable, were unwilling to taste of the cup of the Lord's goodness — like that first structure of folly, much-toiled and easily thrown down. So too the inhabitants of Jericho, because of the strength of their towers, did not count themselves among the rest of the Canaanites, as to whether the right hand of the Lord ruled over them or the sword of the Almighty drew near to them. For it is the Lord who builds and who tears down, who gives strongholds over to trembling and lofty towers to ruin. For even the tower that stood on the heights of Lebanon, which David built and fortified with sword and shield against Damascus, was no hindrance or obstacle to Eder, who rose up as an adversary to Solomon. For holiness is the stronghold, and the choice works of piety toward God are a wall.

Now let us return again to the order of what was set forth before. Let none reckon sins few or slight — those who do not repent or make atonement, or who draw upon themselves the punishment near at hand and the punishment of those who border them, which falls out according to men's transgressions: let the cypress mourn for the cedar's sake, and the bramble for the olive tree's. For it is not that all are worthy of death, according to the Lord's own word, upon whom the tower fell — but it stands as a warning that seizes those nearby on account of others' sins, and as instruction and caution for those far away. For it was not done long ago, nor has so much time passed in between as to blur the record of the calamities that befell Arcn; for those who saw it with their own eyes were not few, and they had no need of report; for there were many a land

and city that survived that onslaught, but they grew stubborn in their minds, and by their very fortifications rebelled — not against men, but against God, who gives high towers over to trampling and fortified cities to mounds of earth. They neither understood nor took to heart the fear of the Lord and the threats that come from him, and they reckoned as exhausted the dregs of wrath and fury that are poured down for sinners to drink. Above all the stronghold of Ani, and its daughter towns round about it, being schooled all the more in arrogance, kicked against heaven itself — until God stirred up the king of the Persians to act in his own stead, to see what would be done in it. A work of war came upon the land of the Armenians, to extend their own habitations and to rule over the territory of another kingdom; and it was the five hundred and thirteenth year of our era.

Now the king came, advancing with many myriads and countless men-at-arms. Having entered into our land, he brought fear and dread upon those far and near. He trampled, he overthrew many lands, until he reached the city that held its own sins in full measure. He pitched his tent opposite the city of Ani, and spread out his camp across the breadth of the land. He strove and contrived to tear away the iron gate and the bronze bolts that stood against his own dominion; and having grown hopeless on account of its strength, although he pressed the assault the harder, he was minded to march away. And he did not know that the Lord had cast discord and disunity, tumult and division, among the guards and the princes; and thereupon they abandoned the work of war and turned to flight, and, panic-stricken with fear, no one looked to kinsman or close friend, but each one was seized with terror. And the armed troops who were fighting outside, seeing this, made a way for themselves up over the wall opposite them, and poured into the bosom of the city like a surge of the sea's waves, and, putting the Persian sword to work, spared no one. But a multitude of men and women rushed to the palaces of the kings, as though they might survive there, and others escaped to the stronghold called Nerk'i berd. And as for those who had fortified themselves within the city — when the enemy learned that they were unprepared, having among them neither fighting men

nor food and drink, they swiftly surrounded them and pressed them with sudden distress, until they forced them out against their will.

There one might see the grief and the anguish of every age of life: infants were snatched from their mothers' arms and mercilessly dashed against stone, and the mothers drenched their children with blood and tears. One sword slaughtered father and son alike; for the old and the young, priests and deacons, received the same taste of death from the sword. For the city was filled from end to end, and the road itself was made of the bodies of the slain; for from the multitude of the slaughtered and the countless corpses, the great stream that runs by the city was dyed with blood, and wild beasts and tame became the grave of the corpses, for there was none to bury and cover the slaughtered with the earth they were owed. And moreover, from the very fat of the injustice wrought within it, the high-built and beautifully-adorned mansions were burned down, and the whole habitation became like a heap of earth; and the usury and the deceit that were within it were brought to an end.

This is the portion of unjust cities, which build themselves up with the blood of strangers, and grow rich from the sweat of the poor, and fortify their own houses through usury and injustice; and they themselves, holding their minds without mercy toward the poor and the needy, attend only to ease and luxury, and do not shrink from deeds of filthiness, but are wholly intoxicated by the lusts which have taken them to themselves. And now what befalls them at the coming of the Lord's wrath? They are consumed and waste away like wax before fire, whether it be a king or a prince, as we have learned from these writings. But the king of the Persians, having taken possession of many provinces, returned to his own land with countless plunder.

Concerning the King of the Greeks, Who Was Taken Captive by the King of the Persians

Now it is not fitting to become a narrator of things beyond one's reach and not to be undertaken, or to commit them to writing — matters for which no labor of others has been handed down to us, nor was it demanded of us by anyone, nor are we ourselves able to set our hand to it. For that reason we have passed over much of the necessary history bound up with these matters, leaving it to others more skilled and richer in mind, that perhaps someone among them may take it up; and in this I stir rivalry in those who are able. But we have reckoned it no small failing to pass over in silence the spectacle of war between the two kings; rather, let us settle great matters in few words.

Now the king Diogenes, who was the sixtieth from the great Constantine by the reckoning of the kings — a little more or less — when he saw that the king of the Persians had cut off no small part of land from his own kingdom, and had put the governors of the Greeks to flight, and had himself returned to his own land with great plunder and captives, then the king of the Greeks, ten years later, took upon himself the work of war, in keeping with his zealous and valiant nature, lest he appear cowardly and base, and leave behind him a base memory. Vaunting himself, and with great fury, as though crossing the sea as over dry land, he passed over, and, encamping in the land of the Bithynians, gathered to himself a boundless multitude. For he still held the wide and spacious extent of the kingdom's border, from the valleys of the Phoenicians, where great Antioch stands, as far as the fortress of Van, and the whole land of Rshtunik' facing Her. When he saw so great a multitude of troops gathered in one place, he grew proud and was lifted up in his mind, thinking he would not be overcome by earth-born kings, and he did not call to mind the word of the prophet — that it is not a multitude of troops that can save the king, nor the giant by his own strength, but the right hand and arm of the Almighty.

Now he conceived some unseemly plan in his mind, and sent much of the army by another road under the hand of his generals; and he himself, with a great

multitude, took the eastward road and came, arriving at the great city of Theodosiopolis, and there arrayed the cavalry. Grievous are sins, and they strip away sonship and wisdom from those who commit them; but arrogance still more so, by which princes and kings are led astray, and are not persuaded by the memory of the earlier arrogant ones who were brought to ruin — for this same disease of wickedness corrupts all who bear it, since it is not that anyone else stands opposed to the arrogant man, but God himself is his adversary, as the proverb-maker says. For this reason he did not allow the troops rest enough for other multitudes to come and gather to him, and encourage one another to valor and vigor, and become a great host, terrible to the enemy; but he chose instead to press the work of war forward with his own forces alone. He came swiftly to where the king of the Persians had encamped, at the borders of the district of Manazkert, and there pitched his royal tent facing the Persian host, fortified himself round about, and set a day for battle.

But the king of the Persians, out of fear, sought battle by cunning, lest the scattered troops, coming together, should reinforce the king, and the line of battle become unassailable to him. He reckoned it better to stand against two parts than against three. He stirred up urgent alarm, until at last the Greek line of battle was formed, against its own will, facing the arrayed line of the Persians. And when, vaunting themselves, they rushed upon one another, and clashed against one another with warlike display, and as yet the defeat of neither host appeared — then suddenly one great division, among whom there was no piety, rebelling against the king of the Greeks, went over to the side of the enemy. On account of this there was great breaking of the troops; and from then on they advanced into the ranks with hesitation and not with valor, and, having provoked the Persians, they made them vigorous and unassailable. But the king of the Greeks, without cause and unaware, was filled with wrath against the troops of the Armenians and against their people, and looked upon them with an evil eye; but when he saw the single-hearted fighting and the valiant struggle of the brave men — who did not shrink before the skilled bowmen of the Persians, but stood opposed to the contest with courage, and did not turn their backs, though many had fallen away from love of the king, yet with a single

mind took death upon themselves, so that even after death a fitting memory of their valor, with singleness of mind, might be left behind — then he showed an ill-timed love, and promised gifts beyond the reach of undertaking.

There the king, looking up from where he sat, and watching, kept his eye upon his rivals; and seeing his own troops panic-stricken and turned to flight, then and there swiftly put on the array of an armed soldier, and came like lightning to the line of battle. And among the brave men of the Persians he laid many low, strewn as corpses, and brought sudden distress upon the troops. But he did not know this: that the commander of the Lord's host was not with him — he who appeared to Joshua and gave the victory. Nor did the Lord go forth with our troops with weapon and shield, nor did he draw the sword against the enemy and bar their way, nor did the Lord of hosts gird himself about the waist, nor did the Lord become for us a horn of salvation and of hope. Rather, gathering his strength back into himself, away from us, he delivered us into the hands of our enemies and into the reproach of our neighbors, and gave us up like sheep to the slaughter. Our bows were shattered, and our weapons broken; our soldiers grew weak and gave way; for the Lord took away his strength and the heart of courage from our soldiers and from our princes, took the sword and the might from them, and gave it to the enemy, on account of their unfitting conduct.

Now that world-ruler and lord of the great throne, taken captive like some cowardly slave of sin, they set before the king of the Persians. But God, who strikes and who heals, whose loving-kindness is boundless in its sweetness, and who does not strike utterly down the one he corrects, but forbears with a brief trial, that we may know our own weakness — he spared and honored the lord of his own footstool-throne, and cast into the heart of the beast-minded king of the Persians love and care as toward a beloved brother; and with much ease and care released him.

And now, him whom God had freed and drawn out, snatched from the hand of the foreigner — his own people, with treachery and disgrace, darkened the lights of his eyes and slew him, and shed indelible blood upon that kingdom. From that time the strength of the princes and of the soldiers was taken away, and

victory was not granted to that kingdom; and the princes stood toward one another with treachery and envy, and abolished the justice of judgments; they only laid the land waste and worked no deliverance — until the Lord, in the anger of his wrath, summoned many nations to work their own vengeance, from the Mountains of the Moon and from the great river that passes to the north of India: foreign-tongued and evil nations, to come pouring like many waters upon our lands, to lay their foundations by the shore of the sea of Ocean, and pitch their tents facing the great city, and fill all the land with blood and with corpses, and abolish the order and the religion of Christianity.

But when the king of the Persians, Alp Arslan, saw such great victory as had come into his hand, and the success of three wars — for in the first, though Manazkert itself remained untaken, he laid low much land besides by sword and captivity; and in the second he made Ani a waste and a desert by slaughter of the sword and by fire — for this reason he came to meet the king of the Greeks with a fearless and haughty spirit. And he made a vow in his mind: "If he is taken into my grasp, I will release him with love and honor to his own kingdom." And by oath the covenant was confirmed, that there should be peace between the kingdom of the Persians and that of the Greeks. But when it came to pass that he was raised up in this war as well, and whatever he desired came to pass and was accomplished, and he before whom the other had once trembled and been afraid now stood in fetters before him at his feet, like one of his own servants — then he remembered the covenant he had made with God, and rising, seated him at his right hand, and honored him as a faithful friend, and made a covenant with him, saying: "From now on let there be no strife between me and you; but hold your kingdom in peace, and we our Persian dominion. But what I took in war shall be mine, and let us invade your lands no more." And he released him with great honor. After this, when he learned that he had been seized by the treachery of his own nakharars, and they deprived him of his eyes, and he did not attain to the kingdom but died in torments, he was filled with turmoil and wrath, and wished to repay it for his friend's sake; but death overtook him there, and he went out from this world after all the earth-born, where kings and paupers are together.

Discourse of Commemoration Concerning This Very Book

I have judged it needful to remind, by this writing, our beloved brethren, for the knowledge of matters made known — even as it was the beginning of my discourse to tell, in few words, of God's foreknowledge, of His boundlessness. How the swift-coursing and world-surveying element, beautiful and luminous — while it still shone with perfect light, and held the midpoint of its course, hastening with swift motion along its path into the shadowless hemisphere, holding the earth beneath it — cast upon itself a wide-spread garment woven of long-gathered sins. And it wrapped so thickly about it that it hindered the boundless brightness of its rays; and that which is not usually visible boldly to the eye appeared fainter than the stars, showing only its bare circle. This showed forth in itself, as a figure, the shadowless and luminous orders of the Church shut in by darkness; and the brightness of souls and the rays of the path of virtue, made invisible and dim. For from that time — which I spoke of before, in which was the year of the Armenians four hundred and eighty-two — even until now, the covenant of holiness and the order of the Church have been broken up and corrupted. And we heard no report of peace or glad tidings of good things; nor was any monument of victory raised up — neither for kings nor for princes. Nor was this all: not even could the monks find strength to set their face against the war-loving demon; but, grown feeble and powerless, intemperate and stubborn, fallen under the hand of enemies, the land became full and overflowing with tumult and wrath. For step by step its darkening proved a true prophecy; for from that time enemies rushed upon us, and clothed us with a garment of mourning and sadness, and joy was taken away from the world.

Now when such calamities of doubt and world-groaning birth-pangs had spread over all the earth, and a fire went forth from the south and consumed the high strongholds, and melted away the unapproachable towers as though they were wax, kings and princes grew few and failed, and the hope of expectation of

refuge was taken from us. But the wrath of the Lord's fury spread universally over us; for houses of prayer were pulled down, and stones anointed with the oil of holiness were laid as the foundation of the palaces of foreigners; and the service of holiness was taken away from our midst, and we became a mockery and a reproach to the heathen. And we wasted away and were bowed down, and our loins clove to the earth; and we became like dried bones, in which there was no hope of breath or of life; and the transgressions of our fathers were filled up and accomplished in us, demanding of us the debt of vengeance for our forebears. Sevenfold recompense we received into our bosom; for the name of Christianity was accounted a reproach and a mockery for scorn. For justice and judgment were taken from us, and there was no place for our tears and our groans; for their piety consisted in this — to defraud us, and to plunder us, and to kill us. Even the necessary garment that covered our shame seemed evil to them; rather, when they saw us naked and disgraced, at this they rejoiced the more. For amid the many afflictions that befell us, worn thin and troubled, we wandered upon the earth like a shadow, trembling and terrified; our food was without strength, and our drink bitter from fear and from the threats of our masters. For they did not believe that we had a God in heaven, or that our prayers and supplications could reach Him. For the Lord willed to afflict us with such tortures, and to persecute and torment us, and to cast every age under torment; to expel and cast us out from His presence, as those liable to punishment and transgressors; to scatter and remove us far among foreign nations, that perhaps He might restrain our rebellious and disobedient mind, and our stiff-neckedness; to cast us beneath the rod of His correction, as Israel in the days of Elijah, and Samaria in the days of Elisha. For they had some portion of hope: the oversight of kings and of princes, and, above all else, the grace-filled and joy-bringing word of the prophets, by which they were strengthened, and were able to stand against the affliction of the trials that they received from the Lord. But ours is heavier and greater than all of theirs: without king and without prince; without lord and without overseer, in soul and in body, and there is not one place of refuge for us to find; but we are grown faint and are made subject to stand beneath the kingdom of the heathen, and to receive day

by day the fierce blow of their rod. For in that we did not serve the Lord, let us serve foreigners; and in that we despised the fear of the Lord, let us be tormented day by day with fear of these; and because we offered service to the Lord with sloth, let us serve and minister to these by day and by night. For it was not according to our transgressions that He disciplined us, but in compassion and mercy He cast us into the furnace of correction, to make us sober and to render us useful.

For if You should set our sins in the balance, they are heavier than the correction we have received from You, and Your punishment is lighter than our debt. Cast upon us every extremity of torment, but do not cast us away from Your face, O Lord; and stir up against us every wave of trial, but do not reject us from Your love, O Lord. It is better to fall into Your hands and receive from You correction and punishment, than to stand apart from You uncorrected; it is better to draw near to You through suffering and affliction, than to withdraw from You and live in ease and comfort. This is enough for us: that Your holy name has been called upon us, accounting us to Yourself as an inheritance, to acquire us for Yourself as a people of the new covenant by precious blood. Now do not abandon us from Your hand for the sake of Your creative will, lest we be utterly tormented by the heathen who hate You; for all this, and more than this book can record, has come upon us on account of our sins.

And now we have judged it enough to write down all the surging waves of turmoil that occurred in our days; and to divide them into particulars — whatever befell, place by place, land by land, and city by city — whatever we suffered from the heathen. For not for a single day, nor for one season, did we meet with ease or comfort; but the whole time of our days was filled with turmoil and affliction; and day by day it added yet more to our torments and our sufferings. And not one of them was well-disposed toward us, though for many years they dwelt among us; their fury was not restrained, like that of a viper, nor was there any satiety of their greed, like that of fire; for all their designs concerning us are in wickedness, and their words are full of deceit. For every morning they made a fresh beginning of evils; for this was the design of them all — to wear us down and consume us like a worn-out garment, and to remove

our memory from among them, that they should never look upon us and see us alive; but that our graves should be left without trace beneath their feet.

For this reason we have felt the lack of the ancient chroniclers' history, that with fitting and well-suited words of their own they might set down this book, gathering together without error, into one, whatever befell of present things and of past, leaving behind them a record of the things that came to pass, as the historiography of the ancients shows. But what has been written here in this book is not in full, but only the beginning of the things that came to pass and passed over us; for we were not able fully to call to mind or to write the completion of these matters. But all this we have set down for this reason: that you may read and know that sin was the cause of all this that has passed over us. That, looking upon us, you may be struck with dread to fear before the face of the Lord, and to tremble at the terror of His power; to come before Him early with confession and repentance, arriving before His chastisement is stirred up, and to stand against it.

NOTES

These notes are keyed by chapter and by lemma. No cue for them appears on the reading page. References to the source are to the printed pages and marginal line numbers of the controlling edition (Yuzbashyan, Erevan 1963), given as **p. 23 l. 13**.

I. Textual notes

Uncertain readings and consequential textual decisions. Where a crux is genuinely open, it is left open here: a defensible rendering stands in the text and the problem is stated, rather than a confident guess being made in the reader's name.

The title of the work

The title, p. 21 ll. 1–3. The edition's own table of contents, p. 155, reads յալլաստնն where the main text reads ՅԱՅԼԱԶԳԵԱՆ, siding with the manuscript variant ABCDԼԻ յալլաստն. Both give much the same sense — *of foreign kind* against *of foreign nation*. The printed main text is followed; the contents-page reading is recorded here and not adopted.

The Chapter 1 heading, p. 21. The editor notes that in every manuscript the heading of Chapter Ա runs on directly from the general title of the work: the division into title block, numeral and heading is his presentation of one transmitted rubric, and it is kept as he prints it. The apparatus at the foot of the page collates both items across the manuscripts, so both are transmitted source text and both are translated. **No heading is supplied for the verse proem:** «Նախերգանք» is the reading of manuscript S alone, reported in the apparatus and not constituted by the editor.

Chapter 1

առաւիր, p. 23 l. 13. The print reads առաւիր, which yields no construable sense in the clause. This is a difficulty in the manuscript tradition, not a defect of the scan: the letters are legible. The printed reading is **not emended**. The English rests on the correction անիրաւ recorded by the corrector C, and this note is that reliance made explicit.

Chapter 2

Ջորոյ or Ջորոյ, p. 26 l. 11. The initial is an italic capital, and Ջ and Ջ are not separable from one another at the resolution of the available images. The reading affects a name.

ապաժոյժ, p. 30 l. 22, and **զաչացունսն**, p. 30 l. 23. The letters of both words are secure; the sense is not. They are rendered *what is past enduring* and *that had eyes*, each a defensible construal of a word that is otherwise unattested in this form.

Chapter 3

The chapter heading, p. 32. The heading announces matter that the narrative does not reach until Chapter 4. The discrepancy is the edition's, and behind it the tradition's. **No English was added to the chapter to make its heading fit**, and none was removed from the heading.

Chapter 5

զլարս, p. 41 l. 5. The print sets three letters where two are expected, the middle one identical in every measured feature to the ղ of neighbouring words on the same page. A medial ղ is impossible in Classical Armenian, no apparatus entry stands at the line, and the clause requires լար. This is a foul sort in the printer's forme, not a reading, and the English translates the sense the clause requires: *the cords of the tent*.

Chapter 16

Հատկիմ, p. 86 l. 17. Rendered *I am broken*. The sense is construed from the context, not established from other attestations.

Հիմենացի, p. 87. Carried into the English by transliteration. The word is not identified, and the English asserts nothing about it beyond what the sentence around it requires.

Chapter 17

բնակիտ, p. 99. Carried by transliteration, on the same footing as **Հիմենացի** above.

The editor's last three starred references, pp. 100–101. The stars that key the editor's scripture notes on these two pages appear **displaced by one** relative to the quotations they identify. The displacement is the edition's own. It is preserved as printed and not repaired; the identifications given in section II below follow the quotations, not the stars.

Chapter 18

տառեղունքն, p. 104. A bird, species unidentified. The English carries the word and identifies nothing.

The scripture note on p. 110. The editor's centred note above the apparatus rule keys a reference to line 27 of a page that ends at line 26. The anomaly is the edition's own and stands as printed.

Chapter 19

զարձան, p. 111 l. 22. The print sets զարձան where the sense and the grammar both require դարձան, *they turned*. The printed non-word is **kept as printed** in the Armenian record and the English translates the required sense. No silent emendation was made, and this note is the disclosure.

սինքրորք, p. 111 l. 18. Rendered *those left, bereft*. A disclosed construal.

Chapter 21

երեմեան, p. 115 l. 6. This word is **not represented in the English**. It is unresolved on the project's own record, and no rendering could be given that would not manufacture a precision the evidence does not carry. The gap is deliberate and is stated here rather than left silent.

ի շիփս, p. 118 l. 15. Unresolved. Carried by transliteration.

The quotation at p. 115. Attributed in the text to God in the days of Moses, at the ten plagues. The edition supplies no reference for it, and it is not identified here.

Chapter 22

օցսողաց, p. 122 l. 3. Rendered *despoilers*. A disclosed construal.

Chapter 23

Khach' [Cross], p. 126. The bracketed word here is the **translator's** gloss, not the source editor's supplement. Everywhere else in this edition square brackets mark the editor's supplied text, and this single exception is recorded rather than removed.

Chapter 24

The chapter heading, p. 134. The printed heading ends ՈՐՈՎ, which leaves it syntactically open, and it is translated as it stands: *...by which....* The edition's own table of

contents, p. 157, reads սրով, and its apparatus records BCDEI սրոյ; both give *by the sword*, and both would close the sentence. **The printed main text is followed.** The divergence is recorded here and not adopted.

The authorial colophon

Its status. The closing *Discourse of Commemoration Concerning This Very Book* is the only headed unit in the volume without a numeral. It is the author's own composition and the work's conclusion, and it is **not** a twenty-sixth chapter. The work ends with it, at p. 145 l. 30.

II. Scripture identifications

Every quotation of scripture the text makes, and every clear allusion, with its reference and the provenance of that reference. Where the reference is the edition's own it is the editor's identification; where it is not, it was identified in this project, or it is left unidentified. Aristakes quotes from memory, conflates and misremembers, and the fidelity of each quotation is stated: **the English always translates his Armenian, and never substitutes the wording of an English Bible.** Entries are keyed by the printed page and line and by the opening words of the Armenian; in the text, these are the passages set in « ».

Chapter 1

- p. 23 ll. 6-8 — «Ընդ առաւօտս որպէս դալարի բուսցին, ընդ առաւօտս որպէս դալարի... — Psalms 89 (LXX; 90 Hebrew), 5-6. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 23 ll. 21-25 — «Փոխանակ զի ոչ ախորժեաց ժողովուրդդ այդ զջուրն Սելովմայ որ... — Isaiah 8 and 7, 8:6-7 conflated with 7:6. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; The waters of Siloam and Rezin are Isaiah 8:6; The son of tabel is isaiah 7:6. The editor's note names only 8:6-7.
- p. 24 ll. 19-20 — «Ամենայն թագաւորութիւն բաժանեալ յանձն՝ ոչ կարէ կեալ» — Mark 3:24. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 25 ll. 4-5 — «Առաջ նորա դրախտ փափկութեան, և վերջ նորա դաշտ ապականութեան» — Joel 2:3. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 21 ll. 10-11 — Ապականեաց ամենայն մարմին զճանապարհս իւր, / Եւ երկիր լցաւ... — Genesis 6:11-12. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 21 l. 9 — Եւ ել աղաղակ մեր առաջի Աստուծոյ: — Genesis 18:20-21. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; Exodus

3:9 is an equally available echo.

- **p. 21 l. 13** — ժողովուրդ և քահանայ ստեաց Աստուծոյ. — **Hosea 4:9**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- **p. 22 l. 1** — Եւ դարձան փառք մեր յապականութիւն: — **Hosea 4:7**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- **p. 22 l. 2** — Շունչ ի մեզ ոչ մնաց, — **Daniel 10:17**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; Joshua 2:11 is an equally available echo.
- **p. 22 l. 5** — Եւ դժոխք շատ ասել ոչ կամեցան. — **Proverbs 30:15-16**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; Isaiah 5:14 is an equally available echo.
- **p. 22 ll. 19-21** — Բարձան ուրախութիւնք յերկրէ, / Լոեցին ձայնք քնարաց, / Լոեցին... — **Isaiah 24, 8 and 11**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 2

- **p. 26 ll. 1-2** — «Լցաւ երկիր գիտութեամբ տեառն՝ իբրև գշտուր Բազումս որ ծածկեն... — **Isaiah 11:9**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- **p. 30 ll. 19-20** — «Հատուցէ, ասէ, յանդիման ատելեացն իւրոց, և ոչ յամեցուցէ» — **Deuteronomy 7:10**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- **p. 30 ll. 16-17** — որպէս զի որդիք որ ծնանիցին՝ յարիցեն և պատմեցեն զայս... — **Psalms 78 (Hebrew; 77 LXX), 5-7**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- **p. 31 l. 7** — զկէսն ի գրկաց մարցն առեալ զքարի հարկանէին — **Psalms 137 (Hebrew; 136 LXX), 9**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- **p. 31 ll. 11-13** — Սակայն այսու ամենայնի ոչ շիջաւ բարկութիւն նորա. այլ տակաւին... — **Isaiah 5 and 9, 5.25; 9.12, 17, 21; 10.4**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; Isaiah repeats the refrain five times; Aristakes uses it once and does not name the prophet.

Chapter 3

- **p. 34 ll. 9-10** — և կամ ի վերայ աազոյ շինուած, որ ի բախել... — **Matthew 7:26-27**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a

quotation.

- p. 34 ll. 16-17 — կամ իբրև զհզոր այր՝ զի թափէ զգինի — **Psalms 77:65**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; Armenian psalm numbering; = Ps. 78.65 in the Hebrew/English numbering.

Chapter 4

- p. 38-39 ll. 38.23-39.2 — «Ես մատնեցի զժողովուրդ իմ ի ձեռս քո. և դու... — **Isaiah 47:6**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 39 ll. 39.15-16 — «Ոչ, ասէ, իրով զօրութեամբ զօրանայ հզօրն, այլ տէր տկարացուցանէ... — **1 Kingdoms 2:9**. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; Runs together the two limbs of 1 Kgdms 2:9-10, which the Armenian Bible separates; ասէ stands INSIDE the quotation.
- p. 37 ll. 37.8-10 — որպէս ի հնումն յաւուրսն Յովրամայ՝ Սովաբացիքն ի վերայ Իսրայէլի... — **4 Kingdoms 3:21-27**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 39 ll. 39.4-5 — որպէս առ Սովսէսի Եգիպտոս հարաւ կարկտիս և եղեմամբ, որ... — **Exodus 9:23-26**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 40 l. 40.9 — պատուէր ետ նմա՝ որպէս Դաւիթ Սողոմոնի — **3 Kingdoms 2:1-9**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 40 ll. 40.11-12 — Եւ ինքն առեալ զոտս ի մահիճն իւր պակասեաց — **Genesis 49:33**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 6

- p. 43 ll. 43.20-21 — «Ամենայն որ հարցի ընդ վիմիս ընդ այսմիկ փշրեսցի. և... — **Matthew 21:44**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 44 ll. 44.8-9 — «Բարի է յուսալ ի տէր և յաղօթս սրբոց, քան... — **Psalms 117:9**. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; The author adds two limbs the verse does not have: and in the prayers of the saints, and in the abundance of treasures. Both additions are the argument of his chapter and both are translated as he wrote them.
- p. 44 ll. 44.9-10 — քանզի ոչինչ օգնեն ինչք յաւուր բարկութեան — **Proverbs 11:4**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a

quotation.

Chapter 9

- p. 46 ll. 46.7-13 — Դանիէլ յիւրում մարգարէութեանն՝ զոր ետես, որոյ զլուխն ոսկի էր,... — **Daniel 2:32-35**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; quoted loosely; Aristakes names FOUR members where Daniel names five, and his words are not the Armenian Bible's: gluxn / t'ikunk'n ew dzerrk'n / mejk'n ew koghk'n / srunk'n ew otk'n. The English follows HIS words - head / back and hands / middle and sides / legs and feet - and does NOT import Daniel's breast, belly or thighs.
- p. 48 l. 48.18 — «Զչարսն չարաւ կորուսցէ» — **Matthew 21:41**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 49 ll. 49.18-20 — «Եղիցին ատուրք այնոքիկ նեղութեանց՝ որպիսիք ոչ եղեն ի ներքոյ... — **Mark 13:19**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 51 ll. 51.16-19 — որպէս խոտ տանեաց, որ մինչչև ի բուռն եկեալ էր՝... — **Psalms 128:6-8**. the reference is the edition's own; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 10

- p. 53 ll. 53.6-9 — Մի պարծեսցի հզօրն ի զօրութիւն իւր, և մի մեծն... — **1 Kingdoms + Jeremiah 2 + 9, 10 + 23-24**. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; 1 Kgs 2.10 run together with Jer 9.23-24; the author's own aside որպէս ի գրոց յուսք stands INSIDE the quotation marks.
- p. 53 l. 53.11 — Եղջիր նորա բարձր եղիցի փառօք — **Psalms 111:9-10**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 53 l. 53.21 — Մի մխեր զձեռն քո ի դմա, զի օծեալ տեսան... — **1 Kingdoms 24:7**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 53 ll. 53.22-23 — Գտի այր ըստ սրտի իմոյ, որ արասցէ զհաճոյս իմ — **Acts 13:22**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 54 ll. 54.1-2 — Վայ է նոցա զի կամեցան թագաւորել և ոչ ինել — **Unidentified**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 54 l. 54.6 — Յաթոռն Մովսեսի նստան դպիրքն և փարիսեցիքն — **Matthew 23:2**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 54 ll. 54.9-11 — Ամենայն անձն, ասէ, որ ընդ իշխանութեամբ իցէ, ի հնազանդութեան... — **Romans 13:1**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted

loosely.

- p. 54 ll. 54.13-14 — Որ հակառակ կայ իշխանութեանն, Աստուծոյ հրամանին հակառակ կայ. և... — **Romans 13:2-3**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 54 l. 54.19 — Դու ծանեար զյետին իմ և զառաջին իմ — **Psalms 138:5**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 54 ll. 54.20-21 — Չիք ինչ արարած աներեւոյթ յերեսաց նորա — **Hebrews 4:13**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 54 ll. 54.21-23 — Որ նստիս ի քերովբէս և հայիս յանդունդս, գովեալ ես... — **Daniel 3:54**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 55 ll. 55.1-2 — Տէր յերկնից յերկիր նայեցաւ — **Psalms 13:2**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 55 ll. 55.2-5 — Աչք տեսոն բարձունք են, և մարդ տառապեալ. և խոնարհեցի... — **Isaiah 2:11**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 55 ll. 55.16-17 — Անդ հան ողնի ձագս և սնոյց առանց երկիւղի զորդիս... — **Isaiah 34:15**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 60 l. 60.18 — Ոչ ևս յաւելուցու յառնել — **Psalms 40:9**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 60 ll. 60.23-61.1 — Ճանապարհք Սիովնի, ասէ, սգան, զի ոչ որ է որ... — **Lamentations 1:4**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 61 ll. 61.7-9 — Ոչ, ասէ, ոսկեղինօք և արծաթեղինօք գնեալ ազատեցայք ի ձեր... — **1 Peter 1:18-19**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 61 ll. 61.13-14 — ապականեաց գնա խոզ անտառի, և կինն վայրի ճարակեցաւ ի... — **Psalms 79:14**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.

Chapter 11

- p. 65 ll. 65.11-13 — «Ցայլվայր եկեցես, և այլ մի ևս յաւելուցուս, այլ այդրէն... — **Job 38:11**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 66 l. 66.5 — «Մատն Աստուծոյ է այս» — **Exodus 8:19**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 66 ll. 66.6-7 — «Ո՛չ գիտեմ գտէր, և զԻսրայէլ ո՛չ արձակեմ» — **Exodus 5:2**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 66 ll. 66.18-19 — «Դադարեցէք, ասէ, ի չարեաց ձերոց, և ուսարուք զբարիս զործել» — **Isaiah 1:16-17**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.

- p. 67 ll. 67.3-6 — «Գալիլեացիքն, ասէ, զորոց արինսն Պիղատոս խառնեաց ընդ զոհս նոցա... — Luke 13:4-5. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; The edition keys 13:4-5, but the Galileans and Pilate are Luke 13:1-2; the author runs vv. 1-3 together with the formula of vv.
- p. 67 l. 67.11 — «Լալ ընդ լացօղսն» — Romans 12:15. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 68 ll. 68.12-14 — «Զմնացորդսն թրթրոյն եկեր մարախն, և զմնացորդս մորեխին եկեր ջորեակն,... — Joel 1:4. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 68 ll. 68.21-22 — «Գազանք անապատի եկայք կերէ՛ք զայս որ յանտառիս է» — Isaiah 56:9. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 69 ll. 69.11-12 — «Թերևս, ասէ, զոջասցի Աստուած, և դարձցի սրտմտութիւն նորա ի... — Jonah 3:9. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 69 ll. 69.14-15 — և մեք չարագանեալք և կործանեալք և տեսարան աշխարհի եղեալ.... — 1 Corinthians 4:9. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 73 ll. 73.23-74.2 — Լերինք Սմբատայ, մի անկցի ի վերայ ձեր անձրև, և... — 2 Kingdoms 1:21. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation; The author substitutes Լերինք Սմբատայ for the mountains of Gilboa and rewrites the second half.

Chapter 12

- p. 75 ll. 75.18-19 — «Անիծեալ է, ասէ, որ յափշտակէ զարտս ընկերին» — Deuteronomy 27:17. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 75 ll. 75.20-22 — «Վայ, ասէ, այնոցիկ, որ յարեն գտուն ի տուն եւ... — Isaiah 5:8-9. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 76 l. 76.6 — «Խոտեցին այնոքիկ որ ընտրեալ են արծաթով» — Psalms 67:31. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 76 ll. 76.10-11 — «Փոխանակ, ասէ, զի հպարտացան դստերք Սիովնի, եւ գնացին ի... — Isaiah 3:16. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 76 l. 76.18 — «Փոխանակ, ասէ, ոսկի զարդուցն, գլխոյն կնտութիւն» — Isaiah 3:24. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 76 ll. 76.20-21 — «Փոխանակ ոսկի կամարացն չուան գօտի. եւ փոխանակ պատուական հանդերձիցն... — Isaiah 3:24. the reference is the

edition's own; quoted loosely.

- p. 77 ll. 77.4-5 — «Թէ՛ն ո՛չ առաւելուցու արդարութիւն ձեր աւելի քան զդպրացն եւ... — **Matthew 5:20**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 77 ll. 77.17-18 — «Ընդէ՞ր տէր կացեր ի հեռաստանէ, եւ անտես արարեր զմեզ... — **Psalms 10:1**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 78 ll. 78.3-4 — «Արեգակն ծագեաց ի յերկիր, եւ տէր տեղաց ի Սողոմ... — **Genesis 19:23-24**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 78 ll. 78.9-11 — «Եկեսցէ ժամանակ, զի ամենայն որ սպանանիցէ զձեզ, համարիցի պաշտօն... — **John 16:2**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 78 ll. 78.11-12 — «Եւ զայն արասցեն ընդ ձեզ վասն անուան իմոյ, զի... — **John 15:21**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 79 ll. 79.12-13 — «Մատնեաց, ասէն, ի գերութիւն զգորութիւնս նոցա, եւ զգիւս նոցա... — **Psalms 78:61**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.

Chapter 13

- p. 80 ll. 80.5-6 — «Յիմարեցան իշխանք Տայանու, որ էին իմաստուն խորհրդականք թագաւորին» — **Isaiah 19:11**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 80 ll. 80.16-17 — «Քանզի ո՛չ թէ իւրով զօրութեամբ զօրանայ հզօրն, այլ տէր... — **1 Kingdoms 2:9-10**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.

Chapter 16

- p. 90 ll. 11-12 — Ոչ երկեայց ի չարէ զի դու տէր ընդ իս... — **Psalms 22:4**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 90 ll. 12-14 — Ոչ երկեայց ես ի բիրաւոր զօրաց նոցա, որ շուրջ... — **Psalms 3:7**, the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 86 l. 5 — հիմենացի երիտասարդին նման գոլով իմ՝ գուժարկու եղէ — **1 Kingdoms (1 Samuel) 4:12**, the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 17

- p. 95 l. 3 — «թագաւոր արդար կանգնէ զաշխարհս, իսկ անօրէնն կործանէ» — **Proverbs 29:4**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 97-98 ll. [~15]-[~1] — «Որդի մարդոյ զի՞նչ է առակդ այդ զօր ասեն ի... — **Ezekiel 18:2-4**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 100 l. 15 — «Թշնամեաց քոց թշնամի եղեց, եւ զատելիս քո սատակեցից» — **Psalms 17:41**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 100 l. 16 — «Ոչ թողից զքեզ եւ ոչ ընդ վայր հարից» — **Hebrews 13:5**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 100 ll. 20-21 — «Մինչչեւ իցէ քո կարդացեալ, եւ լուայց քեզ. եւ մինչդեռ... — **Isaiah 65:24**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 100 ll. 23-24 — «Ոչ եղիցի անձն իմ ընդ նոսա» — **Proverbs 1:28**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 100-101 ll. 25-1 — «Իցէ՞ զի կարդայցէք առ իս, եւ ես ոչ լուայց... — **Isaiah 1:15**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 101 ll. 6-7 — «Եկայք օրհնեալք հօր իմոյ, ժառանգեցէք զանպատում զկեանսն» — **Matthew 25:34**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.

Chapter 18

- p. 104 l. 3 — Երկիր, ասէ, էր ամայի եւ անպատրաստ. վասն զի մարդ... — **Genesis 1 and 2, 1 and 5**. the reference is the edition's own; conflated from more than one place; conflates Gen. 1:2 and 2:5.
- p. 104 l. 8 — Մոռացեալ եղէ եւ որպէս մեռեալ ի սրտէ — **Psalms 30:13**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 104 l. 19 — Տնծասցեն դաշտք, եւ ամենայն որ է ի նոսա — **Psalms 95(96), 17(12)**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 110 ll. 13-15 — Եկայք, ասէ, լուարուք ինձ, եւ կեցցեն ի բարութեան անձինք... — **Isaiah (composite) 1 + 55 + 1, 18 + 3 + 19**. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.

Chapter 19

- p. 111 l. 4 — ոչ տալով քուն աչաց եւ նինջ արտեւանաց — **Psalms 131:4**. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 21

- p. 113 ll. 6-7 — Բազում տանջանք են մեղաւորաց. եւ խրատք քո ուսուցէ զիս — **Psalms 31 and 17, 10 and 36.** the reference is the edition's own; composite, drawn from several places; Two-part composite: Ps 31:10 ('many are the scourges of the sinner') + Ps 17:36 ('and thy discipline shall teach me').
- p. 113 ll. 8-9 — Զի թէ ի խրատու կարգի կայք, ասէ, իբրեւ յորդիս... — **Hebrews 12:7,** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 115 ll. 11-12 — Գիրացաւ, ասէ, ստուարացաւ եւ սոնքացաւ, եթող զտէր Աստուած զարարիչն... — **Deuteronomy 32:15.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 115 ll. 6-7 — Երինջ երեմեան զոլով յաստիս ուժի քաջութեան, ըստ Մովսէսի — **Jeremiah 48:34.** the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 115 l. 22 — որպէս Ղազարոսն ... որպէս մեծատունն — **Luke 16:19-31.** the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.
- p. 113 ll. 19-20 — Այս է զօրութիւն իմ մեծ — **Unidentified.** the edition supplies no reference for this quotation; quoted loosely.

Chapter 22

- p. 119 ll. 15-18 — Եւ սատանայ իսկ կերպարանի ի հրեշտակ լուսոյ. զինչ թէ... — **2 Corinthians 11:13-14.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 120 ll. 8-9 — Զգոյշ լերուք ի սուտ մարգարէիցն որ զան առ ձեզ... — **Matthew 7:15.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 120 ll. 10-13 — Զգոյշ լերուք ի շանց անտի, զգոյշ լերուք ի չար... — **Philippians 3:2.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 120 ll. 15-18 — Առ ի մէնջ ելին, այլ ոչ էին ամենեքեան նոքա... — **1 John 2:19,** the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 121 ll. 22-24 — Դու ես վէմ, եւ ի վերայ այդր վիմի շինեցից... — **Matthew 16:18.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 122 ll. 6-7 — Որ ուտէ զմարմին իմ, զմահ մի տեսցէ յաւիտեան — **John 6:56-58.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 123 ll. 15-16 — Բարի է յուսալ ի Տէր, քան յուսալ յիշխանս — **Psalms 117:8.** the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 124 l. 14 — ոչ հուրն զայրելն մոռանալ կարէ, եւ ոչ հնդիկն զսեւութիւնն,... — **Jeremiah 13:23.** the edition supplies no reference; identified here;

an allusion rather than a quotation.

- p. 120 l. 24 — ըստ Եզեկիէլի տեսողութեանն՝ ականակիտ եւ յստակ — *Ezekiel* — chapter and verse not identified. the edition supplies no reference; identified here; an allusion rather than a quotation.

Chapter 23

- p. 126 l. 2 — Սրեցին որպէս սուսեր զլեզուս իւրեանց, ըստ սաղմոսական երգոյն, եւ... — *Psalms 63:4*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 126 l. 10 — Սրտմտութիւն վիշապաց է զինի նոցա, սրտմտութիւն իժից՝ անհնարին առ... — *Deuteronomy 32:33*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 127 l. 6 — Մի՛, ասէ, ի ցաւ ցանկութեան, որպէս եւ այլ հեթանոսքն,... — *1 Thessalonians 4:5*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 127 l. 10 — Որդեակ, ասէ, պահեա՛ զքեզ ի խառնակութենէ օտար կանանց...քանզի թափք... — *Proverbs 5:3*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted loosely.
- p. 128 l. 13 — Մի լիցի ինձ, ասէ՛ պարծիլ, բայց միայն ի խաչն... — *Galatians 6:14*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.
- p. 131 l. 20 — Օրհնեցէք գտէր, զի սքանչելիս արար — *Psalms 97:1*. the reference is the edition's own; quoted verbatim.

III. Names and places

Persons, peoples and places in the form the English uses, with the author's own Armenian and the identification behind it. Where a long-established English form of a name exists it is used; where none does, the author's form is kept and the identification is recorded here instead of being imposed on his text. Entries stand at the chapter of first occurrence.

Chapter 1

- *Abkhaz* — Ափխազ / Ափխազաց, p. 24 l. 1. The Abkhazo-Georgian kingdom.
- *Aghori* — Աղորի, p. 23 l. 9. A land (աշխարհ).
- *Bagarat* — Բագարատ, p. 24 l. 1. Bagrat III of Abkhazia-Georgia, d. 1014.
- *Basil* — Վասիլ, p. 22 l. 29. Basil II, Byzantine emperor 976-1025.
- *Bulgars* — Բուլղարք / Բուլղարաց, p. 24 l. 13. The Bulgarians of the First Bulgarian Empire.

- **David** — Դավիթ (հոգեբազում), p. 23 l. 6. The psalmist.
- **Dawit'** — Դավիթ (Կիրապաղատ), p. 22 l. 25. David of Tayk', curopalates, d. 1000/1001.
- **Georgi** — Գեորգի, p. 25 l. 8. Giorgi I of Georgia.
- **Gurgen** — Գուրգեն, p. 24 l. 2. Gurgen of Georgia, father of Bagrat III.
- **Hawachich** — Հաաաճիչ, p. 23 l. 9. A stronghold (ամուր).
- **Isaiah** — Եսայիաս, p. 23 l. 21. The prophet.
- **Manazkert** — Մանազկերտ, p. 24 l. 5. Manzikert.
- **Rezin** — Հռասիմ, p. 23 l. 23. Rezin of Damascus, Isaiah 7-8.
- **Romans** — Հռոմ / Հռոմոնց, p. 22 l. 29. The Byzantine Greeks, as Aristakes names them.
- **Siloam** — Սելովմայ, p. 23 l. 22. The pool of Siloam / waters of Shiloah, Isaiah 8:6.
- **Tabeel** — Տաբեել, p. 23 l. 23. The son of Tabeel, Isaiah 7:6.
- **Tayk'** — Տայք / Տայոց, p. 23 l. 3. The Armenian-Georgian march of Tayk'/Tao.
- **the Rus** — Ըռուզք, p. 23 l. 11. The Rus / Varangian corps in Basil II's service.

Chapter 2

- **Ani** — Անի, p. 27 l. 6. Ani, the Bagratuni capital.
- **Armenians** — Հայք / Հայոց, p. 25 l. 21. The Armenians.
- **Ashot** — Աշոտ (հայր Գագկայ), p. 25 l. 22. Ashot III Bagratuni, father of Gagik I.
- **Ashot** — Աշոտ (որդի Գագկայ), p. 26 l. 24. Ashot IV Bagratuni, son of Gagik I.
- **Bagratuni** — Բագրատունի, p. 25 l. 22. The Bagratuni royal line.
- **Basean** — Բասեան, p. 28 l. 24. The district of Basean.
- **Erkat'** — Երկաթ, p. 32 l. 10. The son of Yovhannes-Smbat, who died before his father.
- **Gagik** — Գագիկ, p. 25 l. 21. Gagik I Bagratuni, king of Armenia 989-1017/20.
- **Georgians** — Վիրք / Վրաց, p. 27 l. 7. The Georgians of Kartli-Iberia.
- **Grigor** — Գրիգոր, p. 26 l. 16. Grigor Narekatsi.
- **Hndzuts'** — Հնձուց, p. 26 l. 11. A monastery.
- **Horomos** — Հռոմոս, p. 32 l. 14. The monastery in which the catholicos Sargis is buried.
- **Jeremiah** — Երեմիա, p. 30 l. 13. The prophet.

- **Job** — Յոբ, p. 30 l. 19. The biblical Job.
- **Kamrjats' Zor** — Կամրջացն Զորոյ, p. 26 l. 11. A monastery; almost certainly Կամրջածոր, Kamrjadzor.
- **Karin** — Կարին, p. 28 l. 16. Karin, i.e. Theodosiopolis/Erzurum.
- **Karmir P'orak** — Կարմիր Փորակ, p. 29 l. 7. A place in the district of Vanand.
- **Khaghtik'** — Խաղտիք / Խաղտեաց, p. 29 l. 6. The district of Khaghtik', i.e. Chaldia.
- **Nicomedian** — Նիկոմիտացի, p. 28 l. 9. A man of Nicomedia.
- **Okomi** — Օկոմի, p. 29 l. 4. A great town destroyed by the emperor's order.
- **Paghakats'is** — Պաղակացիս, p. 29 l. 12. A lake near which the battle was fought.
- **Persians** — Պարսք / Պարսից, p. 27 l. 7. The Persians.
- **Petros** — Պետրոս, p. 28 l. 13. Petros I Getadardz, catholicos 1019-1058.
- **Pontus** — Պոնդոս / Պոնդոսի, p. 31 l. 19. The Black Sea littoral province to which the emperor withdraws for the winter.
- **Rat** — Ռատ, p. 29 l. 19. A great prince of the house of Tayk', killed at Paghakats'is.
- **Samuel** — Սամուէլ, p. 26 l. 10. Abbot of the monastery of Kamrjats' Zor.
- **Sargis** — Սարգիս (հայրապետ), p. 26 l. 4. Sargis I of Sevan, catholicos 992-1019.
- **Sargis** — Սարգիս (վարդապետ), p. 26 l. 9. A vardapet of the catholicosate.
- **Sevan** — Սեւան, p. 26 l. 5. Lake Sevan and the island monastery on it.
- **Shatik** — Շատիկ, p. 27 l. 11. A place claimed by a prince of Ashot's party.
- **Smbat** — Սմբատ, p. 26 l. 23. Yovhannes-Smbat III Bagratuni, son of Gagik I.
- **Step'annos Taronets'i** — Ստեփաննոս Տարօնացի, p. 26 l. 12. Step'annos Taronets'i Asoghik, author of the Universal History.
- **the Broad Plain of Karin** — Ընդարձակ դաշտն Կարնոյ, p. 28 l. 15. The plain of Karin.
- **the Illuminator** — Լուսաւորիչ, p. 26 l. 7. Gregory the Illuminator.
- **Theodosiopolis** — Թէոդոսուպօլիս, p. 28 l. 11. Theodosiopolis, i.e. Karin/Erzurum.
- **Tiranun** — Տիրանուն, p. 26 l. 9. A vardapet of the catholicosate.
- **Vagharshakert** — Վաղարշակերտ, p. 28 l. 18. A city with a Georgian bishop.
- **Vanand** — Վանանդ, p. 29 l. 7. The district of Vanand.
- **Yenovk'** — Յենովք, p. 26 l. 9. A vardapet of the catholicosate.

- **Yovhannes Kozern** — Յովհաննէս Կոզերն, p. 26 l. 15. Yovhannes Kozern, vardapet and visionary.
- **Yovsep'** — Յովսէփ, p. 26 l. 11. Head of the monastery of Hndzuts'.

Chapter 3

- **Abkhaz** — Ափխազ (Y.035.19), p. 35 l. 19. The Abkhaz KING. Yuzbashyan's PERSONAL-name index prints Ափխազ [թագաւոր Բագարատ] - 35. 19, 37.
- **Andronike / Andronikos** — Անդրոնիկէ / Անդրոնիկոսն, p. 35 l. 13 / 35.16. Son-in-law of Phers and his fellow in counsel; beheaded with him.
- **Babylon** — Բաբելոն, p. 33 l. 24. Babylon; here the author's classicizing designation, paired with Քաղդէացւոց.
- **Chaldeans** — Քաղդէացիք / Քաղդէացւոց, p. 33 l. 24. The Chaldeans; ի քաղաքն Քաղդէացւոց.
- **Crooked-neck** — Ծռավիզն, p. 33 l. 9. Nickname of the son of Phokas: չոր Ծռավիզն կոչէին.
- **Dawit'** — Դաւիթ (Արծրունի), p. 34 l. 10. The Artsruni king who ceded Vaspurakan to Basil II, called Սենեքերիմ by the author.
- **Iberians** — Վեռիացիք / ՎԵՌԻԱՑԻՈՅ, p. 32 l. 17. The Iberians. Yuzbashyan's own index of place names and peoples identifies them with the Virk'/Vrats' by a reciprocal cross-reference: [Վեռիացիք], Վեռիացիոց - 32. 17, տ.
- **Magdat** — Մագդատ, p. 33 l. 14. A fortress the emperor withdrew to: յամուրս բերդի միոջ որ կոչի Մագդատ. Unidentified.
- **Phers** — Փերս / Փերսի, p. 35 l. 10. A rebel seized and beheaded at the emperor's command. Unidentified.
- **Phokas** — Փոկաս / Փոկասայ, p. 33 l. 9 / 33.25. The Phokas family. Two men in this unit: the son of Phokas proclaimed by the conspirators (Y.033.08-09), and his namesake Phokas who rebelled earlier and ruled the East seven years (Y.033.25).
- **Salk'oray** — Սալքորայ, p. 35 l. 11. The place at the far end of Basen where the emperor entrenched his camp. Unidentified.
- **Sebastia** — Սեբաստիա, p. 34 l. 12. The city given in exchange for Vaspurakan.
- **Vard** — Վարդ, p. 33 l. 20. Bardas Skleros, the earlier rebel against the same emperor.
- **Vaspurakan** — Վասպուրական / Վասպուրականի, p. 34 ll. 11-12. The Artsruni realm, ceded to the emperor: գտուն Վասպուրականի.

Chapter 4

- **Basil** — Վասիլի (Y.038.04), p. 38 l. 4. Basil II, emperor.
- **Georgi** — Գեորգի (Y.036.04, Y.036.10, Y.037.21), p. 36 l. 4. Son of Bagarat, king of the Abkhaz and ruler of the Georgians.
- **Gurgen** — Գուրգենայ (Y.036.04), p. 36 l. 4. Father of Bagarat, therefore grandfather of Georgi.
- **Her** — Հերայ (Y.038.06), p. 38 l. 6. A named locality; Basil encamps in its broad plain, and its prince offers tribute for its orchards. Yuzbashyan indexes it: Հերայ դաշտ - 38. 6, directly under the separate headword Հեր - 137.
- **Shghpha** — Շղփայ (Y.036.02, Y.037.02), p. 36 l. 2. A place; the site of the last battle of the Abkhaz war. Yuzbashyan's place index prints Շղփայ, տեղի - 36. 2, 37.
- **the Artsrunis** — Արծրունեաց (Y.039.09), p. 39 l. 9. The district of the Artsrunis, into which the wrecked army crosses.
- **the Babylonian** — ԳԲաբելացին (Y.038.23), p. 38 l. 23. Babylon, addressed in Isaiah 47:6.
- **the Georgians** — Վիրս (Y.039.14), p. 39 l. 14. The Georgians, delivered into Basil's hand. Index lemma: Վիրք, Վրաց - 27. 7, 33.
- **the Nicaeans** — Նիկիացոց (Y.039.21), p. 39 l. 21. The district of the Nicaeans, where Constantine was when Basil sent for him.
- **the Persians** — Պարսից (Y.038.09), p. 38 l. 9. The land of the Persians, beleaguered and seeking deliverance.
- **Vagharshakert** — Վաղարշակերտոյ (Y.036.10), p. 36 l. 10. A city; the see of bishop Zak'aria.
- **Zak'aria** — Զաքարիա (Y.036.09), Զաքարիայն (Y.036.18), p. 36 l. 9. Bishop of Vagharshakert; Basil's envoy to Georgi, later mutilated and exiled.

Chapter 5

- **Archesh** — Արճեշ (Y.041.14), p. 41 l. 14. The town on Lake Van brought under Byzantine control by Komianos, lord of Vaspurakan.
- **Cappadocian** — կապադովկացի (Y.041.04), p. 41 l. 4. The Cappadocian troops, who band together and seize Komianos.
- **Constantine** — Կոստանդին (Y.040.19) / Կոստանդիանոսի (Y.041.07), p. 40 l. 19. Constantine VIII, Byzantine emperor, brother of Basil II; the chapter is his reign.

- **Komianos** — Կոմիանոս (Y.040.23), p. 40 l. 23. A brave and warlike man set up as lord of the district of Vaspurakan; conspires with Georgi, is seized by the Cappadocian troops and blinded in the second year of Constantine VIII.
- **Nikit** — Նիկիտ (Y.041.17), p. 41 l. 17. A eunuch sent east by Constantine VIII as overseer of the land; drives many azats out of their patrimonies.
- **Simovn** — Սիմովն (Y.041.22), p. 41 l. 22. A eunuch holding the authority of half the kingdom (parekimanos); goes east in the third year and turns back on news of Constantine VIII's death.

Chapter 6

- **Antiochenes** — Անտիոքացի, p. 42 l. 16. The people of Antioch. The king marches i koghmans Antiokacwoc, toward their parts.
- **Halp** — Հալպ, p. 42 l. 17. Aleppo.
- **John** — Յովհաննու, p. 42 l. 20. John the Baptist. The monks bear his likeness - one goatskin, and locusts and wild honey.
- **Romanus** — ՌՈՄԱՆՈՍՆ (Y.042.05, display capitals) / Ռոմանոսի (Y.042.12), p. 42 l. 12. Romanus III Argyrus, emperor 1028-1034. The chapter heading names him and Zoe is given to him in marriage at 42. 12.
- **Seaw** — Սեաւ (լեառն), p. 42 l. 18. The mountain of monasteries the king meets on the march toward Antioch. seaw is the ordinary adjective black, so the name is transparently the Black Mountain.
- **Syrians** — Սսորոց, p. 43 l. 12. The Syrians. Their bishop is deported to Constantinople and dies in the mines.
- **Tajiks** — տաճիկ / տաճկաց, p. 44 l. 1. The force of eight hundred to a thousand that ambushes the king on the road back from Antioch.
- **Zoe** — Զոյի, p. 42 l. 12. Zoe, daughter of Constantine VIII, married to Romanus III in 1028.

Chapter 7

- **Maniak** — Մանեակ, p. 44 l. 20. The man holding authority on the marches of the Roman district, resident at Samosata, to whom Salamay sends his offer.
- **Salamay** — Սալամայ, p. 44 l. 16. The servant whom the amir's widow loved and set up as lord of Urhay; he offers the city to the Romans and is made anthypatos patrikios.
- **Samosata** — Սամուսատ, p. 44 l. 22. The city where Maniak resided.

- **Samson** — Սամսոնի (gen.), p. 44 l. 22. The builder of Samosata according to the report Aristakes cites (զոր ասեն, which they say).
- **Urhay** — ՈՒՌՀԱՅ (Y.044.13, display capitals), p. 44 l. 13. The city whose capture the chapter narrates. Yuzbashyan's place index prints Ուռհայ, քաղաք - 44. 13 and supplies NO modern identification.

Chapter 8

- **the queen** — թագուհուն (Y.046.03), p. 46 l. 3. UNKNOWN. The consenting party to the king's death. The armenian does not name HER.

Chapter 9

- **Ananias** — Անանիաս (Այր մի Անանիաս անուն, Y.049.21), p. 49 l. 21. The man who lamented in Jerusalem before its destruction, whose story Aristakes says the great Eusebius records. The edition's index reads 'Անանիաս - 49. 21', WITHOUT the asterisk it uses for scriptural figures.
- **Apahunik'** — Ապահունեաց (Y.050.01), p. 50 l. 1. A district. The edition's place index reads 'Ապահունեաց գաւառ - 84. 24, 50.
- **Ardzak** — Արձակ / յԱրձակ (Y.048.08, Y.048.18), p. 48 l. 8. A place far from Berkri, chosen for its fodder. The edition's place index reads 'Արձակ, տեղի - 48. 8, 18'.
- **Basil** — Բարսղի (որպէս ի հինսն առ Բարսղի, Y.047.15), p. 47 l. 15. UNKNOWN as to which Basil. The edition's index gives the bare headword 'Բարսղի - 47. 15' with NO qualifier and NO asterisk.
- **Berkri** — Բերկրի (բերդաքաղաքն որ կոչի Բերկրի, Y.048.02), p. 48 l. 2. A fortress-town in the district of the land of the Artsrunis, long held by the Persians. The edition's place index reads 'Բերկրի - 84. 22, բերդաքաղաք - 48.
- **Ekegheats'** — յեկեղեաց (Y.050.02), p. 50 l. 2. A district, the last stage of the wanderer's route.
- **Eusebius** — Եւսեբիոս (մեծն Եւսեբիոս, Y.049.24), p. 49 l. 24. Eusebius of Caesarea, cited for the Ecclesiastical History. The edition's index reads 'Եւսեբիոս - 49. 24'.
- **Hark'** — Հարքայ (ընդ Հարքայ գաւառն, Y.050.01), p. 50 l. 1. A district, on the wanderer's route between Apahunik' and Mananaghi.
- **Kawasilas** — Կաւասիլաս (Կաւասիլաս ոմն, Y.048.04), p. 48 l. 4. A Byzantine commander, governor of Vaspurakan. The edition's index reads 'Կաւասիլաս, գաւառապետ Վասպուրականի - 48. 4' and offers NO further identification.

- **Khtrik** — Խտրիկ / Խտրիկն (Y.048.10, Y.048.21), p. 48 l. 10. The lord of Berkri, shut up in the fortress; he summons the Persian chiefs and later has the prisoners slaughtered over a pit and bathes in their blood. The edition's index reads 'Խտրիկ, տէր քաղաքին - 48. 10, 21'.
- **Mananaghi** — Սանանաղի (Y.050.01), p. 50 l. 1. A district. The edition's place index reads 'Սանանաղի, գաւառ - 50. 1, 125.
- **Michael** — ՄԻԽԱՅԼԻՆ (heading, Y.046.06) / զՄիխայիլս (Y.046.21), p. 46 l. 6. Yuzbashyan's index identifies him as Michael IV: 'Միխայլ [Դ], թագաւոր Հոռոմնոց - 46. 6, 21'. The bracketed regnal number is the editor's and stands in the INDEX, Not on the PAGE.
- **Ort'anoros** — օռթանօռօս (Y.047.07), p. 47 l. 7. UNKNOWN. Michael's third brother, a eunuch and a monk, set over Constantinople as sinklitos. The armenian does not identify him and neither does the EDITION.
- **Tachkastan** — Տաճկաստանի (Y.047.05), p. 47 l. 5. The land of the Tachiks. The edition's place index reads 'Տաճկաստան - 47. 5' and offers NO modern equivalent.
- **the Bulgars** — Բուլղարացն (զհողս Բուլղարացն, Y.047.04), p. 47 l. 4. The Bulgars, whose lands are entrusted to Michael's brother the magistros along with the western parts.
- **Theodora** — Թէոդորայ (Y.050.17, Y.050.24), p. 50 l. 17. The queen's sister. The edition's index designates her 'Թէոդորայ, թագուհի - 50. 17, 24, 95.
- **Thessalonica / the Thessalonians** — Թէսաղոնիկ / Թէսաղոնիկն / Թէսաղոնիկեցոց (Y.047.03, 14, 22), p. 47 l. 3. Thessalonica. The edition's place index reads 'Թէսաղոնիկ - 47. 3, Թէսաղոնիկն - 47.

Chapter 10

- **Absalom** — Աբիսողոմայն (զԱբիսողոմայն, Y.052.24), p. 52 l. 24. Biblical Absalom.
- **Agag** — Ագագ (զերկրորդ Ագագ, Y.058.15), p. 58 l. 15. Biblical Agag.
- **Anania** — Անանիա (զԱնանիա զերեց եղբայրն, Y.064.18), p. 64 l. 18. Khachik's elder brother.
- **Ani** — Անի (զքաղաքն Անի, Y.057.20), p. 57 l. 20. The Bagratid capital.
- **Apusuar** — Ապուսուար (Իսկ Ապուսուար տէր քաղաքին, Y.063.18), p. 63 l. 18. The lord of Dvin.
- **Asit** — Ասիտ (իշխան ոմն Ասիտ անուն, Y.063.14), p. 63 l. 14. The Byzantine lieutenant of Ani.

- **Bagarat** — Բագարատ (ի Բագարատ թագաւորն Ափխազաց, Y.062.21), p. 62 l. 21. King of the Abkhaz.
- **Bjni** — Բջնոյ (զբանալին Բջնոյ, Y.062.15), p. 62 l. 15. Grigor's stronghold.
- **Constantine** — Կոստանդէայ (ԹԱԳԱՒՈՐՈՒԹԻՒՆ ԿՈՍՏԱՆԴԵԱՅ, Y.051.22), p. 51 l. 22. The Byzantine ruler of this chapter, called Monomachos in the heading.
- **Dawit' of Dvin** — Դաւիթ ... Դունացին (ի Դաւիթ ... ի Դունացին, Y.062.20-21), p. 62 l. 20. The Dvin ruler whose sister was Gagik's wife.
- **Dawit' son of Senek'erim** — Դաւթի որդւոյ Սենէքերիմայ (Y.063.11), p. 63 l. 11. Gagik's father-in-law, who died without an heir.
- **Dvin** — Դունայ (քաղաքին Դունայ, Y.063.17), p. 63 l. 17. The city of Dvin.
- **Gagik** — Գագիկ (զԳագիկ որդի Աշոտոյ, Y.058.03), p. 58 l. 3. The last Bagratid king of Ani.
- **Grigor** — Գրիգոր (Գրիգոր որդի քաջին Վասակայ, Y.062.11), p. 62 l. 11. Grigor son of Vasak, who received the magistros dignity.
- **Kamenas** — Կամենաս (Կամենաս ոմն, Y.063.22), p. 63 l. 22. Asit's successor in the lordship of Armenia.
- **Karin** — Կարին (ի Կարին գաւառի, Y.063.26), p. 63 l. 26. The district of Karin.
- **Khachik** — Խաչիկ (զԽաչիկ անուն, Y.064.16), p. 64 l. 16. Petros's sister's son.
- **Khaghtoy Arich** — Խաղտոյ Առիճ (բերդին որ կոչի Խաղտոյ Առիճ, Y.064.15), p. 64 l. 15. The fortress where Petros was confined.
- **Kiwrakos** — Կիւրակոս (զերէց ոմն Կիւրակոս անուն, Y.057.04), p. 57 l. 4. The priest who carried the letter.
- **Maniak** — Մանեակ (որդին Մանեակ, Y.052.13), p. 52 l. 13. UNKNOWN.
- **Melitene** — Մելիտինէ (զՄելիտինէ, Y.062.09), p. 62 l. 9. Melitene.
- **Monomachos** — ՄՈՆՈՄԱԽՍ (ՈՐ ԿՈՉԻ ՄՈՆՈՄԱԽՍ, Y.051.23), p. 51 l. 23. Greek Monomachos, the ruler byname.
- **Pahlaw** — Պահլաւ (հաւասար նմա Պահլաւ, Y.058.01), p. 58 l. 1. The Pahlawuni epithet, in apposition to Vahram.
- **Petros** — Պետրոս (հայրապետն Պետրոս, Y.062.02), p. 62 l. 2. The catholicos who gave up Ani.
- **Samosata** — Սամուսատ (ի քաղաքին Սամուսատ, Y.063.01), p. 63 l. 1. Samosata.

- **Samson** — Սամփսոնի (շինեալ Սամփսոնի, Y.063.02), p. 63 l. 2. Biblical Samson, the reputed builder of Samosata.
- **Sargis** — Սարգիս (Սարգիս անուն, Y.057.21), p. 57 l. 21. A chief azat of Armenia who seized the treasury.
- **Seaw K'ar** — Սեաւ Քար (բերդին որ կոչի Սեաւ Քար, Y.064.16), p. 64 l. 16. The fortress where Khachik was confined.
- **Senek'erim** — Սենեքերիմայ (Y.063.11), p. 63 l. 11. Dawit's father.
- **Shirak** — Շիրակայ (տանն Շիրակայ, Y.057.22), p. 57 l. 22. The district of Shirak.
- **Surmari** — Սուրմառի (բերդաքաղաքն որ կոչի Սուրմառի, Y.058.08-09), p. 58 l. 8. A fortress-town.
- **Tachik** — տաճիկ (այր մի տաճիկ, Y.064.05), p. 64 l. 5. A Tachik man seeking baptism.
- **the Abkhaz** — Ափխազաց (թագաւորն Ափխազաց, Y.062.22), p. 62 l. 22. The Abkhaz.
- **Theodos** — Թէոդոսի (ՈՐԴԻՈՅ Թէոդոսի, Y.051.22), p. 51 l. 22. The father named in the chapter heading.
- **Vahram** — Վահրամ (Իսկ Վահրամ այր հզօր, Y.057.25), p. 57 l. 25. The great prince of Armenia, killed at Dvin with his son.
- **Vasak** — Վասակայ (որդի քաջին Վասակայ, Y.062.11), p. 62 l. 11. Grigor's father.
- **Yovhannes** — Յովհաննէս (եղբարքն Աշոտ և Յովհաննէս, Y.055.09), p. 55 l. 9. The Bagratid king who died with his brother Ashot.
- **Zion** — Սիովնի (Ճանապարհք Սիովնի, Y.060.23), p. 60 l. 23. Zion, in the Lamentations quotation.

Chapter 11

- **Amos** — ամովսական (Y.067.06-07), p. 67 l. 6. The prophet Amos; the passage paraphrases Amos 6:4-6.
- **Arsharunik'** — Արշարունեաց (Y.067.21), p. 67 l. 21. A district whose strongholds bound the flood to the north.
- **Basean** — Բասեան (Y.065.05); Բասենոյ (Y.064.22, Y.067.18), p. 64 l. 22. The district and plain overrun in 497.
- **Elijah** — Եղիա (Y.073.18), p. 73 l. 18. Elijah fleeing to Horeb.

- **Galileans** — Գալիլեացիքն (Y.067.03-04), p. 67 l. 3. The Galileans of Luke 13.
- **Gilboa** — Գեղբուայ (Y.073.21), p. 73 l. 21. Mount Gilboa.
- **Hashtenk'** — Հաշտենից (Y.067.22), p. 67 l. 22. A district at the southern limit.
- **Hermon** — Հերմոնի (Y.073.14), p. 73 l. 14. Mount Hermon.
- **Horeb** — Քորեբ (Y.073.19), p. 73 l. 19. Mount Horeb.
- **Israel** — Էսրայել / Իսրայել (Y.066.07, Y.066.11, Y.067.07); Իսրայելի (Y.073.22), p. 66 l. 7. Biblical Israel.
- **Jezebel** — Յեզաբելայ (Y.073.18), p. 73 l. 18. Jezebel, whom Elijah flees.
- **Joseph** — Յովսեփու (Y.067.09, Y.067.13), p. 67 l. 9. The biblical Joseph, in the Amos allusion.
- **Khordzean** — Խորձենյ (Y.067.22), p. 67 l. 22. The forests at the far southern limit.
- **Moses** — Մովսեսի (Y.073.16), p. 73 l. 16. Moses at Sinai.
- **Ninevites** — Նինուեացիքն (Y.069.04), p. 69 l. 4. The Ninevites of Jonah 3.
- **Persians** — Պարսիկք (Y.068.18), p. 68 l. 18. The Persians of the first invasion.
- **Pharaoh** — Փարաոնին (Y.066.03), p. 66 l. 3. Pharaoh of the Exodus.
- **Pilate** — Պիղատոս (Y.067.04), p. 67 l. 4. Pontius Pilate.
- **Sisak** — Սիսակայ (տանն Սիսակայ, Y.068.04), p. 68 l. 4. The eponym whose house is the last given the cup to drink.
- **Smbat** — Սմբատայ (Y.064.23); Լերինք Սմբատայ (Y.073.23), p. 64 l. 23. The mountain of the massacre, in the district of Mananaghi.
- **Smbatay Berd** — Սմբատայ Բերդ (Y.071.06), p. 71 l. 6. The name of the same mountain in the narrative. Index headword: Սմբատաց բերդ, լեռն - 71. 6.
- **Sper** — Սպեր (Y.067.20), p. 67 l. 20. The northern limit of the 497 flood.
- **T'urk'astan** — Թուրքաստանէ (ի Թուրքաստանէ, Y.064.25), p. 64 l. 25. The land the invading troops are set in motion out of.
- **Taron** — Տարոն (Y.067.21), p. 67 l. 21. The southern limit of the flood.
- **Vagharshawan** — Վաղարշաւան (Y.065.06), p. 65 l. 6. The great դաստակերտ (estate) marking the limit of the first incursion.

Chapter 12

- **Arcn** — Արծն / Արծինն (Y.074.10, Y.079.15), p. 74 l. 10. The city of the chapter's heading and closing paragraph, sacked in the Persian invasion.

- **Christ** — Քրիստոս (Y.075.07), p. 75 l. 7. Christ, opposed to Mammon in the author's moral argument.
- **Jerusalem** — Երուսաղեմ (Y.077.09), p. 77 l. 9. Jerusalem, sacked by the Persians under Nebuchadnezzar, the author's parallel for Arcn's fall.
- **Naboth** — Նաբովթայ (Y.075.23), p. 75 l. 23. The owner of the vineyard Jezebel seized (1 Kings 21).
- **Sodomites** — սողոմայեցիոց (Y.078.02), p. 78 l. 2. The people of Sodom, whose destruction (Genesis 19) the author sets beside the sack of Arcn.

Chapter 13

- **Egyptians** — Եգիպտացւոցն (Y.080.04), p. 80 l. 4. The people of Isaiah's prophecy that opens the chapter.
- **Hezekiah** — Եզեկիային (Y.081.05), p. 81 l. 5. Biblical King Hezekiah, whose prayer occasioned the angel's destruction of Sennacherib's army (2 Kings 19 / Isaiah 37).
- **Jews** — Հրեայքն (Y.081.01), p. 81 l. 1. The unnamed episode of a people loading their treasure on camels and carrying it to a nation with no hope of help.
- **Liparit** — Լիպարիտ (Y.080.22, Y.081.08), p. 80 l. 22. The Georgian-Armenian prince captured in this chapter's battle; his first appearance in the work.
- **Saul** — Սաուդայն (Y.080.23), p. 80 l. 23. Biblical King Saul, consulting the witch of Endor (1 Samuel 28).
- **Zoan** — Տայանու (Y.080.05), p. 80 l. 5. The Egyptian city of the Isaiah 19:11 citation (LXX/Vulgate "Tanis," Hebrew "Zoan").

Chapter 14

- **Atom** — Ատոմ որդի Սենեքերիմայ (Y.082.14), p. 82 l. 14. Son of Senek'erim of Vaspurakan; takes Petros into his custody as a pledge and brings him to Sebastopolis.
- **Sebastopolis** — Սեբաստուպոլիս (Y.082.15), p. 82 l. 15. The Byzantine city (in the Armeniac theme) to which Atom brings Petros, and where Petros dies.
- **Second Armenia** — Երկրորդ Հայք (Y.082.24), p. 82 l. 24. The Byzantine provincial designation Armenia Secunda, to whose borders Khachik comes after his release.
- **Tarntay** — Տարնտայ (Y.082.25, 83.13), p. 82 l. 25. A district in Second Armenia where Khachik settles and where two monasteries are later granted to the church.

Chapter 15

- **Kars** — Կարս (Y.083.16, chapter heading), p. 83 l. 16. The rich city sacked at night during the feast of the Lord's manifestation; the chapter's own subject, named only in its heading.

Chapter 16

- **Abas** — Աբաս (Y.088.13), p. 88 l. 13. Gagik's father, named only via the patronymic.
- **Apahunik'** — Ապահունիք / Ապահունեաց (Y.084.25), p. 84 l. 25. District around Manazkert, where the Sultan's camp occupies the plains.
- **Arsuban** — Արսուբան (Y.088.19), p. 88 l. 19. The Persian amir whose son Tatul mortally wounds.
- **Artske** — Արծկէ (Y.094.16), p. 94 l. 16. City on the sea of Bznunik' (Lake Van), besieged and taken at the chapter's close.
- **Awnik** — Աւնիկ (Y.089.23), p. 89 l. 22. Impregnable fortress in the plain of Basean, bypassed by the Sultan.
- **Baberd** — Բաբերդ (Y.088.02), p. 88 l. 2. Fortress-city, scene of the encounter with the Varangian company.
- **Chaneti** — Ճանեթ, Ճանեթոյ (Y.085.03), p. 85 l. 3. Forest region marking the western limit of the raiding parties.
- **Derjan** — Դերջան (Y.087.20), p. 87 l. 20. District suffering slaughter, paired with Ekegheats'.
- **Gagik son of Abas** — Գագիկ որդի Աբասայ (Y.088.13), p. 88 l. 13. Prince whose forces meet the retreating raiders at the borders of Vanand.
- **Handzit'** — Հանձէթ (Y.086.15), p. 86 l. 15. District paired with Khordzean in the chapter's lament.
- **Parkhar** — Պարխար (Y.085.01), p. 85 l. 1. Mountain marking the northern limit of the raiding parties.
- **Sim** — Սիմ (Y.085.04), p. 85 l. 4. Mountain marking the southern limit of the raiding parties.
- **Tatul** — Թաթուլ (Y.088.15), p. 88 l. 15. A captured azat, mighty and war-loving, who wounds the Persian amir's son.
- **the Caucasus** — Կովկաս, Կովկասու (Y.085.02), p. 85 l. 2. Mountain range marking the far northern extent of the raiding.
- **the Chorokh** — Ծորոխ (Y.088.[apx.1]), p. 88 l. 1. The great river reached by the raiders who entered Tayk'.

- **the sea of Bznunik'** — Բզնունիք, ծովուն Բզնունեաց (Y.094.16), p. 94 l. 16. The author's own name for Lake Van.
- **the village of Du** — Դու, գիւղն (Y.090.[apx.1]), p. 90 l. 1. Village near the head of Basean.
- **Tuaratsoy Tap'** — Տուարածոյ Տափ (Y.089.22), p. 89 l. 21. A plain the Sultan marches to after abandoning the siege for three days.
- **Vasil** — Վասիլն (իշխանն Մանազկերտոյ, Y.094.14), p. 94 l. 14. The Armenian prince of Manazkert, not the emperor.

Chapter 17

- **Aratsani** — Արածանի (Y.097.[~02]), p. 97 l. [~2]. Village on the raiders' route from Mankan Gom, where the ice broke under captives and captors alike.
- **Ashot** — Աշոտոյ (թագաւորին Հայոց Աշոտոյ, Y.096.[~04]), p. 96 l. [~4]. King of the Armenians, Apusuar's father-in-law.
- **Awan** — Աւանն (գոր Աւանն կոչէին, Y.096.[~11]), p. 96 l. [~11]. Byname for Theodoros son of Aharon, "in their own tongue" (a language other than Armenian, unspecified).
- **Babylonians** — Բաբելացոց (յաշխարհն Բաբելացոց, Y.095.[~24]), p. 95 l. [~24]. Ethnonym for the Sultan's own realm, the author's classicizing designation for the bearer of Theodora's treasure being taken.
- **Hark'** — Հարքայ (Y.096.[~26]), p. 96 l. [~26]. District containing Mankan Gom, sacked at Theophany.
- **Khlat'** — Խլարայ (Y.096.[~14]), p. 96 l. [~14]. District entered by the Turkestan troop before bringing plunder to Taron.
- **Mankan Gom** — Մանկան Գոմ (Y.096.[~26]), p. 96 l. [~26]. The market-town in Hark' destroyed by night-raiders at the feast of the Theophany.
- **Taron** — Տարօնոյ (Y.096.[~10]), p. 96 l. [~10]. District where Theodoros son of Aharon is prince.
- **Theodoros son of Aharon** — Թէոդորոս որդի Ահարոնի (Y.096.[~10]), p. 96 l. [~10]. Prince of Taron, styled "Awan" in his own people's tongue; mortally wounded fighting Turkestan raiders.

Chapter 18

- **Aghori** — Աղօրի (Y.106.07), p. 106 l. 7. District Ivane returns to.

- **Ani** — Անի (Y.106.15), p. 106 l. 15. Seat of the unnamed magistros who sends troops against Ivane.
- **Arcn** — Արծինն (Y.108.24), p. 108 l. 24. Refugees from Arcn are among those massacred at Blurk.
- **Blurk'** — Բլուրս (Y.108.17), p. 108 l. 17. Village near Karin whose sand-founded wall collapses at first assault, per the dominical parable.
- **Eghants Berd** — Եղանց Բերդ (Y.106.06), p. 106 l. 6. Fortress Ivane takes by deception.
- **Eriza** — Երիզայ (Y.106.04), p. 106 l. 4. The great settlement in Hashteank' granted to Ivane.
- **Hashteank'** — Հաշտենից (Y.106.04), p. 106 l. 4. District containing Eriza.
- **Ivane, son of Liparit** — Իւանէ որդի Լիպարտին (Y.106.03), p. 106 l. 3. Georgian-connected lord who seizes Karin under cover of the 1057 succession dispute.
- **Kamenas** — Կամենասն (Y.103.22), p. 103 l. 22. Co-commander of the 1057 revolt with Komianos.
- **Karin** — Կարնոյ (Y.106.10, recurring), p. 106 l. 10. City besieged by Ivane, later by the raiders.
- **Komianos** — Կոմիանոսն (Y.103.21) / Կոմիանոս, Կոմիանոսին (Y.112.04,05,17,18,19), p. 103 l. 21. Named jointly with Kamenas as leader of the 1057 revolt who himself becomes king; historically Isaac I Komnenos.
- **Mananaghi** — Մանանաղու (Y.107.15), p. 107 l. 15. District where the raiders split in two.
- **Michael** — Միխայիլ (Y.103.06), p. 103 l. 6. Michael VI Bringas, raised to the throne by Theodora on her deathbed.
- **the Euphrates** — Եւփրատայ (Y.108.23), p. 108 l. 23. River; villages and monasteries on its near side gather at Blurk for refuge.
- **the forest of Khrt'i in Chanet'** — Խրթի անտառն Ճանէթոյ (Y.107.11), p. 107 l. 11. Geographic extent of the slaughter in Khaghteank'.
- **Theodora** — Թէոդորին (heading, dat./gen.; not named in the running prose), p. 101 l. 9. Byzantine empress, sole ruler 1055-1057 between Constantine IX Monomachos and Michael VI; identified from content (matak ariwc, thaguhwoyn), not from the heading's case-ending.

Chapter 19

- **Mesopotamia** — Միջագետաց (Y.110.23), p. 110 l. 23. The region; heading names it as the chapter subject.

Chapter 21

- **Eghnut** — Եղնուտին (սահմանսն Եղնուտին, Y.118.[~10]), p. 118 l. [~10]. Borders near which a further skirmish and rescue of captives takes place.
- **Kamakh** — Կամախ (գաւառն որ կոչի Կամախ, Y.116.[~9]), p. 116 l. [~9]. District where the invading force divides in two.
- **Koloneia** — Կողոնիա (Y.116.[~10]), p. 116 l. [~10]. Destination of half the raiding force after Kamakh.
- **Lazarus** — Ղազարոսն (որպէս Ղազարոսն, Y.115.[~24]), p. 115 l. [~24]. The poor man of the parable (Luke 16:19-31), named alongside "the rich man" (մեծասունն) as an example of punishment suffered only in this life.
- **Mormreans** — Մորմրեանս (գիւղն որ կոչի Մորմրեանս, Y.117.[~21]), p. 117 l. [~21]. The fortified village at the head of the district where the retreating Persian force is checked.
- **Sanasunk'** — Սանասունք (Y.118.[~15]), p. 118 l. [~15]. By the custom of men, the popular name for the people of Mount Simn, after their forefather.
- **Simn** — Սիմն (լեռնէն Սիմն կոչեցեալ, Y.118.[~14]), p. 118 l. [~14]. The mountain from which troops descend against the retreating raiders.

Chapter 22

- **Esayi** — Եսայի (Y.123.23), p. 123 l. 23. The monk from Karin who exposes Yakobos's practices to Catholicos Sargis.
- **Greeks** — Յունաց (աշխարհն Յունաց, Y.124.15), p. 124 l. 15. The Greeks/Byzantines encountered at Constantinople.
- **James** — Յակովբ (սուրբն Յակովբ, Y.120.20), p. 120 l. 20. The biblical apostle James, author of the epistle alluded to (the "sweet and bitter water" of one spring, Jas 3:11-12).
- **Muharkin** — Մուհարկին (Y.125.04), p. 125 l. 4. The city where the heresiarch dies, wretchedly and without Christian rites.
- **Tondrak** — Թոնդրակ (Թոնդրակս, Y.124.24), p. 124 l. 24. The sect's own namesake locality, in the district of Apahunik' — "the assembly of the god-forsaken and the fold of beasts".

- **Yakobos** — Յակոբոս (Y.119.04), p. 119 l. 4. The chapter's own heresiarch, bishop of Hark', exposed and defrocked as a secret Tondrakian sympathizer.

Chapter 23

- **Aghuank'** — Աղուանից (Y.125.15), p. 125 l. 15. Caucasian Albania; claimed origin of the corrupting teacher-monk.
- **Aghyusoy** — Աղիսոյ (Y.128.04), p. 128 l. 4. The other farmstead.
- **Akhni** — Ախնի (Y.125.22), p. 125 l. 22. One of two sister-disciples of Kuntsik.
- **Andreas** — Անդրէաս (Y.126.17), p. 126 l. 17. Abbot of the monastery Vrvr built and later abandoned.
- **Bazmaghybur** — Բազմաղբիւր (Y.128.18), p. 128 l. 18. Village where the cross-desecration miracle occurs; renamed Խաչ ("Cross") per the author's own statement.
- **Eghia** — Եղիա (որում անուն էր Եղիա, Y.130.02), p. 130 l. 2. The royal judge of the laws of the land sent into the district in the summer of the Vrvr affair.
- **Episarat** — Եպիսառատ (Y.132.11), p. 132 l. 11. Bishop who adopts Vrvr as his ward via bribery.
- **Gaylakhazut** — Գալլախազուտ (Y.128.17), p. 128 l. 17. The district's modern name, given by the author himself ("որ այժմ կոչի").
- **Hranush** — Հրանոյշ (Y.125.18), p. 125 l. 18. First woman Kuntsik seduces, "of a leading and choice family".
- **Jerma** — Զերմայ (Y.129.17), p. 129 l. 17. Town where the six seized "teachers" of the sect are branded.
- **Kamara** — Կամարայ (Y.125.22), p. 125 l. 22. The other sister-disciple.
- **Kashe** — Կաշէ (Y.128.04), p. 128 l. 4. One of two farmsteads held by Vrvr's kinswomen.
- **Koter** — Կոթէր (Y.130.24), p. 130 l. 24. Town across the Euphrates the soldiers try to ferry Samuel to.
- **Kuntsik** — Կունծիկ (Y.125.12), p. 125 l. 12. The heresiarch monk at the chapter's opening, "dog-named" (infamous).
- **P'rris** — Փռռիս / Փրրիս (Y.132.02), p. 132 l. 2. Episcopal residence the judge visits.
- **Pakhra** — Պախրայ (Y.128.17), p. 128 l. 17. Mountain whose district frames the chapter's second episode.

- **Samuel** — Սամուիլ / Սամուէլ (Y.129.09 Սամուիլի; Y.130.06 Սամուէլ), p. 129 l. 9. Bishop/patriarch investigating the heresy, leader of the river-crossing miracle.
- **Shirni** — Շիրնի (Y.125.12), p. 125 l. 12. Fortress-town near which Kuntsik dwelt.
- **Theodoros** — Թէոդորոս (Y.130.06), p. 130 l. 6. Samuel's nephew, ferried across the Euphrates with him.
- **Vrver** — Վրվէր (Y.126.14), p. 126 l. 14. Prince, brother and procurer of Kuntsik's disciples, the chapter's central figure through paragraphs 2-7.

Chapter 24

- **Canaanites** — Քանանացիք (Քանանացիսն, Y.133.22), p. 133 l. 22. The Canaanites, among whom Jericho's inhabitants declined to count themselves.
- **Damascus** — Դամասկոս (Y.134.03), p. 134 l. 3. Damascus, against which David fortified the tower of Lebanon.
- **Eder** — Եդերայ (Y.134.03), p. 134 l. 3. The adversary who rose up against Solomon. THREE LAYERS, Kept distinct (closing audit 2026-08-22): (1) what Aristakes says -- the tower of Lebanon built by David against Damascus was no hindrance to Eder, who rose up as satan to Solomon; (2) what the edition says -- its personal-name index, p. 152, gives "* Եդեր -- 134.
- **Jericho** — Երիքով (Երիքովի, Y.133.20-21), p. 133 l. 20. Jericho, the biblical city whose inhabitants trusted in the strength of their towers.
- **Lebanon** — Լիբանան (Լիբանանու, Y.134.02), p. 134 l. 2. Lebanon, site of the tower built by David and fortified against Damascus.
- **Nerk'i berd** — Ներքի բերդ (Y.135.22), p. 135 l. 22. The inner stronghold of Ani, to which part of the population fled during the sack; rendered as a place name, not descriptively.

Chapter 25

- **Alp Arslan** — Ալբասլան (Y.140.29), p. 140 l. 29. The Persian (Seljuk) king who defeats and later releases Diogenes.
- **Antioch** — Անտիոք (Y.137.22), p. 137 l. 22. The city in Syria, named as the southern limit of the Byzantine realm's extent.
- **Bithynians** — Բիւթանացոց (Y.137.20), p. 137 l. 20. The people of Bithynia, in whose land Diogenes encamps and gathers his army.

- **Constantine [the Great]** — Կոստանդիանոս (Y.137.13), p. 137 l. 13. Constantine the Great, founder of Constantinople; Diogenes is reckoned "sixtieth" from him.
- **Diogenes** — Դիոգեն (Y.137.12), p. 137 l. 12. The reigning Byzantine king throughout this chapter; historically Romanos IV Diogenes, defeated and captured at Manzikert.
- **India** — Հնդկաց (Y.140.24), p. 140 l. 24. India, named as the geographic marker for the great river north of which the invading nations pass.
- **Joshua** — Յեսուայ (Y.139.20), p. 139 l. 20. Biblical Joshua, to whom the commander of the LORD's host appeared (Joshua 5:14) -- an unmarked allusion, not a printed quotation.
- **Mountains of the Moon** — Լուսնալերանց (Y.140.23), p. 140 l. 23. A legendary/classical geographic term for a distant range, source of the invading nations; no specific modern real-world range is asserted.
- **Ocean** — Ովկիանոսի (Y.140.26), p. 140 l. 26. The classical/medieval world-encircling outer sea ("ծովուն Ովկիանոսի", the sea of Ocean).
- **Phoenicians** — Փինիկեցոց (Y.137.21), p. 137 l. 21. The people of Phoenicia, named for the valleys marking the realm's southern extent, near Antioch.
- **Rshunik'** — Ռշտունեաց (Y.137.23), p. 137 l. 23. An Armenian district near Lake Van, named with Her as the chapter's furthest-east geographic marker.
- **Theodosiopolis** — Թեոդոսպոլիս (Y.138.07), p. 138 l. 7. The great city where Diogenes arrays his cavalry en route east; historically = Karin/modern Erzurum.
- **Van** — Վան (Y.137.23), p. 137 l. 23. The fortress of Van, named as the eastern limit of the realm's extent ("ամուրն Վան").

The authorial colophon

- **Samaria** — Սամարիա (Y.144.03), p. 144 l. 3. Biblical Samaria, paired with Israel/Elijah in the same clause ("իբրեւ զԻսրայել յաւուրսն Եղիայի, եւ զՍամարիա յաւուրսն Եղիսէի" -- "as Israel in the days of Elijah, and Samaria in the days of Elisha").

IV. Dates

Aristakes dates by the Armenian era, by regnal year and by indiction. **His dating is kept exactly as he gives it and is never converted in the running text**, and his chronological errors stand there uncorrected. The modern equivalents below are offered here and nowhere else, each with the basis on which it rests. Where he is demonstrably wrong, that is said.

Chapter 1

- p. 24 l. 10 — *in the year four hundred and fifty of this era of ours*. AD 1001/1002. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553.
- p. 25 l. 7 — *In the four hundred and sixty-fourth year of our era*. AD 1015/1016. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553. **The author is in error here:** Bagrat III of Abkhazia-Georgia died in 1014 by other reckonings; the author's 464 is his own and stands.
- p. 22 l. 29 — *in the twenty-fifth year of his reign*. AD 1000/1001, reckoning Basil II from 976.
- p. 24 l. 11 — *fourteen years*. No modern equivalent is offered. **The author is in error here:** Fourteen years from AD 1001 gives 1015, which agrees with Y.025.7's 464; but the interval is measured from a campaign, not from Bagarat's death, so the two datings are not straightforwardly reconcilable. The discrepancy is HIS and is not corrected.
- p. 23 ll. 13-14 — *on the day of Great Thursday. Maundy Thursday*. the liturgical designation is the author's own.

Chapter 2

- p. 28 l. 8 — *in the year four hundred and sixty-seven of this era of ours*. AD 1018/1019. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553.
- p. 28 l. 12 — *in the year four hundred and sixty-eight*. AD 1019/1020. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553.
- p. 28 ll. 13-14 — *in the year four hundred and seventy*. AD 1021/1022. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553.
- p. 31 ll. 20-21 — *on the days of the great feast of the Theophany. early January, in the winter following the campaign dated 470 of the Armenian era at Y.028.13-14*. the Armenian church keeps the Theophany on 6 January; the winter is the one the emperor spends in Pontus after the twelve districts are destroyed.
- p. 31 l. 22 — *on the day of Illumination. the same feast day, on which the water is blessed*. the author distinguishes the feast (Աստուածայայտնութիւն) from the day of the blessing of the water (լուսաւորութեան ատուր) and the English keeps them apart.

Chapter 3

- p. 33 ll. 25 - 34.1 — *ruled all the East for seven years*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 34 ll. 13-14 — *two or three years before*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 35 l. 12 — *a month of days, or longer still*. No modern equivalent is offered.

Chapter 4

- p. 38 l. 5 — *after three years*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 39 l. 18 — *after staying three years*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 40 l. 12 — *after two days*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 40 ll. 12-13 — *he had reigned fifty years. 976-1025 CE*. Basil II's sole and joint reign as counted from 976; the figure is the author's own and is not converted in the text.

Chapter 5

- p. 40 ll. 19-20 — *four years. 1025-1028 CE*. Constantine VIII's sole reign. **The author is in error here:** The apparatus records A Numerical variant and the editor flags it HIMSELF: 20 BC Գ. (3!), i.e. manuscripts B and C read the numeral three where the print reads չորս (four), and Yuzbashyan prints his own exclamation mark. Constantine VIII's reign is usually reckoned at about three years.
- p. 41 l. 8 — *in which the years of this era of ours were four hundred and seventy-five. AD 1026/1027*. Armenian era year 1 = AD 552/553.
- p. 41 l. 11 — *when the second year came*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 41 l. 22 — *at the coming in of the third year*. No modern equivalent is offered.

Chapter 6

- p. 42 l. 42.15 — *in the first year of his own reign. 1029 or 1030*. Romanus III reigned 1028-1034 and the Syrian campaign that ended in his defeat is dated 1030. The equivalent lives HERE and in the back-of-book note only, never in the text.

Chapter 8

- p. 45 l. 23 — *on the great Thursday. the Great Thursday of Holy Week*. hingshabat' is literally The fifth DAY, the ordinary Armenian for Thursday; yawur meci is On the great DAY. Together they are the Great Thursday of Holy Week.
- p. 46 l. 4 — *seven years. UNKNOWN*. Duration of the reign, stated retrospectively after the king's death.

Chapter 9

- p. 49 l. 49.9-11 — *in the month of Arats, on the day of Friday, at the turning of the day; and it was the four hundred and eighty-second year of our era. AD 1033*. Armenian era

year 482.

- p. 50 ll. 50.10-11 — *having lived seven years and eight months in the kingship*. UNKNOWN. Duration of the reign, stated at the point of the king's death.
- p. 51 l. 51.20 — *who reigned six months*. UNKNOWN. Duration of the caesar's reign, the chapter's closing clause.
- p. 49 l. 49.1 — *at the coming of the second year*. UNKNOWN. The second year of the Berkri campaign, reckoned from the events of paragraph 3. No absolute date is supplied and none is inferable from the Armenian.

Chapter 10

- p. 55 ll. 55.5-6 — *the years of this era of ours were four hundred and ninety*. AD 1041/42. Armenian era + 551.
- p. 55 l. 55.7 — *after three years*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 61 l. 61.17 — *in the four hundred and ninety-fourth year of the era*. AD 1045/46. Armenian era + 551. **The author is in error here.**
- p. 63 l. 63.22 — *in the four hundred and ninety-third year of this era of ours*. AD 1044/45. Armenian era + 551. **The author is in error here.**
- p. 61 l. 61.11 — *with his fifteen years of sweating labour*. No modern equivalent is offered. Of the Illuminator's labour, not of this chapter's events.
- p. 64 l. 64.1 — *the feast of the holy Theophany*. **6 January**. The Armenian Theophany.
- p. 64 l. 64.17 — *until near Easter*. No modern equivalent is offered.

Chapter 11

- p. 67 ll. 67.15-16 — *in the four hundred and ninety-seventh year of this era of ours*. AD 1048/49. Armenian era year 497, on the standard epoch of AD 552.
- p. 67 l. 67.16 — *which was the second year of our captivity*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 67 ll. 67.22-23 — *fourteen days*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 68 l. 68.22 — *And when the next year came*. No modern equivalent is offered.
- p. 69 ll. 69.1-2 — *in the month of September, on the feast of the Holy Cross, on a Wednesday*. No modern equivalent is offered.

Chapter 16

- p. 84 l. 17 — *the five hundred and third year of our era*. UNKNOWN.

Chapter 17

- p. 96 l. [~2] — *the five hundred and fourth year of our era*. UNKNOWN.

Chapter 18

- p. 103 l. 23 — *in the five hundred and sixth year of our era, ...the Greek indiction was the tenth*. 1057 CE. Armenian Era 506; matches the historical dating of Isaac Komnenos's 1057 revolt.

Chapter 21

- p. 118 l. 23 — *And it was the five hundred and seventh year of our era when this thus came to pass*. 1058 CE.

Chapter 24

- p. 135 l. 3 — *the five hundred and thirteenth year of our era*. 1064 CE.

The authorial colophon

- p. 142 ll. 15-16 — *the year of the Armenians four hundred and eighty-two*. 1033 CE.

V. Terms kept untranslated

Titles, offices, coins, measures and engines for which no English word carries the sense without distorting it. Each keeps the author's own vocabulary in the text and is explained here. Several he marks as foreign himself, telling his reader what *they* called a thing; where he does, the English keeps his distance from the word.

- **amir** — ամիրայ, p. 44 l. 14. An Arab title.
- **anthypatos** — անթիպատոս, p. 45 l. 2. A Byzantine title.
- **Astvatsatur** — Աստուածատուր, p. 101 l. 9. A term. The chapter heading's own etymological gloss of Theodora's name, literally 'God-given.' Kept as the name-form the heading supplies; its literal sense recorded here, not imported into the running English.
- **azat** — ազատ, p. 23 l. 3. An Armenian title.
- **baban** — բաբան, p. 92 l. 11. A military term. A siege engine. The author himself flags it as their own word for it ('զոր ինքեանք բաբան կոչէին' = 'which they themselves called

a baban'), so it is kept untranslated rather than assigned an invented English equivalent.

- **caliph** — խալիփ (ցխալիփայն, Y.082.04), p. 82 l. 4. An Arab title. First occurrence in the project.
- **curopalates** — կիրապաղատ, p. 22 l. 25. A Byzantine title. Greek court title in Armenian dress; kept as a title, not turned into a description.
- **dahekan** — դահեկան, p. 37 l. 18. A term. Coin. Kept untranslated, like vardapet and curopalates; appears in the back-of-book glossary at publication.
- **dahekan** — դահեկան (Y.095.[~17]), p. 95 l. [~17]. A term.
- **demeslikos** — դեմեպիկոս / դեմեպիկոսն (Y.047.04, Y.051.04), p. 47 l. 4. A Byzantine title. TRANSLITERATED, NOT IDENTIFIED. The print reads demeslikos at Y.047.04 and demeslikosn at Y.051.04, with sl and not st; the apparatus knows only G dimeslikos and GHT dimeslikosn.
- **hambars** — համբարեաց (բնակութիւնք համբարեաց, Y.055.15), p. 55 l. 15. A biblical term. A class of demon or monster in the Armenian vocabulary of desolation. Kept untranslated; back-of-book glossary at publication.
- **Karapet (Forerunner)** — Կարապետ (կարապետին Քրիստոսի, Y.118.19), p. 118 l. 19. A biblical ecclesiastical term. Epithet for St. John the Baptist.
- **litr** — լիտր, p. 92 l. 13. A Byzantine term. Byzantine weight unit (Greek litra). Kept as the measure the author gives, not converted to a modern equivalent in the text.
- **magistros** — մագիստրոս, p. 24 l. 4. A Byzantine title. As curopalates.
- **mandator** — մանդատոր, p. 93 l. 5. A Byzantine title. Byzantine courier/messenger title. The author glosses it himself in the same clause ('այսինքն թղթաբեր' = 'that is, a letter-bearer'); both the untranslated term and his own gloss are carried into the English.
- **parekimanos** — պառեկիմանոս, p. 41 l. 24. A Byzantine title.
- **patrikios** — պատրիկ, p. 45 l. 2. A Byzantine title. Six letters confirmed from the image, not patrikios spelled out; M2 reads patruik, a spelling variant of the same Greek title. Two competing established english forms - patrikios and patrician.
- **sinklitos** — սինկլիտոս (առնելով զնա սինկլիտոս, Y.047.08), p. 47 l. 8. A Byzantine title. TRANSLITERATED, NOT IDENTIFIED. Very probably Greek sygkletos, the senate, here conferred as a dignity on a person; the identification is recorded Here only and does not enter the English.
- **the noble troop of the azats** — սեպուհ զունդն ազատաց (Y.060.11), p. 60 l. 11. An Armenian military term.
- **the office of magistros** — մագիստրոսութեան (զպատիւ մագիստրոսութեան, Y.062.16), p. 62 l. 16. A Byzantine title. magistros kept

untranslated per standing rule 5.

- **the rank of magistros** — մագիստրոսութեան, p. 106 l. 16. A Byzantine title.
- **vardapet** — վարդապետ, p. 26 l. 9. An Armenian ecclesiastical term.
- **yushkaparks** — յուշկապարկաց (և յուշկապարկաց, Y.055.15), p. 55 l. 15. A biblical term.
- **zgayiosut'iwn** — զգայիսութեան (ի պալատին զգայիսութեան ունէր զպատիւ, Y.051.25), p. 51 l. 25. A Byzantine office. A Greek loan with no Armenian sense. Yuzbashyan's OWN apparatus at p. 51 l. 25 reports that Prudhomme connects it with Greek dikaiosyne; that identification is recorded and does NOT enter the English. The initial q is part of the word — every cited witness has it.

These notes were compiled at the faithful-edition build from the project's own verified records. No fresh research was undertaken for them. Nothing in them qualifies, softens or defends the author: where he is wrong he is left wrong, and where he is savage he is left savage.